

12 साल विश्वास के, विकास के, जनकल्याण के



राजस्थान सरकार

माननीय प्रधानमंत्री
श्री नरेन्द्र मोदी जी
का
हार्दिक आभार

राजस्थान को एक और बड़ी सौगात

राजस्थान को यमुना जल मिलने का मार्ग प्रशस्त

32 वर्षों से प्रतीक्षारत पेयजल और सिंचाई की जरूरत होगी पूरी

₹34,102 करोड़
की महत्वाकांक्षी परियोजना



राजस्थान और हरियाणा के बीच
यमुना जल समझौते (MoA) पर हस्ताक्षर

75 लाख आबादी को मिलेगा लाभ

यमुना जल समझौते से शेखावाटी क्षेत्र के सीकर, झुंझुनूं और
चूरू जिलों एवं अन्य क्षेत्रों को मिलेगा भरपूर पानी

“राजस्थान के लिए जल से जुड़ी इस महत्वपूर्ण परियोजना को प्रधानमंत्री श्री नरेन्द्र मोदी जी के नेतृत्व में समय पर पूरा करने की प्रतिबद्धता के लिए गृह मंत्री श्री अमित शाह जी, केंद्रीय जल शक्ति मंत्री श्री सी.आर. पाटिल जी एवं हरियाणा के मुख्यमंत्री श्री नायब सिंह सैनी जी का हार्दिक अभिनंदन।”

— भजनलाल शर्मा, मुख्यमंत्री, राजस्थान

राजस्थान संवाद

36 civilians dead in Pak attacks along border: Afghan officials

Pak says ground ops in response to militant strikes; UN puts toll at 28

Associated Press
Kabul, June 29

GROUND OPERATIONS and strikes by Pakistani forces killed at least 36 civilians in Afghanistan overnight and wounded more than 160 others, Afghan officials said Monday, as tensions between neighbours escalated.

One Afghan official said the attacks would be met with retaliation. Islamabad said the operations were launched in response to militant attacks across Pakistan. Security forces carried out a ground operation along the border late Sunday, followed by strikes against militant hide-

outs and safe havens, killing 29 fighters, Pakistan's Information Minister Attaullah Tarar said.

Afghanistan condemned the strikes in Paktia, Paktika, and Kunar provinces as a "cowardly act of aggression" and an "act of brutality." Hayatullah Mohajer Farahi, a deputy minister at the Ministry of Information and Culture, said Afghanistan would respond "in due time."

Hamdullah Fitrat, the deputy spokesperson for Afghanistan's Taliban government, said Pakistani forces targeted a home in Paktia's Chamkani district, killing an older man and a child, while other family members were wounded. When residents



Residents walk past the site of a damaged building after Pakistani airstrikes in Mandokhail village, Afghanistan, on Monday. AP

gathered to rescue people, the area was struck again, killing 28 villagers and wounding 158, he said. Six people, mostly women and children, were killed in a village in Giyan district, Paktika province, when another home

was struck, he said. A civilian home in Kunar province was also hit, causing no casualties but killing some 30 livestock.

The UN Assistance Mission in Afghanistan independently confirmed that at least 28 civil-

ians were killed and 49 others were wounded in the strikes, including women and children.

It added that the figures were preliminary and could increase. Pakistani officials said an uneasy calm prevailed along the border on Monday, with security forces remaining on high alert.

On Monday, Afghanistan and Pakistan summoned each other's top diplomats to protest the attacks. Zia Ahmad Takal, the Afghanistan Foreign Ministry's deputy spokesperson, accused Islamabad of repeatedly blaming Afghanistan for security incidents inside Pakistan without "credible evidence."

Pakistan's behavior "seriously harms the atmosphere of trust between the two countries, good neighborly relations and the security and stability of the region," Takal said. Pakistan's

Ministry of Foreign Affairs said it summoned Afghanistan's top diplomat in Islamabad to protest the involvement of Afghan nationals in recent attacks, including one in Karachi over the weekend. Militant attacks targeting Pakistan's security forces have surged in recent years.

The Pakistani Taliban are separate from but allied with the Afghan Taliban that returned to power in 2021.

Tarar, the Pakistani information minister, shared three videos on X that he said showed projectiles striking sprawling camps and safe havens of Jamaat-ul-Ahrar and Fitna al-Khawarij in Afghanistan's Paktia, Paktika and Kunar provinces. He said the overnight strikes killed "terrorists" and destroyed weapons and ammunition stockpiles.

KUSHNER & WITKOFF BOUND FOR DOHA

US, Iran pause strikes, but differ over next steps on talks

Pezeshkian: \$6bn of \$12bn assets frozen in Qatar to be returned to Tehran

Reuters
Washington, Dubai, June 29

PRESIDENT DONALD Trump said on Monday that Iran had requested a meeting with US counterparts, though one of Iran's top negotiators said no further talks had been scheduled after attacks across Persian Gulf over the weekend challenged negotiations to end the war.

The US President has tried to preserve a fragile interim deal, but hostilities mounted in recent days in the Strait of Hormuz. After four days of trading strikes, both sides appeared to pause their attacks on Monday.

Trump said on social media that a meeting with Iran would happen on Tuesday in Doha, Qatar. Special Envoy Steve Witkoff and Jared Kushner, the president's son-in-law, are flying to Qatar for the meeting. White House Press Secretary Karoline Leavitt told *Fox News*.

Kazem Gharibabadi, a senior negotiator for Iran, denied any talks had been scheduled. The US and Iran agreed to an interim deal earlier this month that calls for Tehran to dilute its stockpile of enriched uranium.

It also waives US-backed sanctions on the country, opens the Strait of Hormuz and gives each side 60 days to hammer out broader agreements. The Trump administration was operating on Monday on the understanding that the US and Iran are standing down after the

Only Iran will de-mine Strait, says minister

Dubai: The removal of mines from the Strait of Hormuz is to be carried out solely by Iran according to the Islamabad MoU between Tehran and Washington, Iran's Deputy Foreign Minister Kazem Gharibabadi said in a post on X on Monday, in response to French President Macron's comments on the subject.

Emmanuel Macron said on Monday that France and Oman will cooperate with their partners on clearing mines from the Strait of Hormuz. "We strongly advise France not to complicate it further with its provocations," Gharibabadi said. **REUTERS**

recent back-and-forth strikes and that vessels can move freely through the Strait of Hormuz, said a US official.

Iranian President Masoud Pezeshkian offered praise for the interim deal in comments published Monday by state-run *IRNA news* agency, calling it "a great victory for Iranian people."

"Based on the plans made, \$6 billion out of the total \$12 billion of Iranian resources in Qatar will be released and returned to the country, and necessary follow-ups are being carried out," he said. Pezeshkian, a reformist within Iran's theocracy, is the highest-ranking official to reference the release of the funds held by Qatar, a key mediator along with Pakistan. Gharibabadi, the Iranian negotiator, cast doubt on the meeting in comments published by IRNA.

• BRIEFLY

UNITED STATES

America's 'royal couple' Taylor and Travis may wed this week



Taylor Swift and Travis Kelce at the US Open on September 8, 2024. FILE

TAYLOR SWIFT may enter her marriage era this week. The record-setting pop singer and her fiancé, National Football League player Travis Kelce, are widely expected to marry this week. They have made no official announcement, and *Reuters* could not confirm a date or location, though the *New York Times* reported that city permits and other clues point toward a Manhattan wedding late in the week. Even without confirmation, excitement is building for one of the most anticipated celebrity weddings of the century. **REUTERS**

VENEZUELA

Rig explosion leaves 8 injured

AN EXPLOSION at a rig operated by state-run oil company PDVSA in Venezuela's Apure state left at least eight workers injured late on Sunday, sources said on Monday. The people were transported to Colombia for medical assistance, according to sources. **REUTERS**

AUSTRALIA

Airline worker held with heroin

THE AUSTRALIAN police said Monday that a Thai airline employee was arrested and charged for allegedly importing more than 1 kilogram of heroin into Melbourne. She was arrested after raising suspicions during a baggage screening, police said in a statement on its website. AP

4.6 magnitude aftershock hits Venezuela as rescue efforts enter critical hours

Twin earthquakes have killed 1,719 people, hundreds of buildings collapsed

Reuters
Caracas, June 29

RESIDENTS OF Caracas woke up on Monday on an aftershock that rocked their houses, while rescue teams continued their fourth day of round-the-clock work in the areas affected by last week's powerful earthquakes in Venezuela.

A 4.6-magnitude aftershock centred at a depth of 10 km hit north of the Venezuelan capital Caracas early Monday, according to the US Geological Survey.

No damage was immediately reported from the aftershock, the president of the National Assembly, Jorge Rodriguez, said on social media, adding that the toll from the twin earthquakes rose to 1,719.

Rescue efforts have been focusing particularly on La Guaira,

the hardest-hit state of a country long mired in a deep political and economic crisis.

The international community has rallied to help Venezuela in the wake of the disaster.

The country has received support from 24 countries, which have sent over 500 metric tons of supplies, more than 2,700 rescue and support personnel and about 86 canine teams, according to authorities. National and international rescue teams continued their efforts throughout the night, while the families of the missing remain hopeful that survivors will be found.

Salvadoran President Nayib Bukele shared the rescue of 21-year-old Aaron Levi in a collapsed building in the disaster-stricken state of La Guaira. "This rescue was made possible thanks to the coordinated efforts of rescue teams from Venezuela, Mexico, and El Salvador," he said on X. Venezuela's interim president, Delcy Rodriguez, also echoed Levi's story, explaining that he was pulled out after 106 hours trapped under the rubble through a rescue operation that lasted 43 hours.

Six killed in German welfare facility shooting; 2 suspects held

Reuters
Berlin, June 29

SIX PEOPLE were shot and killed at a youth welfare facility in northern Germany on Monday, with footage by the *Bild* newspaper showing police surrounding and detaining two people from a car that was driving with a busted tyre.

Police called the incident a homicide with multiple victims in the town of Stade near the port city of Hamburg. The motive was not immediately clear.

The *Spiegel* news outlet, citing information it obtained, said it was likely a personal rather than political or extremist matter. Police said that two people had been detained, including the suspected shooter.

Police had warned people to stay away from the area where the incident took place, but later said there was no danger to the general public.

German media reports initially said four women and one man were dead. Police later said a sixth adult had died in hospital of wounds.

Italy, Balkans scorched by record heat as fears of wildfire mount

Reuters

Rome, June 29

ITALY AND the Balkans felt the impact on Monday of the record-breaking heatwave that has caused hundreds of excess deaths and disrupted daily life across the continent for more than a week, with growing concerns over the spread of wildfires.

There was also a warning that the heat was likely to build again from the start of next week in countries such as France and Germany that bore the brunt over the past few days.

In Italy, 22 cities from Bolzano in the north to Palermo on the southern island of Sicily were covered by a red heat warning.

Pilgrims at the Vatican used fans to cool themselves and sheltered under umbrellas for shade as Pope Leo delivered his Angelus message from a balcony to the crowd below on the Feast of Saints Peter and Paul, a holiday in the city of Rome.

In Croatia, the weather service issued a red alert on Monday for regions including the capital Zagreb and the tourist destinations of Split and Dubrovnik. Dozens of firefighters,



People are sprayed with water at Old Town Square in Prague, Czech Republic, on Monday. REUTERS

assisted by four aircraft, battled a wildfire burning pine forests on the tourist island of Vis in the Adriatic Sea, some 55 km southwest of Split.

In neighbouring Serbia, the State Hydrometeorological Service (RHMZ) has warned temperatures would reach 39 degrees Celsius on Monday.

Further south, Albania contained a wildfire that has consumed many hectares of bushes and olive trees near the southern village of Klos over the weekend.

US Supreme Court rejects Trump's unprecedented bid to fire Fed Governor

Reuters

Washington, June 29

THE US Supreme Court refused on Monday to let Donald Trump fire Federal Reserve Governor Lisa Cook as it stood firm to preserve the central bank's cherished independence against an unprecedented challenge by the Republican president.

The court, in a 5-4 ruling, blocked Trump's bid to become the first president to remove a Fed official since Congress created the central bank in 1913. In his second term as president, Trump has tested the limits of presidential power in numerous other ways as well.

Conservative Chief Justice John Roberts and fellow conservative Justice Brett Kavanaugh were in the majority, along with the court's three liberal justices. Conservative Justices Clarence Thomas, Samuel Alito, Neil Gorsuch and Amy Coney Barrett dissented.



Fed Reserve Governor Lisa Cook

Roberts, who authored the ruling, said Trump "failed to afford Cook the procedural protections to which she was entitled by statute. Without such protections, she could not properly dispute the charges the president laid against her."

Canvassing the history of the Federal Reserve System and its predecessor central banks since the founding, including the Bank of North America and the First and Second Banks of the United States, Roberts emphasized that all have featured independence from the president.



Comedian Bill Maher

Maher wins Mark Twain Prize for American Humor

Washington: Comedian Bill Maher won the Mark Twain Prize for American Humor at the Kennedy Center on Sunday night. Accepting it, Maher derided extremes in both political parties, rejecting what he called "groupthink." "If you hang around long enough and create something important enough, everyone hates you at some point," Maher said.

The ceremony at the Kennedy Center wasn't purely political. There were plenty of jokes about Maher's fondness for marijuana, his rejection of religion and his penchant for controversy, including comments he made after 9/11. **REUTERS**

FT: China grounds private light aircraft after Beijing tower crash

Reuters

Beijing, June 29

CHINA HAS grounded flights of private light fixed-wing aircraft after a plane crashed into Beijing's tallest building last week, the *Financial Times* reported on Monday, citing operators around the country.

The sole pilot on board the twin-seat aircraft was killed during the incident on Friday, which injured 13 people who weren't on board, local government said on Saturday.

The aircraft crashed into a 528-metre-high (1,732-foot) building, known as CITIC Tower or China Zun, in Beijing's central business district during the evening rush hour.

A nationwide airspace control order covering recreational flights has been issued, with all relevant flying activities banned, the *FT* reported.

The restrictions have not been announced publicly. Reuters could not immediately verify the report. The Civil Avi-



The damaged exterior of Beijing's Citic Tower after a small plane crashed into it. FILE

ation Administration of China did not immediately respond to a *Reuters* request for comment.

Authorities are investigating the incident and have given no details on the possible cause of the crash. China's skies are among the most tightly controlled in the world, with the military retaining primary authority over airspace access and allocation.

Beijing is among the most sensitive parts of that manage-

ment framework.

There is a permanent no-fly zone of roughly 100 sq km (39 sq miles) over the political and ceremonial core of the Chinese capital, according to a Reuters review of official aviation navigation rules.

The prohibited area is immediately to the west of the skyscraper-dense central business district, and covers Tiananmen Square and the Zhongnanhai, a compound that houses the offices of China's top political leadership.

While police and other official aircraft have occasionally been spotted over downtown Beijing, apart from military aircraft formations during national parades, a plane near the city's skyscrapers is an exceptionally rare sight.

Commercial jets are routed around Beijing's dense urban areas, with low-flying general aviation broadly restricted to the outskirts. Beijing instituted a citywide drone ban earlier this year.

• AFTER YEARS OF IMPRISONMENT, DONG GUANGPING, 68, MADE THREE FAILED ATTEMPTS TO FLEE THROUGH THAILAND, TAIWAN AND VIETNAM BEFORE ESCAPING TO CANADA VIA SOUTH KOREA

'No point fearing death': Chinese dissident's perilous dinghy escape to South Korea

Kanis Leung

Hong Kong, June 29

A ROUGHLY 40-hour sea journey on a dinghy with a dying phone. Detention in South Korea. That's just part of what Chinese dissident Dong Guangping endured to escape his native country. He arrived late last week in Canada, a destination he had eyed for more than a decade.

Dong had been locked up in China several times, including for his activities commemorating the 1989 crackdown on pro-democracy protesters in Beijing's Tiananmen Square and past efforts to flee. "It's like living in a cage. Very suffocating," he

said in an online video interview with *The Associated Press* from Toronto, referring to the lack of freedom of expression in China.

After his release from prison, the 68-year-old dissident said he was unable to receive retirement benefits or renew his passport and was under constant police monitoring.

He attempted to flee at least three previous times: in 2015 to Thailand, where authorities deported him back to China; in 2019 when he tried to swim to a Taiwanese island off China's east coast; and in 2020, when he reached Vietnam, only to be deported back again.

Last month, he tried again. In the early hours of May 24, he

set off in a gray rubber dinghy fitted with an engine from Weihai, a coastal city in eastern China's Shandong province, under fine weather. He was eyeing Japan, confident that the government there would not send him back to China.

But the next day brought fog. When he noticed his phone, which he relied on for GPS navigation, was on its last bar, he became terrified. His power bank also died. He quickly switched to his contingency plan - South Korea.

Dong recalled that dread ran deep because his tiny boat might capsize if the winds and waves picked up. But he had no way to return and shook off the



Dong Guangping on a dinghy crossing the sea between China and South Korea, on May 24, 2026. AP

fear of death. "Living conditions back in the country are so terrible that being alive is little different than being dead. So

there is no point fearing death," he said. "If you move forward, there's a chance at life." In the evening, he saw lights in the

distance and moved toward them. The first vessel could not hear his cries for help and left. Later, he encountered a fishing boat that agreed to pull him on board. He asked the fishers to call the police to help him.

The South Korean Coast Guard detained him for allegedly violating the country's immigration law.

They sought a warrant to formally arrest him, but a court refused, saying it's "difficult to recognize sufficient grounds and necessity" for his arrest.

Dong was later sent to a refugee center in Incheon, a port city near Seoul.

Earlier this month, the UN refugee agency contacted him

via video call, he said.

A refugee center manager later asked about his height, weight and his eye color. He was worried at first but it turned out to be a good sign. His lawyer told him it was at the request of the Canadian diplomatic mission, he said.

About a week later, Dong boarded a flight and he arrived in Toronto Friday.

He was still unclear what legal procedures were involved in his move, but guessed it was based on cooperation between the South Korean and Canadian governments and the UN agency.

"I feel very surprised, extremely surprised. It's like still in

a dream. It's very fast," he said.

He believed the resettlement status in Canada that his family secured in 2015, before Thai authorities deported him back to China, was still valid.

The Canadian Embassy in South Korea declined to comment on Dong's case. The UN refugee agency and the South Korean government did not immediately respond to requests for comment.

Dong said he feels at home after arriving in Toronto, saying he finally tasted freedom for the first time in over a decade.

"There's not even a hint of fear," he said. He hopes to make a living, possibly by being a truck driver or an Uber driver. **AP**



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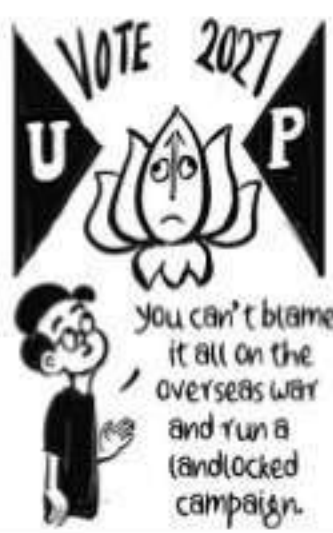
Happening today

● **PM NARENDRA MODI** is likely to hold a meeting with all the Central Secretaries, his second interaction with the top bureaucracy in just over a month. **P 8**

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Business as Usual

By EP UNNNY



DELHI GOVT APPROVES EV POLICY 2.0: NO NEW CNG AUTORICKSHAWS FROM JANUARY NEXT YEAR

Delhi mandates all new 2-wheelers be electric from '28 to fight pollution

100% road tax waiver for four-wheelers priced up to Rs 30 lakh; cash incentives for buying electric two- three-wheelers

Gayathri Mani
New Delhi, June 29

NO PETROL motorcycles and scooters can be registered in Delhi after March 31, 2028, the Delhi government announced on Monday. The registration of new CNG auto-rickshaws will stop at the end of this year. Beginning April 2028, therefore, every new two- and three-wheeler sold in Delhi will have to be an electric vehicle (EV).

The decisions, part of the Delhi government's EV Policy 2.0, represent a sweeping, first-of-its kind policy reform in the country, aimed at making a significant contribution to the Capital's chronic air pollution problem.

The policy will come into effect on July 1, following approval from Lt Governor Taranjit Singh Sandhu. Chief Minister Rekha Gupta, who announced the decision of the Delhi Cabinet on Monday, described the EV Policy as a major step to-



Delhi CM Rekha Gupta at the Secretariat, Monday. ABHINAV SAHA

INSIDE PAGE 4

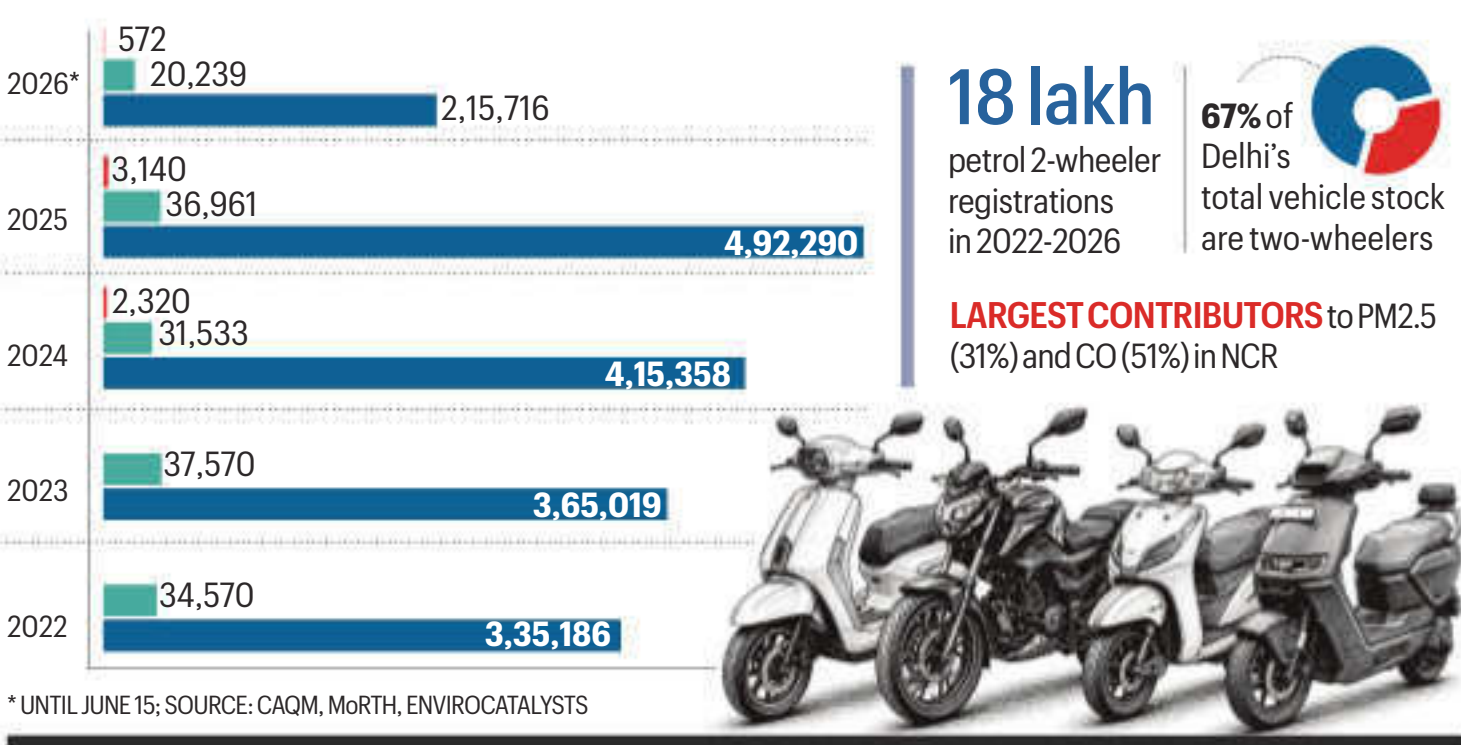
INCENTIVES, TAX EXEMPTIONS: HOW BUYERS BENEFIT

EXPERTS PUSH FOR INFRA BOOST

wards making Delhi pollution-free by March 31, 2030. The government would spend Rs 15,000 crore on incentives and on strengthening the

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

• TWO-WHEELERS IN THE CAPITAL



Two-wheelers constitute two-thirds of Delhi's vehicles, why this shift matters

Sophiya Mathew & Devansh Mittal
New Delhi, June 29

THE DELHI Electric Vehicle (EV) Policy announced on Monday focuses on two priorities: a phased transition to mandatory electric two-wheelers, three-wheelers, and

light-duty trucks, and a conscious emphasis on pure EVs over strong hybrid vehicles. The policy aims to achieve a minimum 30% electrification of Delhi's vehicle fleet by March 31, 2030, when the policy runs out. The transport sector is

among the most significant contributors to Delhi's air pollution. While winter episodes of bad air get the most attention, vehicular emissions remain a persistent source of pollution through the year, making the transition to

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

In Karnataka, 519 small hydel power projects allotted, 386 cancelled

State ranks first in small hydel power generation capacity, but projects are failing to get environmental clearances

Johnson T A
Bengaluru, June 29

WHILE IT ranks top among states in the small hydel power sector, with an installed capacity of 1284 MW, three-fourths of the allotted projects in Karnataka eventually fell through before the commissioning stage. In most cases, the reason was failure to get environmental clearances.

As per data released for small hydel projects (plants with a generation capacity of up to 25 MW) by the Karnataka Renewable Energy Develop-

ment Limited (KREDL), until May 31 this year, 519 had been allotted in the state, and 386 stood cancelled.

In March this year, the Centre cleared a Rs 2,584-crore impetus for private participation in the small hydro sector, to facilitate installation of approximately 1500 MW of small hydro power, amid the West Asia crisis-triggered fuel shortage.

Most of the cancelled Karnataka projects were allotted in the 2007-10 and 2014-15 period, when incentives were on offer. Some among them were

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

• Allotments and cancellations

PERIOD (GOVT)	ALLOTTED	CANCELLED
2009-10 (BJP)	22 projects (205 MW)	11 projects (54 MW)
2010-11 (BJP)	52 projects (214 MW)	46 projects (172 MW)
2014-15 (Congress)	25 projects (126 MW)	20 projects (71 MW)
2015-16 (Congress)	21 projects (212 MW)	17 projects (164 MW)
2018-19 (JDS-Cong)	11 projects (118 MW)	10 projects (117 MW)
2022-23 (BJP)	225 projects (1,165 MW)	220 projects (1,123 MW)
2025-26 (Congress)	10 projects (142 MW)	2 projects (39 MW)

DATA SOURCE: KREDL

Brazil knock Japan out of World Cup



GABRIEL MARTINELLI scored a stoppage-time goal for Brazil to beat Japan 2-1 in the World Cup knockouts, Monday.

KAISHU SANO put Japan ahead in the 27th minute, before Casemiro equalised for Brazil in the 56th minute. Substitute Martinelli then squeezed in a shot at the far post in the fifth minute of added time to win it for the five-time champions.

REPORTS, PAGE 17

Brazil's Gabriel Martinelli celebrates his goal against Japan at Houston Stadium in Texas, Monday. REUTERS

NATION PAGES 12, 15



RAM TEMPLE 'THEFT': SC DECLINES URGENT HEARING IN PETITION SEEKING CBI PROBE

HEAVY RAIN RAVAGES ARUNACHAL: THREE KILLED, 12 DISTRICTS AFFECTED

Akal Takht gives Mann Govt one month to amend anti-sacrilege law

Kamaldeep Singh Brar
Amritsar, June 29

THE AKAL Takht gave the Aam Aadmi Party (AAP)-led Punjab government a month to remove certain "objectionable" clauses in its anti-sacrilege law, as almost all Sikh legislators cutting across party lines, including 78 MLAs and nine ministers, appeared before it on Monday.

The Sikh community's highest temporal authority also asked the Bhagwant Mann-led

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2



Punjab MLAs at the Akal Takht in Amritsar, Monday. RANA SIMRANJIT SINGH

Bihar Governor, MoS likely to attend Khamenei's funeral in Iran next month

PM and Jaishankar have foreign visits planned around same dates

Divya A
New Delhi, June 29

BIHAR GOVERNOR Lt Gen Syed Ata Hasnain (retired) and Minister of State for External Affairs Pabitra Margherita are likely to represent India at Iran's state funeral for Supreme Leader Ayatollah Ali Khamenei next month, *The Indian Express* has learnt. An official announcement is yet to be made. Last week, Iran President Masoud Pezeshkian had sent a formal invitation to Prime Minister Narendra Modi to attend the funeral next month. However, sources said there were scheduling issues, as a multinational visit by the Prime Minister was planned around the same dates.

Khamenei was killed in a US-Israeli air strike on Tehran on February 28. While the burial was initially scheduled for March, it was postponed in view of the conflict raging then. The funeral proceedings will begin in Tehran on July 4, and he will be laid to rest in his home town of Mashhad on July 9. With External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar, too, unlikely to be available due to pre-scheduled foreign visits, New Delhi wanted to send a delegation commensurate with the importance it attaches to its civilisational ties with Tehran. As MoS, External Affairs, Margherita represented the Indian government at the

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2



(Top) Bihar Governor Lt Gen Syed Ata Hasnain (retired); Minister of State for External Affairs Pabitra Margherita

Sarla Bhat was killed to drive Kashmiri Pandits out of Valley, says chargesheet

737-page chargesheet names Yasin Malik as key accused in the abduction and killing of the young nurse in 1990

Naveed Iqbal & Arun Sharma
Srinagar, Jammu, June 29

THE JAMMU and Kashmir police's investigation into the death of Sarla Bhat in 1990 has "conclusively established" that she was "abducted, tortured and killed" by the Jammu and Kashmir Liberation Front (JKLF), "pursuant to a larger terrorist conspiracy and campaign directed against the Kashmiri Pandit community". Bhat was a 27-year-old nurse in the Neonatology Department of the Sher-e-Kashmir Institute of Medical Sciences (SKIMS), Soura. Her body was found on the Malla-bagh-Omer Colony Road in Srinagar on April 19, 1990. On Monday, the State Investigation Agency filed a 737-page chargesheet in a special NIA court in Srinagar, naming the then JKLF chief Yasin Malik as a key accused in her abduction



Sarla Bhat's body was found on a Srinagar road on April 19, 1990

RELATED REPORT, PAGE 15

and killing. Officials called the development a "historic milestone in the pursuit of justice for victims of terrorism" and said that it stands as "one of the most significant breakthroughs in the investigation of legacy terror crimes in Jammu and Kashmir". The case was transferred to the SIA on March 18, 2024, under the orders of the J&K DGP. The accused in the case include Malik, who is currently in judicial custody in another

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

● OF 15 WHO DIED, 12, INCLUDING 16-YEAR-OLD GIRL, WERE FROM KEONJHAR DISTRICT

Girl's death in TN gas leak spotlights desperate migration in Odisha tribal hamlet

Sujit Bisoi
Rangamatia (Keonjhar), June 29

BISUNI JUANGA, 56, is illiterate. But sitting outside his mud house in a remote tribal village, he pores intently over a stack of official papers, seeking answers as to how his 16-year-old daughter died at a seafood processing unit in Tamil Nadu, nearly 1,500 km away.

Of the 15 who have died since the June 21 gas leak at the factory, in Tiruvallur district of the southern state, 12 were from Odisha, all belonging to Keonjhar district, and all of

them women. Of the dead, two belonged to Rangamatia, including Bisuni's daughter Jamini Juanga.

Of the 68 hospitalised, 65 are women; all the five who are critical and on ventilator support belong to Rangamatia.

A tribal hamlet with a population of a little over 200, Rangamatia had at least 10 of its women and 8 men employed at the seafood unit — making the gas leak one of the worst tragedies to have hit the village.

Says Bisuni: "Some officials from the block visited our house, handed over Jamini's

body, and informed us she died due to 'gas'... I don't know what that means... She was just 16, and had a full life to live."

Jamini, who had studied until Class 5, was the third of Bisuni's four daughters. The elder ones, 21 and 19, are married, while the fourth is 14. Jamini went to Tamil Nadu a little over seven months ago, the first member of the family to travel outside Keonjhar. Mostly, they only go to the homes of the married daughters in nearby villages, says Bisuni.

After Jamini left, they had no contact with her, the family says. Until last year, the village had no mobile connectivity;



Relatives and neighbours outside the home of Bisuni Juanga, whose daughter died in the June 21 gas leak in Tamil Nadu. SUJIT BISOI

now BSNL is available. But, Bisuni can barely afford one. Juangas like him are part of a

particularly vulnerable tribal group (PVTG), and Bisuni has long struggled with poverty.

His only possessions are two goats and the mud house, separated into two enclosures.

With no farmland of their own, tribals in the village clear patches of forest to cultivate crops and depend on forest produce.

The 2011 Census put Rangamatia's numbers at 38 households and 158 people. Located in a hilly terrain with poor road connectivity, it has no drinking water and electricity. A small spring from a nearby forest is the only source of drinking water. There is an anganwadi and a school till the primary level.

Villagers, particularly girls such as Jamini, don't study

beyond Class 5. The nearest high school is 10 km away, too far due to both financial constraints and lack of transport facilities. The nearest motorable road is officially 1 km away, but is on the other side of a hill. The nearest hospital is in Harichandpur town, about 40 km away.

"We can't even travel to nearby markets or towns in search of jobs," says Bisuni. So it was understood that when she could, Jamini would migrate to sustain her family, like other youngsters here, he says, adding he is not even sure what wages Jamini was promised.

Most of the girls and women who work outside the village

are not married. Once they are wed, it is the men who leave.

The Odisha government initially announced an ex gratia of Rs 4 lakh for the family members of the victims, which was later enhanced to Rs 10 lakh. But Bisuni claims all he has received so far is Rs 3,000 from the panchayat to conduct her funeral.

Gumani Juanga, the second casualty from Rangamatia, was 15 as per her Aadhaar card; her parents, who were looking for a groom for her, say she was 19. She left for Tamil Nadu last November. She was part of a group of workers, including her elder

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

EXPRESSspecial

‘Stuck for nearly 10 years’: Residents struggle as Kathputli Colony redevelopment project misses another deadline

Devansh Mittal
New Delhi, June 29

“Aisa lagta hai idhar hi jeevan khatam ho jaayega... (It feels like our life will end here only),” says a woman, who is one of thousands of people living in Anand Parbat transit camp of New Delhi after being moved from Kathputli Colony. Home to musicians, puppeteers, magicians and dancers, Kathputli Colony in West Delhi’s Shadi-pur area was the first slum in the Capital conceived for in-situ rehabilitation in 2008 — the only such project undertaken by a private firm, Raheja Developers, under a Public-Private Partnership (PPP) mode.

The demolitions began in 2017 and the construction at the site to build a new housing complex started in 2018. Delhi Development Authority (DDA) officials had told *The Indian Express* last September that the first batch of the flats would be ready by December 2025, according to a timeline sent by developer Raheja Developers Limited. The deadline to finish the full project — comprising 2,800 Economically Weaker Section (EWS) flats — was June this year.

But DDA is set to miss yet another deadline for the completion of the housing complex. The project’s original completion date was 2020 and after repeatedly missing deadlines, it is expected to take one more year to complete, *The Indian Express* has learnt.

“The delay is from the contractor’s side who is claiming to have liquidity issues. However, the DDA is constantly talking to them to expeditiously complete the project,” a senior DDA official said, adding: “The project has made 65-70% physical and financial progress. 1,400 flats are ready, while the remaining 1,400 are under different stages of construction.”

The project was conceived way back in 2008 and approved in 2009. Residents of the slum moved in batches to makeshift camps in Anand Parbat and Outer Delhi’s Narela between 2014 and 2017, when all the slums were finally demolished and the land was cleared. Construction for the housing project eventually started in 2018.

People who are living in the transit camps now have gone weary due to repeated announcements of the project nearing completion over the years.

The Indian Express spoke to people living in Anand Parbat



ABHINAV SAHA



DEVANSH MITTAL

At Anand Parbat transit camp; (top) work on Kathputli Colony project underway at Shadi-pur in New Delhi.

— many of them are losing hope of rehabilitation. “At the last meeting with DDA officials earlier this month, they said it will take one more year. But I don’t know what will happen now. I had three homes there in Kathputli. They shifted us, saying we will have new homes in two years. Now we have been stuck here for almost 10 years,” said Patashi Devi, president of the local RWA.

The transit camp is made of tin porta cabins. “In summers, it is boiling inside the houses,” Devi points out.

“At the Kathputli colony, there were taps inside homes from which we used to get clean water. But here, locals end up fighting among themselves so often as there are common taps that everyone has to use,” says Suraj (20), a resident who works in bands performing at weddings.

Established between the late 1960s and early 1970s, the Kathputli Colony was home to artists and performers originally from Rajasthan, and named after its resident puppeteers. They were later joined by folk artists and migrant workers from Uttar Pradesh, Maharashtra, Gujarat, Bihar and Andhra Pradesh. Many of the artists have won national awards, among other accolades, and performed in events in other countries, representing Indian culture.

The housing complex — where the EWS flats are being

constructed — was last year named as Pragati Apartments. Officials claimed that it was done after residents urged authorities to “adopt a name that reflects progress.”

Developer under scanner

Meanwhile, the developer has been facing action over other projects. Earlier in June, the Enforcement Directorate (ED) had attached assets worth Rs 503.48 crore linked to Raheja Developers, its promoter Navin M Raheja and members of his family as part of an ongoing money-laundering investigation into an alleged fraud against homebuyers. With this action, the total value of assets attached by the agency in this case has risen to about Rs 1,617.29 crore.

There are other disputes involving Raheja Developers and homebuyers across other projects in Gurgaon, with insolvency proceedings already initiated or under consideration in other developments by the company too. The principal bench of National Company Law Tribunal (NCLT) had admitted an insolvency petition filed by 176 homebuyers of Raheja Developers’ Revanta project in Sector 78 of Gurgaon.

Medical procurement fraud case: ‘Liaison’ under scanner

Alok Singh
New Delhi, June 29

AS PROBE deepens into the Rs 700-crore fraud case linked to the Central Procurement Agency (CPA) and the Directorate General of Health Services (DGHS) in Delhi, the role of a “contractor” — accused of manipulating tenders and siphoning off public funds — is under scanner, *The Indian Express* has learnt.

Described by investigators as a broker, he reportedly created multiple shell firms in an alleged attempt to benefit a few manufacturers and played a central role in rigging tenders for medicines, surgical items, consumables and equipment. He is accused of tying up with manufacturers, fixing supply rates and arranging cash kickbacks, said sources.

Said a senior officer, “The FIR mentions the name. His role is being probed and he is on the radar. If required he will be called for questioning and may be arrested also.”

A complaint regarding the alleged scam and irregularities in procurement for health facilities in the Capital was filed by the Department of Vigilance with the Anti-Corruption Branch (ACB) of the Delhi Police, which was later converted into an FIR on June 2. The alleged irregularities first came to light in May this year when the Department of Vigilance conducted raids at the CPA office following complaints regarding procurement discrepancies.

The complaint from the Vigilance Department names several firms allegedly used as fronts and alleged the “liaison” was the real operator behind those entities, sources said.

“Tender specifications and terms were prepared to favour the pre-decided firms... with the liaisoner/supplier drafting restrictive specifications in collusion with manufacturer contacts. Those documents were then reportedly routed to Dr Vinod Kumar Ranga, Head of Office (HOO) of CPA, who presented them to the tender committee,” the complaint stated.

Tender committees were allegedly coerced into approving these tailor-made specifications, according to the complaint and former DGHS Dr Vatsala Aggarwal, who was arrested over the weekend in the case, allegedly gave final sanction to the skewed tender terms.

The “broker” then allegedly ensured that the front firms submitted bids, criteria such as turnover, experience and per-

• CASE TIMELINE

JUNE 2 Complaint filed by Vigilance dept with ACB turns into FIR. It alleges cartels operated within procurement system

JUNE 18 ACB arrests Dr Vinod Kumar Ranga, CPA’s former Head of Office.

JUNE 25 ED files money laundering case under the PMLA

JUNE 28 ACB arrests former DGHS chief Dr Vatsala Aggarwal and former Deputy Controller of Accounts, CPA, Neeraj Chopra

formance were set at exorbitant levels to discourage genuine competitors, yet the shell firms were allowed to qualify.

The complaint further charges that technical evaluation sheets were prepared by the “broker/ supplier” and handed to Dr Ranga for fast approval, while financial bids were opened secretly the same day. Award approvals and purchase orders, the FIR claims, were issued manually and outside the e-procurement or Government e-Marketplace (GeM) workflows — often within hours of bid opening.

The FIR alleges deliberate manipulation of online tender statuses to conceal completed awards. Long-closed procurements, for which full payments were allegedly released, reportedly remained listed as “Active” or “Under Process” on public procurement portals, preventing scrutiny by other suppliers and the public. Payments to existing, legitimate suppliers allegedly stalled for up to two years, while orders tied to the “liaisoner” saw payment re;leased within one/two days. The complaint contends that tenders worth several hundred crores may have been awarded under this arrangement.

The ACB has confirmed registration of an FIR and said preliminary inquiries are underway. Investigators will examine tender files, procurement por-

Arrested former DGHS chief held many key posts over the years

Express News Service
New Delhi, June 29

DR VATSALA Aggarwal, the former Director General of Health Services (DGHS), was arrested by the Anti-Corruption Branch (ACB) of the Delhi government on Sunday in connection with the alleged procurement fraud that is said to have caused loss of over Rs 700 crore to the government exchequer. Over the years, she has held several key posts.

A senior Health Department officer, Aggarwal became DGHS last August as she succeeded Dr Rati Makkar who had retired.

As health services chief, she was responsible for the functioning of Delhi government hospitals, public health programmes and the Central Procurement Agency (CPA), the nodal agency responsible for procuring and supplying medicines, vaccines and medical equipment to Delhi government hospitals and healthcare facilities.

Before she assumed the post, she was the director of Janakpuri Super Speciality Hospital. She also held the additional charge of Medical Superintendent of Deep Chand Bandhu Hospital.

The Delhi government had also handed over interim charge of the Delhi Medical Council (DMC) to her last August nearly two months after the council was dissolved over alleged irregularities.

Earlier, Aggarwal was the Director of the Delhi State Cancer Institute (DSCI) between 2023

and 2025, where she looked after the functioning of the cancer hospital.

However, in 2024, the Delhi government’s Department of Vigilance started an inquiry into alleged irregularities in changes to recruitment rules and appointments at DSCI. However, no criminal case was registered against her at that time.

Her tenure as the health services chief came under scrutiny in May this year after the Department of Vigilance conducted raids at the CPA officers over alleged irregularities in the purchase of medicines, medical equipment. Soon after the raids, she was transferred.

Later, the Delhi government sought permission under Section 17A of the Prevention of Corruption Act to investigate allegations against Aggarwal and Deputy Controller of Accounts Neeraj Chopra in connection with the procurement process. She was suspended as the investigation expanded.

Aggarwal challenged her transfer before the Central Administrative Tribunal (CAT), which stayed the order and asked the government to review its decision. She was later posted to Guru Teg Bahadur Hospital.

On Sunday, the ACB arrested Aggarwal, alleging that she was part of a conspiracy involving irregular purchase of medicines and medical equipment for Delhi government hospitals. According to the agency, the procurement process was manipulated to benefit certain firms, causing a major loss to the government.

tals, payment records and the corporate structures of the named firms to establish links alleged in the complaint. Officials contacted for comment have not yet responded to questions about the timeline for arrests or asset tracing.

The allegations add to scrutiny of procurement practices in the Delhi health department after recent action against senior officials.

The probe aims to determine the extent of the financial damage and to recover any proceeds of the alleged malpractice, said sources.

• Skywatch



Forecast: June 30, 2026
Partly cloudy sky. Heatwave. Light rain, thunderstorm.

MAX: 40-42
4.6°C above normal

MIN: 30-32
4.1°C above normal

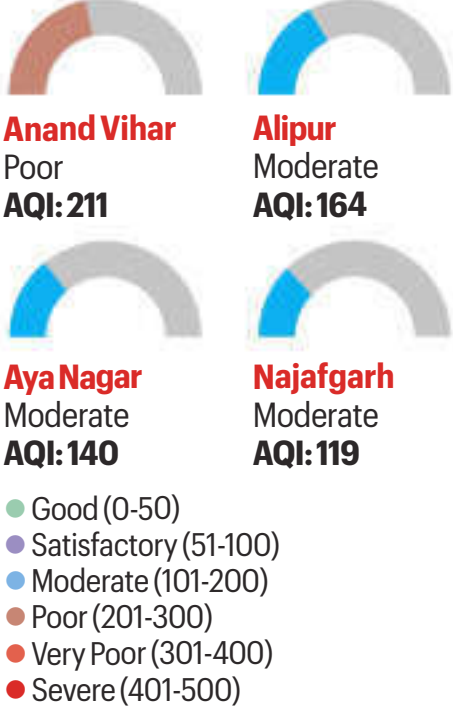
• **Sunrise:** 5:37 AM (July 1)

• **Sunset:** 7:23 PM (June 30)

• **Moonrise:** 7:58 AM (June 30)

• **Moonset:** 6:16 AM (July 1)

• AQI Tracker



• BRIEFLY

Capital reels under heatwave conditions

DELHI WITNESSED its second consecutive day of heatwave conditions Monday before thunderstorms swept across parts of the NCR, causing a sharp dip in temperatures. Very light rainfall and drizzle were reported over parts of south Delhi. During the day, Safdarjung recorded a maximum temperature of 42.2°C, 5°C above normal, while Palam touched 42.4°C (4.8°C above normal). The Ridge recorded 43.4°C, among the highest in the city. As per the India Meteorological Department, heatwave conditions are unlikely to persist on Tuesday. ENS

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NOTICE

TRANSFER OF EQUITY SHARES OF THE CORPORATION TO INVESTOR EDUCATION AND PROTECTION FUND (IEPF)

Notice is hereby given to the shareholders pursuant to the provisions of Section 124(5) of the Companies Act, 2013 read with the Investor Education and Protection Fund Authority (Accounting, Audit, Transfer and Refund) Rules, 2016 ("the Rules") as amended from time to time, for transfer of all shares in respect of which dividend has remained unclaimed by the shareholders for seven consecutive years or more. Individual communication(s) were sent to the latest available address of those shareholders whose shares are liable to be transferred to IEPF Authority under the said rules for not claiming the dividend for seven consecutive years from 2018-19, the details of which are also hosted on the Corporations' website <https://www.gicre.in/en/investors-public-disclosures/investors-en/unclaimed-dividend>.

In view of above, shareholders are requested to verify and claim the unpaid dividend for the year 2018-19 along with subsequent dividend(s) remaining unclaimed immediately and in any case not later than October 01, 2026. In the event of non-receipt of valid claim by October 01, 2026, the Corporation will proceed to transfer the liable dividend and Equity shares in favor of IEPF Authority without any further notice. Please note that no claim shall lie against the Corporation in respect of unclaimed dividend amount and shares transferred to IEPF Authority pursuant to the said rules.

It may please be noted that the Corporation shall transfer the underlying shares to the IEPF Authority, by following due process as enumerated in the rules, which is as under:

- In case you hold shares in physical form:** Duplicate share certificate(s) will be issued and transferred to IEPF. The original share certificate(s) lying with the shareholder, will stand automatically cancelled and deemed non-negotiable.
- In case you hold shares in electronic form:** Demat account will be debited for the shares liable for transfer to the IEPF through instructions given to member's Depository Participants (DP).

After transfer of such shares to IEPF Authority, the shareholders can claim all benefits, dividends accruing thereon in due compliance of the procedure prescribed under the said Rules. For further information, please visit website of IEPF Authority at www.iepf.gov.in

Shareholders are therefore requested to note the aforesaid provisions and submit the claim to the Corporation's Registrar and Share Transfer Agent, M/s. KFin Technologies Limited, Unit: General Insurance Corporation of India, Selenium Building, Tower B, Plot 31-32, Financial District, Nanakramguda, Serilingampally, Hyderabad, Rangareddy, Telangana - 500 032 Toll Free no. 1800-309-4001, E-mail: einward.ris@kfintech.com

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Satheesh Kumar
(Company Secretary)

Date: 29.06.2026
Place: Mumbai

MANDATES ON REGISTRATION



From Jan 1, 2027
Only electric 3-wheelers,
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From Jan 1, 2027
Only electric N1 carriers (can carry
loads of up to 3.5 tonnes)



From April 1, 2028
Only electric
two-wheelers

Experts push for infra boost as Delhi gears up to go electric

Capital sets precedent with first-of-its kind policy for electric vehicles

Gayathri Mani
New Delhi, June 29

EVEN AS some experts have said that Delhi's new policy on electric vehicles — which the Cabinet approved on Monday — is a "game changer", others have expressed concerns over the infrastructural gaps and timelines related to the transition. Ban on registration of two wheelers and dropping the proposed incentives on strong hybrid vehicles — these are among the aspects that seem to have divided the policy experts.

Vikas Nimesh, Assistant Professor at School of Public Policy, IIT Delhi, called the mandate to switch to electric two-wheelers, three-wheelers and school buses in the coming years a "game changer". "Such a transition is a good move because bikes running on fuel are responsible for 70 to 80% of vehicular emissions in the Capital. A couple of years ago, there were no major choices for people looking to buy e-bikes but now there are models to choose from. Similarly, the government has given a time of two years... the makers will also come up with more EV models," he opined.

On the current state of charging infrastructure, he said, there is a "huge gap" and it will take about six-seven years for complete transition to take place. "The government has to expedite the installation of charging infrastructures near the residential areas where people live and come up with models by 2027-28...otherwise, the transition will be difficult to achieve," he said.

Amit Bhatt, Managing Director, International Council on Clean Transportation (ICCT), a nonprofit, said, "The proposed phase-out of two- and three-wheelers could be a game changer in Delhi's fight against air pollution."

Bhatt also pointed out that these segments account for a large share of the city's vehicle fleet, and accelerating their transition to zero-emission vehicles can significantly "reduce vehicular emissions, improve public health, and pave the way for a broader transition to zero-emission transport across all vehicle segments."

Meanwhile, another specialist, Anil Chikkara, a former Transport official, criticised the policy saying, "The government should give some time and go for a gradual transition of petrol two-wheelers to e-two wheelers.



PRAVEEN KHANNA

Percentage Distribution of Fuel Categories by Vehicle Class (%)



91.2% of two-wheelers are petrol-powered, while 8.6% are electric

45.3% private four-wheelers run on petrol, but 28.6% are Petrol CNG, 10.1% are EVs

90% goods carriers are powered by CNG

Minimum Electric Share of Fleet

Till completion of year 2 from the date of notification	10%
Till completion of year 3 from the date of notification	20%
Till 31st March 2030	30%

Budgetary Breakdown (Approx)

Purchase Incentives: Over Rs 1,500 crore
Scrapping Incentives: Over Rs 1,500 crore
Charging Infrastructure: Rs 1,000 crore
Road Tax & Registration Waivers: Over Rs 3,000 crore in revenue foregone to benefit citizens.

EVS PURCHASED IN DELHI will not be given an NOC for selling or re-registering in other states for 3 years

FINANCIAL BENEFITS for the Public: 100% waiver on Road tax & Registration fee for all electric vehicles. But, waiver on Road Tax & registration fee is eligible for e-cars having ex-showroom price up to Rs 30 Lakh.

SOURCE: MINISTRY OF ROAD TRANSPORT AND HIGHWAYS/ ENVIROCATALYSTS/ DELHI GOVERNMENT

Because they do not have enough charging points and stations, why would people switch to EVs...One cannot travel every time to a charging station and there are no facilities in resettlement colonies and narrow colonies...this just seems to benefit EV manufacturers," he said.

On the government's decision to withdraw proposed road waiver on the strong hybrid vehicles, Nimesh said the government should have given a transition 'bridge' to the public. "Too ride an EV, so I know the difficulties I face. A complete transition to EVs is the ultimate goal but till we have solid number charging stations, the government should have given incentives on strong hybrids, so that there could have been at least a gradual transition towards EVs," he said.

But Bhatt said that dropping purchase incentives for strong hybrids would be a positive step, as it would help direct policy support and investments toward a faster transition to zero-emission transport technologies.

Devender Sharma, Auto Manufacturer, Micro Auto Tech Private Limited, giving his opinion as an industry player said, "There is no clarity on subsidies...a similar issue in the previous policy also. For instance, how will the subsidy be disbursed, will the owners have to

apply directly or the manufacturers will get it first and then it will go into the customers account like in the previous policy...EV portal government is saying but it should be defined properly."

The EV policy will come into effect from July 1.

"Every EV delivers a double dividend—it gives our children cleaner air while reducing India's dependence on imported fossil fuels. It's not just an environmental choice; it's an economic and strategic investment in an Atmanirbhar Bharat. It's good for the planet," underlined Delhi Transport Minister Ashish Sood, who heads the panel formalising the EV policy.

Under the new policy, Delhi's 5.8 million two-wheelers are being primarily targeted through subsidies and scrapping incentives. At present, there are around 5,884 EV charging stations and 8,912 charging points. There are 893 battery swapping stations.

CM Rekha Gupta said that her government will develop a robust charging network with installation of more than 30,000 EV charging points across Delhi during the policy period.

The required land has already been identified and charging infrastructure will be developed across the city on a large scale in the coming months," she said.

six months of policy implementation, the government also offers an incentive of Rs 10,000. So the electric scooter will cost Rs. 85,000 in the first year, Rs. 92,000 in the second year and Rs. 98,000 in the third year of the policy.

For four-wheeler owners

While the government has not offered a direct purchase incentive on buying electric cars, it has sought to incentivise petrol or diesel car owners through a scrapping incentive planning

and submitted the documents. Officers, however, learned that it was not the woman whose photo was on the PAN card.

Officers found Sachin never intended to live in Usha's flat. He just wanted a rent agreement so they could get the details of the property and of Usha that he could use later to obtain loans, mortgages and an overdraft.

"The accused managed to source the PAN card of another Usha Rani Sethi from Odisha. This person had no connection

Transition still unsteady in Gurgaon, gaps remain in infra

Abhimanyu Hazarika
Gurgaon, June 29

EVEN AS the Delhi government on Monday approved a new Electric Vehicle Policy — under which only electric two-wheelers will be eligible for registration in the Capital from April 1, 2028 — electric mobility transition in Gurgaon has not yet seen rapid adoption.

Under the newly approved framework, Delhi has eliminated proposed tax exemptions for strong hybrid vehicles to focus entirely on EVs, setting an aggressive timeline to effectively phase out petrol-run bikes. However, vehicle registration data from Gurgaon paints a contrasting picture of adoption across the border.

According to think tank Envirocatalysts, out of the 1,00,675 two-wheelers registered in Gurgaon during financial year (FY) 2025-26, only 2,249 were electric — representing a mere 2.23% share. This figure marks a drop in market share from 2024-25, which saw registration of 87,544 two-wheelers, of which 3,321 were electric — translating to a 3.79 per cent share.

The figure for petrol and petrol-ethanol two-wheelers stood at 98,025 in FY 2025-26.

Despite the Haryana government also introducing an EV policy in 2022 that offers financial subsidies and tax exemptions to buyers, as earlier reported by The Indian Express, Gurgaon has struggled to match the pace of EV adoption seen in the national capital.

In an attempt to address gaps in the charging infrastructure, the Haryana Department of Town and Country Planning on June 5 approved an amendment to the Haryana Building Code, mandating the integration of EV charging infrastructure in all new residential and commercial buildings.

Under the revised norms, commercial establishments such as offices, hotels, and malls are now required to provide at least one charging point for every three parking spaces, while residential and group housing projects must designate one charging point for every five parking slots.

•SIR begins today

● House-to-house visit by BLO: June 30 to July 29	Aug 5 to September 4
● Draft electoral rolls: Aug 5	● Hearings/verification: Aug 5 to Oct 3
● Claims and objections:	● Final electoral rolls: Oct 10

List of documents that can be submitted

● Any ID card/pension payment order issued to a regular employee/pensioner of Central or any state government/PSUs	● Forest Right Certificate
● Any ID card/certificate/document issued in India by the government/local authorities/banks/post office/LIC/PSUs prior to July 1, 1987	● OBC/SC/ST or any caste certificate
● Birth certificate	● National Register of Citizens data (wherever it exists)
● Passport	● Family register prepared by state/local authorities.
● Matriculation/educational certificate issued by recognised boards/universities	● Any land/house allotment certificate by the government.
● Permanent residence certificate issued by state authority	● Extract of the electoral roll of Bihar SIR with reference to July 1, 2025
	● Aadhaar (Only as a proof of identity, not citizenship)

Voters who faced demolition to be treated as special cases: Delhi CEO

Devansh Mittal
New Delhi, June 29

A DAY before the rollout of the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls in the Capital, Chief Electoral Officer Alok Kumar on Monday said the matter involving eligible electors whose houses have been demolished will be discussed with the Election Commission of India.

Starting Tuesday, more than 13,000 Booth Level Officers (BLOs) will begin house-to-house visits in Delhi on June 30 to distribute enumeration forms in which electors are required to fill out details as per the last SIR. The phase will conclude on July 29. "Those whose houses have been demolished will be discussed with the Election Commission of India. Starting Tuesday, more than 13,000 Booth Level Officers (BLOs) will begin house-to-house visits in Delhi on June 30 to distribute enumeration forms in which electors are required to fill out details as per the last SIR. The phase will conclude on July 29.

"Those whose houses have been demolished will not be at their given address. When the BLO goes there, they will find an empty ground. So how will he give an enumeration form? If the elector fills the form online, how will the verification take place? If a filled enumeration form is not collected, then their names will not appear in the draft electoral roll," Kumar said.

"In such cases, if someone's name is not in the draft electoral roll, they can fill a Form 6 along with a declaration of their new address," he explained.

"If there have been demolitions, then those are special cases and we will deal with them separately. This is an

issue which has come up recently. We are aware of it and will talk to the Election Commission of India on this latest development," Kumar said.

During the house-to-house visits, after electors receive the enumeration forms through the BLOs, they would be required to fill the form and return it.

If a house is found locked during verification, BLOs will leave the forms and make at least three visits to collect the filled forms. In case forms are not returned, BLOs may identify probable reasons such as absence, shifting, death or duplicate registration based on local inquiry.

In Delhi, the draft electoral roll will be published on August 5, following which claims and objections can be filed till September 4. Disposal of claims and objections will continue till October 3, while the final electoral roll is slated to be published on October 7.

Delhi has 77.11 lakh male and 67.98 lakh female voters. The number of third-gender voters stands at 1,024, according to the electoral roll frozen at June 16 midnight.

There are 3.29 lakh young voters (aged 18-19), and 192 who are over aged above 100. The Capital has 13,033 polling stations, segregated into seven Lok Sabha and 70 Assembly constituencies.

Fire at Noida highrise, AC blast suspected

Drishti Jain
Noida, June 29

A FAMILY escaped unhurt after a fire, triggered by a suspected air-conditioner blast, broke out in a flat on the 21st floor of a residential building in Noida's Sector 119 Monday morning, prompting the deployment of six fire tenders.

"At the time of the incident, the family was asleep but managed to come out safely as soon as they noticed the fire. No one was injured, and the fire was contained within half an hour," Pradeep Kumar, Chief Fire Officer (CFO), Gautam Buddha Nagar, said.

The senior officer said around 15-20 firefighting personnel entered the flat through the balcony and from inside. "Since the fire was reported to



The building in Noida's Sector-119 on Monday. TASHI TOBGIAL

be severe, the police, an ambulance, and six fire tenders were immediately dispatched to the spot," he added.

According to fire department officials, their control room received a call around 8.50 am. "The fire was contained to a single flat on the 21st floor," said a police officer.

● MONEY ROUTED THROUGH 11 SHELL COMPANIES, SAY COPS

Delhi woman rents out flats, tenant 'avails' loans worth Rs 18 crore in her name

Pragynesh
New Delhi, June 29

IT WAS June 2012. Fifty-five-year-old Usha Rani Sethi, a widow and a resident of East Delhi's Vivek Vihar, was looking for tenants for her newly purchased flats in Block-D. She was contacted by two men, Sachin and Sanjay, who wanted to shift to the flats "urgently", according to officers.

Sachin allegedly introduced himself as the owner of a metal

trading company, Jagdamba Metals, and said Sanjay was his associate. "I had rented out the flat on the second-floor to Sachin for around Rs 47,000 and the smaller one on the third to Sanjay for Rs 17,000. The rent deeds were registered at the Sub-Registrar's office. After some time, both of them left," Usha told police.

She had almost forgotten about the two men until April 2013 when two Supreme Court advocates knocked on her door.

They said she had allegedly taken a loan of Rs 70 lakh against her flats from the Punjab and Sind Bank and hadn't paid her dues. Usha approached the police who later found loans worth a total of Rs 18 crore were availed, using her documents bearing her name, in the name of different companies for running businesses. The money was then routed through 11 shell companies and then cashed out.

"They claimed that she had transferred the sale deed

(ownership) of the property to accused Sachin. He had, however, produced documents bearing Usha's name to avail loans. She saw the documents, and found there was a copy of a PAN card bearing her name, but a different picture. The signatures were not hers either," said a police officer.

When police officers visited the Sub-Registrar's office, they were told that a woman, who identified herself as Usha, had visited the office in February,

and submitted the documents. Officers, however, learned that it was not the woman whose photo was on the PAN card.

Officers found Sachin never intended to live in Usha's flat. He just wanted a rent agreement so they could get the details of the property and of Usha that he could use later to obtain loans, mortgages and an overdraft.

"The accused managed to source the PAN card of another Usha Rani Sethi from Odisha. This person had no connection

with the complainant. They then hired another woman who went to the Sub-Registrar office impersonating Usha. The accused bypassed the document-verification mechanism at the Sub-Registrar's office," a senior officer said.

When police saw the sale deed, a new name cropped up. The property had been transferred to Sachin, but loans amounting to a total of Rs 18 crore had been taken by him and his brother-in-law Sanjeev

Dixit, in the name of Jagdamba Metals.

After the case went cold, a team at the EOW of Delhi Police led by Additional CP Ravi Kumar and SI Rahul started scanning the documents again and as months of investigation found that Dixit had multiple aliases. "In 2011, Dixit was booked by the CBI in a cheating case. He was also involved in 10 other cases, including ones under the Prevention of Corruption Act registered with the

CBI and the ACB," said a police officer. In 2017, Dixit was arrested by the UP Police. He managed to escape while being escorted for production before a court. After almost a decade of hiding in cities across India, he was arrested again in January this year by the CBI and was lodged in Tihar jail.

On June 25, he was arrested again, while search for his brother-in-law Sachin is still on. Police did not confirm Sanjay's involvement in the case.



Govt. of Uttarakhand



GAURAV, VIKAS AUR SANKALP KA PARV



Devbhoomi

Uttarakhand

VIKAS BHI, VIRASAT BHI



"The Honorable Prime Minister has called the third decade of the 21st century the decade of Uttarakhand. In line with the Prime Minister's vision, we are working with an uncompromised resolve a 'Vikalp Rahit Sankalp' to make the state an exemplary state in every field."

PUSHKAR SINGH DHAMI, Chief Minister, Uttarakhand

"There are two major pillars in building the developed India of the 21st century. First, taking pride in our heritage, and second, making every possible effort for development. Today, Uttarakhand is continuously strengthening both of these pillars. This decade is Uttarakhand's decade."

NARENDRA MODI, Prime Minister

Foundation Stone Laid for Iconic Ropeway Projects

The foundation stone has been laid for the construction of ropeways from Gaurikund to Kedarnath and Govindghat to Hemkund Sahib. "The 12.9 km ropeway from Sonprayag to Kedarnath will be constructed at a cost of ₹4,081 crore, while the 12.4 km ropeway from Govindghat to Hemkund Sahib will be built at a cost of ₹2,730 crore.

Expansion of Air Services

An additional terminal has been constructed at the Dehradun Airport. Regular flight services have commenced from Dehradun Airport to major Indian cities, including Ahmedabad, Bhubaneswar, Bengaluru, Mumbai, Kolkata, Delhi, Shamshabad, Jaipur, Lucknow, Pune, and Kullu.

Agricultural & Industrial Development

The Central Government has sanctioned a fund of ₹25 crore for farm fencing in the state. The Central Government has transferred 45.33 of land belonging to the HMT Factory in Haldwani (Ranibagh) to the Government of Uttarakhand.

Roads and Corridors

Approval has been granted for the construction of the proposed Rispana and Bindal Elevated Corridor projects to alleviate growing traffic congestion in Dehradun city. The Prime Minister dedicated to the nation the 210 km long Delhi-Dehradun Economic Corridor, built at a cost of ₹11,963 crore. The Central Government has approved ₹1,105 crore for the construction of the 12.67 km long, 4-lane Rishikesh Bypass.

Railway Expansion

Uttarakhand welcomes two Vande Bharat Express trains, making travel from Dehradun to Delhi and Dehradun to Lucknow highly convenient. "Train operations have been approved for routes connecting Lalkuan to Amritsar Junction, and Dehradun to Tanakpur. Construction of the Rishikesh - Karnaprayag rail line is progressing rapidly, with 72.5% of the work already completed. Approval has been granted for the survey of the Tanakpur- Bageshwar rail route; work on the project's Detailed Project Report (DPR) is underway at a swift pace.

NEW DIMENSIONS OF DEVELOPMENT

Development Initiatives Dedicated to Nation Building



Uttarakhand allocated ₹4,769 crore under the Rail Budget in the Union Budget 2026-27.

The chardham shrines have been connected with an all-weather road built at a cost of over ₹12,000 crore, making travel across the mountains smooth and hassle-free.

Uttarakhand secured the first position among small states in the Export Preparedness Index 2024 released by NITI Aayog.

The Jamrani Dam project received approval from the Central Government. To be constructed at a cost of ₹3,678.23 crore, the project is slated for completion by June 2029.

To economically empower women, more than 2 lakh 54 thousand women in the state have successfully become 'Lakshpati Didis'.

A dedicated Rafting Base Station will be built in Rishikesh, for which the Central Government has sanctioned ₹100 crore.

The National Games were hosted in the state for the very first time.

Tourism, Culture & Sports

Work is progressing rapidly under the Master Plans for Kedarnath and Badrinath Dham. Development projects worth ₹255 crore are underway to transform Badrinath Dham into a smart spiritual hill town. The grand construction of the Yamuna Teerth Sthal in Haripur Kalsi is currently underway. A fund of ₹500 crore has been released to kickstart preparations for the upcoming Kumbh Mela 2027 in Uttarakhand.

Health & Social Welfare

A total of 61 lakh Ayushman cards have been generated in the state under the Atal Ayushman Yojana. So far, over 17 lakh patients have benefited from cashless treatment worth more than ₹3,400 crore. Construction of the AIIMS Satellite Centre in Kichha is in full swing, with 85% of the project already completed. Under the Vibrant Villages Programme, around 200 development projects are being executed across 51 border villages at a cost of over ₹270 crore.

Water Resources & Disaster Management

The Song River Dam Drinking Water Project has received approval from the Central Government. Being constructed at a total cost of ₹2,520.86 crore, this project will supply 150 Million Liters per Day of drinking water to Dehradun city and its suburban areas. For the mitigation of landslide-prone sites, Uttarakhand has received a central assistance of ₹113.90 crore under the ₹461 crore State Disaster Mitigation Fund.

National Achievements & Good Governance

Uttarakhand secured the 1st rank across the country in the Sustainable Development Goals (SDG) India Index 2023-24 released by NITI Aayog. On the occasion of National Startup Day, the Department of Industries, Government of Uttarakhand, was awarded a Certificate of Appreciation for its outstanding performance in the startup ecosystem. The Central Government has sanctioned an incentive of ₹264.5 crore to Uttarakhand for implementing various reforms initiated by the Urban Development and Housing Department. Uttarakhand delivered an outstanding performance in mining sector reforms, securing the 2nd position in the country, for which the Central Government has released an incentive bonus of ₹200 crore."



When we come from our hometowns to Devbhoomi for the Chardham Yatra, we do so with a resolve in our hearts. In the same spirit, I would also like to urge you to take five resolves: Narendra Modi

First Resolve : Cleanliness is paramount.

Second Resolve : Sensitivity toward nature and the environment.

Third Resolve : Emphasis on service, cooperation, & unity.

Fourth Resolve : Promotion of 'Vocal for Local'.

Fifth Resolve : Adherence to discipline, safety, & decorum.



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New Delhi

3-decade-old problem resolved, says Shah as Rajasthan, Haryana sign Yamuna water-sharing pact

Express News Service
New Delhi, Chandigarh,
June 29

RAJASTHAN AND Haryana signed a memorandum of understanding (MoU) on Monday to operationalise water-sharing in accordance with the 1994 Upper Yamuna River Board Agreement.

Under the MoU, approximately 580 million cubic metres (MCM) of water will be supplied from the Yamuna Canal to Rajasthan through three underground pipelines for four months — July to October — every year. The agreement was signed between Rajasthan Chief Minister Bhajan Lal Sharma and his Haryana counterpart Nayab Singh Saini in the presence of Union Home Minister Amit Shah and Union Jal Shakti Minister C R Patil.

Speaking on the occasion, Shah said the agreement has “resolved the nearly three-decade-old water-related problem faced by the people of Haryana and Rajasthan”. “He [Amit Shah] said this agreement is an excellent example of the mantra ‘Solution through Dialogue’, given by Prime Minister Narendra Modi. This agreement demonstrates that if states move forward with the spirit of cooperative federalism, even a problem persisting for three decades can be resolved easily,” the Home Ministry said.

According to the MHA statement, three underground pipelines with a diameter of over 3.6 metres each will provide drinking water to the people of both Rajasthan and Haryana. “Following this agreement, drinking water will be supplied to the districts of Sikar, Churu and Jhunjhunu in Rajasthan, as well as the Bhiwani and Fatehabad areas in Haryana.” Surplus monsoon water between July and October will be released through the canal. “The water that was earlier going to waste will now quench people’s thirst and be stored in large ponds to recharge groundwater,” Shah said.

Retired irrigation department officials and experts as-



Haryana CM Nayab Singh Saini (right) & his Rajasthan counterpart Bhajan Lal Sharma sign the water-sharing pact in the presence of Union ministers Amit Shah and C R Patil, in New Delhi on Monday. PTI

E. EXPLAINED

What was the 1994 agreement?

The Upper Yamuna River Board Agreement was signed on May 12, 1994, by the Yamuna basin states regarding the allocation of the surface flow of the Yamuna river. The agreement allocated Yamuna waters to Haryana 40.6%, Uttar Pradesh 35.1%, Rajasthan 10.4%, Delhi 6.3% and Himachal Pradesh 1.7%. After its creation in 2000, Uttarakhand was also included in the MoU.

sociated with the Yamuna campaign have warned that diverting surplus water from the river to Rajasthan could reduce groundwater recharge in six Haryana districts — Yamunanagar, Karnal, Panipat, Sonapat, Fariabad, and Palwal. Excess river water that previously percolated into the ground in these areas during monsoon is expected to be diverted. They argued that Haryana is facing water scarcity and the surplus water could instead have been utilised in the state’s southern districts.

The statement released by the Home Ministry, however, stated that the agreement has carefully addressed financial

responsibilities, water allocation, cost-sharing, water release protocols and maintenance arrangements. It said that the framework of the agreement, prepared by Haryana, Rajasthan, and especially the Central Water Commission (CWC), will stand as a dispute-free agreement for many decades to come. Lauding the efforts of Patil, Shah said the resolution was achieved in just a few days.

Patil said on X, “A historic agreement regarding the sharing of Yamuna water was signed today between Rajasthan and Haryana. This marks a significant step towards the equitable and improved management of water resources under the leadership of Hon’ble Prime Minister Shri Narendra Modi... Under this agreement, a consensus has been reached to provide Rajasthan with its share of Yamuna water, in accordance with the 1994 Upper Yamuna River Board Agreement, and to establish the necessary arrangements for its conveyance to the state.”

Union government officials said the MoU would accelerate the construction of the Renuka, Kishau and Lakhwar dams, envisaged by the 1994 agreement. Officials also said the two states would construct nearly 300 km of underground pipelines from Hathini Kund in Haryana to Rajasthan to facilitate the transfer of water. “The project is estimated to cost around Rs 3,900 crore...,” an official said.

Mamata era OBC quota law amended, cracks appear among rebels in House

Atri Mitra
Kolkata, June 29

THE WEST Bengal Assembly on Monday passed two Bills amending the laws enacted by the previous TMC government on OBC reservation in the state.

With the passage of the two Bills — The West Bengal Backward Classes (Other than Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes) (Reservation of Vacancies in Services and Posts) (Amendment) Bill, 2026; and The West Bengal Commission for Backward Classes (Amendment) Bill, 2026 — the reservation will now be given to 66 classes under the OBC category. Also, through the two Bills, the government has revised the OBC quota from 17 per cent to 7 per cent in line with the Calcutta High Court’s directives.

Introducing the Bills, Minister for Backward Classes Welfare Gaurishankar Ghosh said the BJP government was acting in accordance with the High Court directions and said there were no political motives behind the amendments. “We have removed 113 classes in-



CM Suwendu Adhikari pays tribute to educationalist and lawyer Ashutosh Mukherjee on his 163rd birth anniversary on Monday. ANI

cluded earlier without conducting any field survey, and retained 66 sub-classes, which were included following various surveys,” Ghosh told the House.

“The Backward Classes Commission will conduct inquiries, and if it feels any community should be included, it can make recommendations for the state government’s consideration. The previous TMC government had bypassed the Commission, and that is why the High Court struck down the

process,” he said.

Speaking in support of the Bills, the BJP MLA from Dum Dum, Arijit Bakshi, hit out at the previous TMC government, accusing it of creating the OBC list to “solely appease the minority community and secure its vote bank, thereby depriving the genuinely backward sections”.

While the passage of the Bills showed a rare realignment of both the TMC factions — loyalists of former CM Mamata Banerjee and rebels led by Rita-

brata Banerjee — it also exposed chinks in the rebel group.

Soon after the two Bills were introduced, ISF MLA Naushad Siddiqui objected to the voice vote and demanded the division of votes.

Opposing the Bills, TMC MLAs Javed Khan and Sabina Yasmin, also demanded division of votes. Agreeing to their demands, Speaker Rathindra Basu allowed the division of votes.

However, soon after, the rebel TMC MLAs walked out of the House, even as a few of them stayed inside. Kajal Sheikh, Bararul Islam, Byron Biswas, Pannalal Halder, and Tausifur Rahman — all from the rebel TMC faction — remained seated in the House, disregarding the group’s decision. On the other hand, Mamata loyalists like Sobhandeb Chatterjee, Biman Banerjee, Kunal Ghosh, Alifa Ahmed, and Pulak Roy stayed and voted against the Bills.

A total of 186 votes were cast in favour of the two Bills, and 17 votes were cast against them — including one from the rebel TMC faction.

Suwendu sets ball rolling for UCC, panel to examine draft

Kolkata: Asserting that the newly elected BJP government is committed to implementing the UCC in West Bengal, Chief Minister Suwendu Adhikari on Monday said he was “not in a hurry” and that a draft Bill pertaining to it will be taken up by the Cabinet on July 2.

Speaking in the Assembly during the ongoing Budget Session, the CM said that a committee, led by retired Supreme Court judge Ranjana Prakash Desai, will look into the draft UCC Bill and propose changes. “We are not in a rush. The UCC will definitely be implemented in Bengal. There is a specific process for it... We will bring this (UCC) Bill after examining the examples of Uttarakhand, Gujarat, and Assam. Ancient tribal communities and indigenous people will remain outside the purview of the Bill,” he said. **ENS**

INDIA-PAK ‘TRACK 2 DIALOGUE’

Misri: India doesn’t take cognisance of such events

Press Trust of India
New Delhi, June 29

FOREIGN SECRETARY Vikram Misri on Monday said the government has no involvement with retired diplomats and military officials participating in overseas discussions on India-Pakistan ties in their personal capacities and that New Delhi does not even take cognisance of such deliberations.

Misri’s remarks to the media at Victoria in Seychelles came in the wake of reports that Indian and Pakistani experts comprising retired military officials, diplomats and politicians participated in Track 2 discussions on

the sidelines of a regional security conference in Colombo last week. “Dozens of these kinds of events take place in dozens of places around the world on a whole variety of subjects. There’s nothing new, nothing special about these events,” the foreign secretary said.

“...these are private events organised by private parties. There is nothing official about them.” The foreign secretary was responding to a media query. “Obviously, I cannot speak for the government of Pakistan, but as far as the government of India is concerned, there is no official participation, no official support or involvement, in these visits.

CJI: Rule of law disciplines exercise of power, ensures none left vulnerable

Express News Service
New Delhi, June 29

COURTS “CANNOT” be mere spectators in the constitutional order”; they “must remain vigilant guardians of constitutional supremacy, ensuring that no exercise of public power escapes the sustained discipline of law”, Chief Justice of India Surya Kant said on Monday.

He was addressing an event organised by the International Institute for Democracy and Electoral Assistance in Sweden.

Speaking on the topic ‘Safeguarding the Rule of Law — Experiences from India and Sweden’, the CJI said the “rule of law...disciplines the exercise of power” and “ensures that

public authority acts through known, stable and general rules; that citizens are treated as equals before the law; and that no person is left vulnerable to the whims of arbitrary government”.

CJI Kant underlined that “the endurance of a constitutional democracy rests upon the fidelity of the Executive and the Legislature to constitutional norms” and “the greatest safeguard to ensuring that these two pillars fulfil their duty lies in an independent Judiciary”.

He pointed out that the Indian Constitution “provides a very wide spectrum to the rule of law and has eloquently entrusted the responsibility for its enforcement to various consti-

tutional organs. In addition to declaring the Judiciary as the final arbiter, duly vested with the power of judicial review, it has also cast responsibility on other institutions to play a constructive role in safeguarding federalism, democracy, separation of powers, harmonious functioning of public institutions and, most importantly, in working towards implementing the Constitution and making its provisions effective”.

The CJI shed light on “how, when confronted with moments of grave crisis and profound human suffering, the constitutional courts in India have fashioned pioneering doctrines to restrain public power and broaden access to justice”.

Allied Healthcare

CAREERS BEYOND MEDICINE

Allied Healthcare Education: Evolving with Technology to Meet Tomorrow's Healthcare Needs

HEALTHCARE has undergone a remarkable transformation over the past few decades, and so has allied healthcare education. Traditionally viewed as a support system to mainstream medicine, allied healthcare once focused primarily on technical and diagnostic services such as laboratory testing, radiography, physiotherapy, and operation theatre assistance. However, with rapid advancements in medical science, changing patient needs, and the integration of digital technologies, allied healthcare has emerged as one of the most dynamic and indispensable pillars of modern healthcare.

Today, allied healthcare professionals are central to every stage of patient care—from disease prevention and diagnosis to treatment, rehabilitation, and long-term wellness. India’s expanding healthcare ecosystem, coupled with an ageing population, rising incidence of lifestyle diseases, and growing emphasis on preventive healthcare, has significantly increased the demand for skilled allied health professionals. This shift has also elevated the importance of allied healthcare education, which is now designed to produce competent professionals capable of meeting the evolving needs of the healthcare industry.

Educational institutions are moving beyond conventional classroom teaching to competency-based learning, simulation laboratories, interdisciplinary training, and extensive clinical exposure. Curricula now incorporate digital health, electronic medical records, telemedicine, medical data interpretation, and advanced diagnostic technologies, ensuring graduates are industry-ready from day one.

The emergence of Artificial Intelligence (AI) has further accelerated this transformation. AI-powered tools are now capable of analysing medical images, automating laboratory workflows, predicting disease risks, and assisting clinicians in faster decision-making. While these innovations have raised concerns about automation replacing jobs, the reality is quite different. AI is enhancing healthcare delivery rather than replacing healthcare professionals.

The role of allied healthcare professionals is becoming more specialised and technology-driven. Radiology technologists now work alongside AI-assisted imaging systems, laboratory professionals validate automated diagnostic reports, physiotherapists use digital rehabilitation technologies, and emergency care specialists rely on smart monitoring systems. Human expertise remains essential to interpret findings, make clinical judgments, communicate with patients, and deliver compassionate care—areas where technology cannot replace human intervention.

Consequently, career opportunities in allied healthcare are expanding rapidly. Graduates can find rewarding careers in multispecialty hospitals, diagnostic laboratories, rehabilitation centres, public health organisations, sports medicine facilities, research institutions, telehealth companies, medical device industries, and home healthcare services. The increasing global demand for skilled allied health professionals has also created opportunities for international careers and higher education.

With healthcare becoming increasingly technology-enabled, employers now seek professionals who possess a combination of clinical knowledge, digital literacy, adaptability, and problem-solving skills. Allied healthcare education has evolved to meet these expectations, making it one of the most future-ready fields of study.

As healthcare continues to embrace innovation, allied healthcare professionals will remain at the heart of quality patient care. Rather than competing with AI, they will work alongside intelligent technologies to deliver faster, safer, and more personalised healthcare—making allied healthcare education one of the most relevant and promising career pathways of the future.

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HEALTHCARE is undergoing rapid transformation. Advances in medicine, an ageing population, and a growing focus on preventive care, rehabilitation, nutrition, and mental well-being have significantly expanded the role of allied healthcare professionals. Today, they are indispensable to the healthcare ecosystem, making quality education more important than ever.

The National Commission for Allied and Healthcare Professions (NCAHP) has introduced nationally benchmarked

standards that emphasize competency, clinical proficiency, ethical practice, and outcome-based learning. These reforms reinforce the need to prepare professionals who are equipped to meet the evolving demands of modern healthcare. At Manav Rachna International Institute of Research & Studies (a NAAC A++

Accredited Deemed-to-be University in the NIRF Top 100), the NCAHP-aligned Allied Health Sciences programmes reflect this vision. Students pursuing Physiotherapy, Nutrition & Dietetics, and Psychology benefit from an integrated learning environment where academic knowledge is complemented by hands-on clinical experience.

Through early clinical exposure at the institution’s Multi-Specialty OPD, the Manovriti Wellness Centre, the Centre for Rehabilitation Psychology, and col-

laborations with leading healthcare institutions, students gain the confidence, competence, and clinical judgement required for professional practice.

The focus extends beyond employability to developing healthcare professionals who can make informed decisions, deliver compassionate care, and contribute meaningfully to society. At Manav Rachna, the future of healthcare begins with education that is designed to shape capable professionals from Day One.

epaper.indianexpress.com

New Delhi



The new age of design: Shaping careers, creating opportunities

As technology reshapes the world, designers are becoming the architects of products, services, brands, and experiences that define the future of business and society.

When you unlock your phone, order things online, navigate a station, everything you are interacting with is a design. Not the kind of design visible in art galleries, but the one that simply resolves your query, improves user experiences, and influences decisions. Today, design is no longer confined to studios or drawing boards. It has become a language through which businesses innovate, healthcare becomes accessible, governments improve public services, and technology becomes more human. Whether it's about creating intuitive digital experiences or building sustainable products and immersive virtual worlds, designers are helping to shape how we live, work, and connect.

The new engine of innovation

The design landscape is changing rapidly, expanding into areas that didn't exist earlier. As industries are digitalizing, there are numerous creations of job opportunities. What we are witnessing is a transition from static medium to dynamic and interactive ecosystems. The evolution is driven by a massive democratization of digital access, creating an unmatched global demand for creative professionals who can make complex systems feel effortlessly simple. Students who are going to be a part of this in the future will experience a marketplace that rewards fresh perspectives with robust, high-growth career trajectories.

Driving innovation through strategy

In today's time and age, design extends far beyond traditional creative disciplines. It has secured a permanent seat in the corporate landscape and plays a vital role in core business strategy, organisational innovation, and digital transformation across sectors like fintech, healthcare, and e-commerce. Organisations around the globe have realised that a superior user experience is no longer a luxury; it is their strongest competitive advantage. Whether a well-established company is undergoing digital transformation or a startup is launching a disruptive platform, design is the tool used to decode consumer behaviour, de-risk multi-million-dollar decisions, and translate complex technologies into accessible human experiences.



Navigating career pathways

The scope of design careers has increased drastically. It is no longer limited to conventional fields such as graphic or fashion design. Specialisations such as UI/UX design, product design, interaction design, animation and motion graphics, game design, digital media, branding and visual communication, service design, design research, creative technology, sustainable and circular design, as well as AR/VR and immersive media are redefining the profession. These disciplines are shaping everything from digital products and customer experiences to sustainable solutions and virtual environments.

Therefore, as a result, design graduates are no longer confined to creative agencies or design studios. They are increasingly sought after

across sectors, including information technology, e-commerce, healthcare, automotive, education, entertainment, consulting, fintech, and many more, where they contribute to innovation, user experience, product development, and business strategy.

Technology redefining the course of design

New technologies such as artificial intelligence and virtual reality are completely changing the design world. Rather than over-taking the jobs, AI tools are replacing the boring, repetitive tasks, like resizing images or cleaning up files. This allows the designers to focus on big ideas and creative strategies.

In order to succeed tomorrow, young designers must learn how to work alongside AI. Simultane-

ously, the rise of VR means designers are moving away from flat computer screens. Instead, they are learning "spatial design," which is the art of building immersive, 3D worlds that users can actually step inside.

Building the right skill set

As the industry is evolving, what hiring managers are looking for is more than software proficiency. The employers are seeking people who know how to think deeply and understand human behaviour. They look for individuals who are good problem-solvers, can handle challenges, and keep testing new ideas. Besides, a modern designer should also have an understanding of;

- Creativity and innovation
- Design thinking and problem-solving
- User-centred research and empathy

- Visual storytelling and communication
- Collaboration across multi-disciplinary teams
- Digital design tools and software proficiency
- Understanding of AI-powered workflows

The power of interdisciplinary learning

One of the defining moments of design education is its interdisciplinary learning. The modern educational landscape places a growing importance on it, wherein designers increasingly intersect with technology, business, and sustainability. A designer who has an understanding of data analytics can build more effective user interfaces, who can understand business models, and can build viable products, while those who have proper knowledge about material science can champion true eco-innovation. This cross-disciplinary learning ensures that graduates are no longer simply creative executors but versatile strategists who are capable of navigating complex corporate landscapes.

A growing career landscape

The demand for skilled designers continues to grow increasingly in India and globally. Driven by a massive base of internet users and a roaring startup ecosystem, Indian enterprises are hiring design talent aggressively, with premier institutes seeing unprecedented corporate interest.

Globally, organisations are investing heavily in user experience, product innovation, sustainability, and digital transformation, all of which are areas where designers play a central role.

Freelancing, remote work, entrepreneurship, and global collaborations have further expanded career possibilities, enabling designers to work across borders and industries.

Building tomorrow's designers

In a world where technology is advancing at an unprecedented pace, the future belongs to those who can imagine possibilities and turn them into meaningful experiences. As industries are becoming more interconnected and technology reshapes the way we live and work, design is emerging as a bridge between human needs and technological innovation.

As the boundaries between design, technology, business, and sustainability continue to blur, the profession will become more relevant in the coming times. The future is vast and full of opportunities to innovate and inspire. In the years ahead, success will not belong only to those who build the future but also to those who will design it.

SGT UNIVERSITY

From Sketches to Smart Design: AI is Shaping the Future of Design

Artificial Intelligence (AI) is revolutionizing the design industry, transforming the way ideas are imagined, developed, and brought to life. From generating trend forecasts and visual identities to creating interactive animations and smart products, AI is becoming an indispensable tool for aspiring designers. As industries increasingly adopt AI-driven frameworks, design education is expanding its scope to prepare students for the future of the profession.

Recognizing this transformation, SGT University's School of Design has integrated AI into its conventional design curriculum to equip students with industry-relevant skills while nurturing creativity, innovation, and human-centric design thinking.

Under the mentorship of expert faculty members with strong industry and academic backgrounds, students across all design disciplines are exposed to AI-powered tools, digital technologies, and hands-on learning experiences that complement their core design education.

Fashion Design students explore AI applications in trend forecasting, digital illustration, garment visualization, supply chain management, and sustainable material research, enabling them to create smart fashion solutions and innovative finishes.

In Furniture & Interior Design, students leverage AI tools for smart space planning, parametric furniture modelling, lighting simulations, and sustainable interior solutions.

For Communication Design, AI-integrated software supports branding, typography, visual storytelling, UX/UI design, digital content creation, and creative ideation, enabling students to develop unique artistic visions enhanced by advanced digital capabilities.

Product Design students explore AI-driven conceptualization, rapid



prototyping, ergonomic analysis, design optimization, and user behaviour research to develop innovative products that address real-world challenges.

Meanwhile, Animation & VFX students are introduced to AI applications in character development, motion capture enhancement, environment generation, visual effects, 3D workflows, and storytelling, preparing them for the rapidly evolving entertainment and gaming industries.

Beyond the classroom, the university encourages students to participate in workshops, industry collaborations, design exhibitions, and competitions, providing interdisciplinary learning opportunities and exposure to emerging technologies aligned with industry requirements.

By integrating creative excellence with technological advancement, SGT University ensures that its graduates leave not only with strong technical skills but also as adaptable innovators capable of thriving in an AI-driven design landscape. As the design profession continues to evolve with intelligent technologies, the School of Design remains committed to fostering imagination, critical thinking, ethical innovation, and lifelong learning—empowering students to shape a future where creativity and technology work hand in hand.

JS INSTITUTE OF DESIGN

Designing Experiences That Shape the Future

Design is all around us. It shapes the spaces we walk into, the apps we navigate, the stories we immerse ourselves in, and the products we use every day. At its core, design isn't just about making things look good—it's about creating experiences that are intuitive, meaningful, and memorable.

Today's designers are storytellers, problem-solvers, and experience builders. They understand people, anticipate needs, and create solutions that influence how we live, work, learn, and connect. Whether designing immersive game worlds or thoughtfully planned interiors, great design creates context and transforms everyday interactions.

This philosophy lies at the heart of JS Institute of Design (JSID). Through programmes like Game Art & Design and Interior Design, students learn to combine creativity with strategy, technology, and human-centred thinking to build experiences that have real-



Professor Nien Siao
Dean of the JS Institute of Design



world impact.

In academic alliance with France's École Intuit Lab, JSID offers a globally informed design education rooted in industry practice. Students are encouraged to think critically, tell compelling stories, and design for a rapidly evolving world.

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I refused to keep art on walls and designed an experience people inhabit.

AALAYA CHANDOLA
UG, Game Art & Design
École Intuit Lab Delhi

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House Veteran

AT THE oath-taking ceremony of Congress chief Mallikarjun Kharge, who was re-elected to the Rajya Sabha, Leader of the House J P Nadda and Ministers Kiren Rijiju, Arjun Ram Meghwal and L Murugan were engaged in a discussion over the LoP's political career. Rijiju asked how many years Kharge had completed in Parliament, to which Meghwal recalled that it was his fourth term — two stints in the Lok Sabha and the second term in the Rajya Sabha. Nadda added that before Parliament, Kharge had completed nine terms in the Karnataka Assembly. Rijiju said he too would have been in his fifth term in the Lok Sabha had the Congress not defeated him in 2009. Rijiju, who made his Lok Sabha debut in 2004, lost to Congress candidate Takam Sanjoy from the Arunachal West constituency.

Appraisal Rush

IT'S APPRAISAL time in the government, and for the first time, everyone from drivers to senior IAS officers have to pass three training courses before they can submit their Annual Performance Appraisal Reports (APAR). Ahead of the June 30 deadline for Central government employees and All-India Services officers to complete their form submission, officials have been in a rush to complete the mandatory courses on the government's iGOT portal over the past week, it is learnt.

1 bloc, 2 camps

AS THE Ram Temple donations row escalates, a UP Congress delegation, led by PCC president Ajay Rai and comprising senior party leaders, is planning to visit the temple on Tuesday morning. Interestingly, while the SP has named its campaign against the alleged embezzlement "chanda chori (donation theft)", the Congress is calling it "chadhawa chori (theft of offerings)". Although the two parties are allies for the upcoming UP elections, their leaders are adamant about continuing with the different names for their campaign against the BJP government.

India condemns Pak for strikes on Afghanistan that killed 36

Divya A
New Delhi, June 29

CONDEMNING AIR strikes by Pakistan on Afghan territory, India has said that aggression by Pakistan is a direct threat to regional peace and stability. As tensions between the two countries escalated, overnight Pakistani strikes have killed at least 36 civilians in Afghanistan and wounded more than 160 others, as per Afghan officials. In a statement on Monday, the MEA said India strongly condemns Pakistan's air strikes on Afghan territory that have resulted in several civilian casualties, including women and children. "This blatant act of aggression by Pakistan is an assault on Afghanistan's sovereignty and a direct threat to regional peace and stability," it added. It reflects Pakistan's persistent pattern of reckless behaviour and its futile attempt to "externalise" internal failures through desperate acts of violence beyond its borders, the statement said. India also conveyed its condolences to Afghan families.

PM set to meet top officials today; deregulation, reforms on agenda

Harikishan Sharma
New Delhi, June 29

IN HIS second interaction with the top bureaucracy in just over a month, PM Narendra Modi is likely to hold a meeting with all the Central Secretaries on Tuesday to discuss deregulation and other reforms that his government has been advocating to improve the 'ease of doing business' and 'ease of living', *The Indian Express* has learnt.

On May 21, Modi had chaired a joint meeting of the Union Council of Ministers and Central Secretaries to develop regulatory roadmaps to realise the vision of a Viksit Bharat.

In a post on X, the Prime Minister had said the Council of Ministers "exchanged per-



Prime Minister Narendra Modi with Seychelles Vice President Sebastien Pillay as he departs for Delhi, in Victoria, Monday. ANI

spectives and best practices relating to boosting ease of living, ease of doing business and how

to further reforms in order to realise the shared dream of a Viksit Bharat".

At the meeting on Tuesday, it is learnt that each Secretary will be given three minutes to brief Modi — on what they have done, and what they can do for implementation of the deregulation and reform agenda. The meeting is also likely to discuss measures to promote Atmanirbharta (self reliance).

The NDA government has been pushing for deregulation and reforms at the Centre as well as the States. Separate committees have been set up for the purpose.

One of these committees is chaired by former Cabinet Secretary and NITI Aayog member Rajiv Gauba. The Cabinet Secretariat constituted the High-Level Committee on Non-Financial Regulatory Reforms (HLC-NFRF) under Gauba on

August 19, 2025. The committee has been mandated to review existing non-financial sector regulations, certifications, licences, and permissions to develop a modern, flexible, people-friendly, and trust-based regulatory framework suited to the needs of the 21st century. The committee has been sharing its recommendations with the departments concerned.

The second panel — Task Force on Deregulation and Compliance Reduction — is led by Bihar-cadre IAS officer K K Pathak, who is currently posted as Special Secretary at the Cabinet Secretariat. This committee was also constituted last year.

The Cabinet Secretariat has also assigned selected Secretaries to some States to push deregulation at the State level.

Rajnath releases DFP-2026 for timely execution of R&D projects, efficiency

Amrita Nayak Dutta
New Delhi, June 29

DEFENCE MINISTER Rajnath Singh on Monday released the Delegation of Financial Powers to DRDO (DFP-2026), a major reform aimed at enhancing efficiency, accountability, and timely execution of strategic defence research and development (R&D) projects.

This comes at a time when the DRDO is actively pursuing critical military projects, such as Project Kusha, AGNI series of ICBMs, Netra Airborne Early Warning and Control systems and Advanced Medium Combat Aircraft (AMCA), among others. Enhanced and simplified financial delegations will aid DRDO with the means to streamline and execute key projects faster.

In a Defence Ministry statement, Singh said the DFP-2026 will facilitate faster production and induction of systems, platforms and technologies emerging from the R&D ecosystem into the Defence Forces.

He said the new framework will foster stronger collaboration with industry and academia, reinforcing the vision of Aatmanirbhar Bharat. The revised framework will con-

tribute to enhanced self-reliance in defence technologies and strengthen the nation's defence preparedness, he added.

The DFP-2026 aims to significantly enhance functional empowerment at various levels within the Department of Defence R&D.

The statement noted that the revised framework addresses several critical requirements, including dedicated financial provisions for trial campaigns, tests and evaluation activities, authorisation for sanctioning pre-project R&D initiatives, and clear segregation of financial powers for grants-in-aid on Extra-Mural Research Projects, Defence Innovation Accelerator-Centres of Excellence, and Technology Development Fund projects under the respective schedules.

The development comes weeks after Singh released the revised Delegation of Financial Powers (DFPDS-2026) for the Armed Forces, which includes a two-fold increase in financial ceiling for field commanders to improve operational efficiency, while also enhancing financial delegation to support revenue procurements exceeding Rs 1.25 lakh crore.

Gen Z doesn't have 'tukde tukde' mindset, believes in our country: Nabin

Nikhila Henry
Hyderabad, June 29

BJP chief Nitin Nabin said on Monday that "some opposition forces want to incite youth by copying Gen-Z movements from other countries".

At the Viksit Bharat Students Conclave at an educational institution in Hyderabad, Nabin told students, "No one is asking what Gen Z really wants. Today, some opposition forces want to incite the youth by copying so-called Gen Z movements from other countries. But Indian youth are not anti-establishment. Indian youth do not believe in anarchy. They believe in nation building."

"Gen Z is not the tukde-tukde mindset. Real Gen Z is the youth sitting here... who are contributing to the growth, innovation and future of Bharat," he said, adding that governments may come and go, but the bigger question is in which direction should the country move.

Without naming any particular party or outfit, Nabin said, "Those trying to incite the youth must understand that Indian youth will never allow foreign forces or negative agendas to dictate India's future."

As an example, he said, "Earlier, the image of Kashmir youth was linked to stone pelting. But in the Modi era, the youth of Kashmir are moving forward in education, sports and national service. Today, Kashmir's youth are winning on the cricket field and making the nation proud. "The real Gen Z," he said, "is not the stone pelted, but the nation builder."

Referring to the UPA rule, Nabin said "there was a sense of depression and uncertainty among youth... Everywhere they saw negativity — corruption, policy paralysis and a lack of direction." He added that the Narendra Modi government has shown that when the leadership is strong, change is possible.

EXPRESS special

'India should know, if we don't act on evidence against Israel, we can't redeem ourselves'



EXPRESS interview S MURALIDHAR FORMER ORISSA HIGH COURT CHIEF JUSTICE

cameras... The operator can clearly make out... if it is a child. How else do you explain a 10-day-old baby being shot through the head with a quadcopter?... We have so many instances where an adult carrying a child is spared, but the child is shot.

We also held oral hearings in Geneva with treating doctors. They testified to finding tiny holes on the upper parts of children's bodies. Cube-shaped pellets were precisely aimed at the head and neck... The scale is astonishing.

The Commission says it sent 13 requests for information and access to Israel, all of which went unanswered. How does the panel operate and verify evidence in such a case?

We are an investigating body, so we actively look for contra-indications. We issue public calls, and anyone from around the world can submit material. We have a highly specialised, multinational team of 12 people. This includes military analysts, cyber experts, and legal and gender experts.

If we find two children killed by gunshots, we use forensic tools, geolocation and chrono-

location to confirm the presence of Israeli soldiers... Ironically, Israel's lack of cooperation is offset by its own soldiers posting massive incriminating evidence on social media...

Furthermore, we sent our draft report to Israel weeks in advance. They never responded to us directly. Instead, they released an 18-page rebuttal... they did not deny the evidence. They didn't claim the soldiers' videos were fake... Israel arbitrarily labels boys 10, 12 or 15 years of age as terrorists. Once you label a child a terrorist, the Israeli soldier feels no need to find a reason to kill...

Israeli soldiers have stated in television interviews their commanders commended them, telling them that irrespective of the target's age, they have to kill. This is not the work of a few rogue soldiers. It is a deliberate, systematic plan.

The report concludes that Israel's actions constitute genocide. In international criminal law, proving 'genocidal intent' is notoriously difficult.

It is not just the killings. It is the taking over of agricultural land. It is the destruction of

97% of all schools and 22 out of 38 universities. It is the bombing of paediatric and neonatal facilities... You also have to look at the rhetoric from the top... Two days after the attack of October 7, 2023, Nissim Vaturi, Deputy Speaker of the Knesset, posted on social media: "Erase Gaza... Do not leave a child there. Expel all the remaining ones... so that they will not have a resurrection."

UN reports and binding ICJ orders with regard to Israel's atrocities against Palestinians are routinely ignored. Why do you believe your findings will translate into tangible justice?

We cannot lose faith in the system... For instance, there are 6,000 French, nearly 2,00 Britishers and 700 Australians currently serving in the Israeli Defence Forces. All these countries are signatories to the Rome Statute of the International Criminal Court, which places on them an obligation to prosecute their own nationals if they are involved in these atrocities...

We are also urging countries that supply arms to Israel — and India exports small arms to Israel — to cease doing so...

When Kulbhushan Jadhav was wrongly captured and denied a fair trial in Pakistan, we went to the International Court of Justice... We want international law when it comes to Wall Street rankings or maritime trade. But the moment it comes to international human rights law, politicians claim it is "foreign" to our traditions...

I really want the Indian government to look at its foreign policy and ask: Are we going to permit fundamental humanitarian principles to be given a go-by? If we fail to act on evidence as stark as this, we cannot redeem ourselves for the future.

Kolkata Police seeks ex-editor's passport application details

Kerala CM writes to Suwendu, calls for intervention

Sweetie Kumari
Kolkata, June 29

THE SPECIAL Branch of Kolkata Police has sought details of the passport application of former editor of *The Telegraph*, R Rajagopal, after he alleged his passport had not been renewed following the deletion of his name from the electoral rolls in West Bengal during the SIR.

Assuring to resolve the issue "as quickly as possible", Additional Commissioner of Police (Special Branch), Dhruvajyoti De told *The Indian Express* on Monday, "There was some issue of deletion of names of voters on the same address (Rajagopal's address). I have sought the details of the file. Voter ID card may be asked for verification, and the absence of the voter ID card may raise a question, but it is not the definitive document for local enquiry for passports. I hope to get it resolved today itself. If it is found okay, another report will be sent to RPO."

Meanwhile, Kerala CM V D Sathesnan wrote to his West Bengal counterpart Suwendu Adhikari seeking his intervention.

"I understand that the adverse report is based on the deletion of his (Rajagopal's) name from the electoral roll under the



R Rajagopal, former editor of The Telegraph

SIR. While the electoral issue is being dealt with through an appropriate appeal process, I am informed that the police report has had the effect of delaying the renewal process of his passport. I would like to request your good self to kindly look into the matter with urgency," he wrote.

Kerala Opposition Leader Pinarayi Vijayan, in a Facebook post, said the authorities' refusal to renew Rajagopal's passport was shocking. "If this is the experience of a renowned editor, one can imagine the plight of ordinary people in the country. Rajagopal might have become a victim of retaliation because he is a strong critic of BJP. SIR has turned to be a weapon for advancing the divisive Hindutva agenda," he said.

In a note on social media, Rajagopal had said he missed his daughter's wedding in the US as he did not possess an active passport. Efforts to renew his passport since then have been unsuccessful, and he has received an appointment to appear before the RPO on July 17. **WITH ENS, THIRUVANANTHAPURAM**

● VIDEO SHOWS SARATH KUMAR AT IPL MATCH IN CHENNAI HANDLING A SMALL QUANTITY OF WHITE POWDER-LIKE SUBSTANCE ON PHONE SCREEN; HE SAYS WAS CRUSHING MEDICINE FOR DAUGHTER

Why DMK has hit the streets over TVK minister's two-year-old video

Arun Janardhanan
Chennai, June 29

THE DMK on Monday mounted one of its first major street protests against Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay's government, demanding the dismissal and arrest of Human Resources Management Minister D Sarath Kumar over a resurfaced video that many allege depicts conduct that resembles drug use.

The police denied permission for the demonstration, but in Chennai, dozens of DMK workers and members of the party's students wing assembled near Rajarathinam Stadium and later staged a road blockade at Doveton in Vepery, briefly disrupting traffic. Officers detained more than 50 protesters, including party functionaries, before dispersing the gathering, citing pro-

hibitory orders. Officials said those detained were likely to be released later.

The protest was all about the Opposition party's attempt to turn a social media controversy into a political issue, arguing that a minister should be held to a higher standard, particularly amid public campaigns against narcotics.

What's the controversy?

The controversy stems from a video clip that has resurfaced online after reportedly first appearing as an Instagram story posted by Sarath Kumar about two years ago with the caption "Thug Life".

The clip, apparently re-recorded during an IPL match at Chennai's M A Chidambaram Stadium, shows the minister seated among spectators handling a small quantity of white, powder-like substance on the



DMK workers protest against TVK Minister Sarath Kumar in Chennai on Monday. Later, over 50 protesters were detained. @ARIVALAYAM/X

screen of a smartphone.

Interestingly, the video surfaced on the same day Vijay ran a "Start Run, Stop Drugs" anti-drug awareness marathon in Chennai last week, adding a strong edge to the controversy around his minister.

In the purported video, Sa-

rath Kumar appears to use an ATM card to press, scrape and gather the substance into a finer powder. A Rs 500 currency note is visible nearby, and at one point he appears to wipe or clean the card or his hand against a handle.

Many online argued that

the sequence bears a resemblance to familiar visual depictions of narcotics being prepared, prompting allegations on social media that the minister was using drugs.

The video has since triggered sharp political criticism from Opposition parties.

Minister's defence

Sarath Kumar has categorically denied the allegation, saying the substance shown was not narcotics but a medicine tablet that he crushed to administer to his sick daughter, who was with him at the match.

According to the minister, he used the card simply to crush the tablet into powder so it could be given more easily to the child. He said the clip had been stripped of its context and was being deliberately misrepresented on social media.

The allegation, therefore,

remains based on interpretations of the visuals in the video.

DMK steps up attack

Despite that clarification, the DMK intensified its attack. Its students wing announced a statewide agitation demanding Sarath Kumar's immediate dismissal from the Cabinet, arguing that a minister should not be associated with visuals that raise questions during an anti-drug campaign.

In a statement announcing Monday's protest, the organisation said combating drug abuse was a collective social responsibility and alleged that the minister's actions ran contrary to that objective. It further accused him of "hiding behind a child to play politics".

Former Health Minister MA Subramanian accused the government of suppressing democratic protests and criticised

what he described as its handling of drug-related issues. DMK spokesperson Saravanan also criticised the police action, alleging party workers attempting to make arrangements for protest had been detained overnight.

The controversy has also drawn criticism beyond the DMK. DMDK general secretary Premalatha Vijayakanth described the footage as "highly condemnable", saying public representatives should maintain proper conduct and that the emergence of the video during an anti-drug campaign was unfortunate. Separately, a woman advocate, Saranya, submitted a complaint to the Chennai City Police Commissioner seeking legal action against the minister.

With Sarath Kumar continuing to reject the allegations, the TVK has since sought to distance itself from the episode as political pressure grows.

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Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath during the 'Uttar Pradesh Global Growth Dialogue 2026', in Bengaluru

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- Through four Ground Breaking Ceremonies, projects worth ₹15+ lakh crore have already taken off, creating over 60 lakh jobs, with GBC-5 set to accelerate growth further with ₹7.5+ lakh crore investments.
- UP's Electronics Manufacturing Policy (2017) surpassed its target of ₹20,000 crore in just three years, showcasing rapid industrial momentum.
- The state is fast emerging as a pharma powerhouse, with ₹10,000 crore investments signed at Pharma Conclave 1.0.
- At global platforms like World Economic Forum 2026, UP secured ₹2.94 lakh crore MoUs across AI, data centres, renewable energy, food processing, and defence manufacturing.
- Major reforms like Nivesh Mitra 3.0, deregulation, and removal of 99% minor criminal provisions have significantly improved the Ease of Doing Business.
- For the first time in India, a dedicated investment promotion policy has been introduced to attract FDI and Fortune Global 500 companies.
- Rapid industrial infrastructure growth is visible across Greater Noida, Unnao, Bareilly, Gorakhpur, and YEIDA regions, along with mega hubs like Film City, Toy Park, Apparel Park, and Logistics Zones.

UP Global Growth Dialogue 2026

₹50,000+ Crore Investment Proposals Secured during the UP Global Growth Dialogue 2026, with 15+ companies signing MoUs in the presence of Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath.

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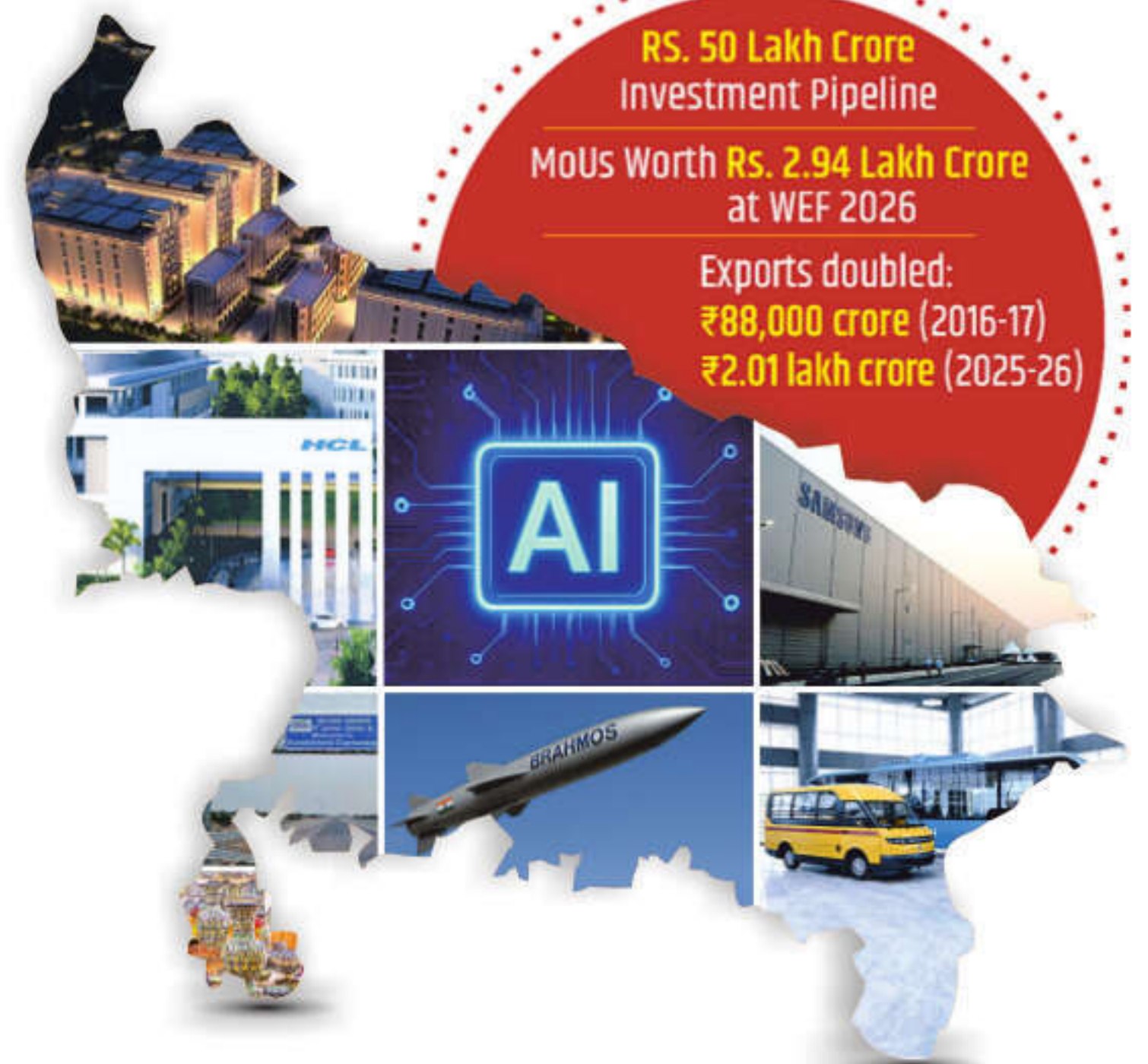
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- Emerging sector-specific clusters in Pharma (Lalitpur-Jhansi), Perfume (Kannauj), Textiles (Lucknow-Hardoi), Leather (Kanpur & Hardoi), and Chemicals (multiple cities) are powering a new industrial ecosystem.
- HCL-Foxconn's India Chip project at Jewar, Greater Noida, with an investment of around ₹3,700 crore, is set to position Uttar Pradesh at the forefront of India's semiconductor revolution. Expected to be operational by 2028, the facility will manufacture Display Driver Integrated Circuits (DDICs), strengthening the nation's drive towards technological self-reliance and global electronics leadership.



GSDP is projected to reach **₹40+ lakh crore** in 2026-27



Uttar Pradesh's New Era of Growth



CM Yogi Adityanath joins Tata Motors in marking the rollout of its 10 lakhth commercial vehicle.

- Uttar Pradesh has built a thriving startup ecosystem with 22,000+ startups, nearly 50% led by women entrepreneurs, supported by 76 incubators and 8 unicorns, marking a new benchmark in innovation and entrepreneurship.
- The state has emerged as India's A-1 "Top Performer" in Startup Rankings, leading the nation in startup ecosystem strength.
- A robust expressway-led connectivity network is driving large-scale industrial expansion across 5,300 hectares of developed industrial land, powering logistics and manufacturing growth.
- A green transformation is underway as Tata Power Renewable Energy plans 3 lakh rooftop solar installations, adding 1,000 MW clean energy capacity for a sustainable future.
- The Shreyas Group is investing ₹4,000 crore in a world-class biofuel and ATF production facility in Gorakhpur, advancing clean energy leadership.
- The upcoming Jewar MRO facility positions Uttar Pradesh as a rising hub in aviation maintenance, boosting self-reliance, skilled jobs, and global investment inflows.
- In the defence sector, the state has secured 197 MoUs worth ₹39,000 crore, expected to generate over 52,000 jobs, strengthening its strategic industrial base.



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The Indian EXPRESS

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RAMNATH GOENKA

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BECAUSE THE TRUTH INVOLVES US ALL

For peace deal, first protect ceasefire

THE FOUR-day cycle of attacks may have subsided, but it underscores how fragile the nearly two-week-old ceasefire between Iran and the US continues to be. At the centre of the renewed tensions, again, is the Strait of Hormuz. A Singapore-flagged container ship that Iran is accused of striking last Thursday was using the toll-free temporary shipping route announced by Oman in coordination with the International Maritime Organisation. The incident prompted a US military response, triggering further exchanges, with the Islamic Revolutionary Guard Corps warning that ships transiting the Strait of Hormuz must use only the “authorised route” through Iranian territorial waters. Clearly, Tehran regards control over the Strait as a strategic lever, worth risking the ceasefire for, even if preserving it could bring substantial economic relief.

Adding to the uncertainty is the ambiguous language of the Memorandum of Understanding. While it requires Iran to “make arrangements using its best efforts for the safe passage of commercial vessels” through the Strait of Hormuz for 60 days, it does not define what those “arrangements” entail. Tehran’s interpretation appears to be that it alone can determine the routes commercial ships must follow. The vague language is now being exploited, as both sides accuse the other of violating the agreement. The other problem is Lebanon. The US-brokered security agreement between Lebanon and Israel, signed on Friday, provides for a phased Israeli withdrawal from parts of the south alongside the deployment of the Lebanese Army, contingent on the dismantling of Hezbollah. Iran has, however, displayed its willingness to close the Strait and resume hostilities if it believes the agreement’s terms on Lebanon are being violated by the US and Israel. With competing interpretations of the MoU, interlinked ceasefires, continuing proxy conflicts and overlapping security arrangements all pulling in different directions, any one of these fault lines could trigger a wider conflagration.

The situation remains in flux. The fallout of the instability extends far beyond the region and the energy sector, disrupting global supply chains, and countries the world over. The economic and military costs of an escalation appear to have given both sides an incentive to seek pathways to preserve the ceasefire framework. Sustained diplomatic engagement and a shared commitment to resolving the differences will be needed to prevent a spiralling of the conflict. This will be tested on Tuesday in Qatar where the two sides are expected to meet for talks.

Overheated Europe, Underprepared world

FOR SEVERAL years, weather extremes seemed a distant crisis for much of the Western world. The devastating heatwave of 2023 did leave an imprint on the ecological consciousness of a section of Europeans. But it’s only been about a decade since people outside the developing world began to feel the impact of global warming acutely. In Europe, temperature records were broken during the summers of 2019, 2022 and 2023. The hot weather has been particularly distressing for people across the continent this year. Temperatures have exceeded 40 degrees Celsius in several countries, red alerts have spread across France and other parts of Europe, schools have shut, transport systems have been disrupted, and health services have come under immense pressure. The UK has recorded its hottest June day on record, while Spain, Portugal, Belgium, the Netherlands and Germany have all experienced conditions that until recently would have been considered highly unusual. The exact toll taken by the climate vagaries is not yet known, but the tragedy of people drowning in France after jumping into rivers and canals to escape the heat underscores the severity of the crisis.

Municipalities in several parts of Europe are now discussing cooling centres, expanding green spaces, redesigning buildings, framing heat action plans and improving emergency response systems. Such conversations are necessary in a continent where buildings are designed to retain warmth. But adaptation addresses only one side of the problem. The European heat crisis is a reminder of something scientists have always asserted: Climate change is an interconnected planetary emergency. For instance, the current weather pattern, a blocked high-pressure system trapping hot air over Europe and drawing warm air up from the Sahara, is not unusual in European summers. But climate change has made such occurrences more frequent and exacting, especially because Europe is the fastest-warming continent.

Delays in global warming mitigation impose burdens all over the world. Most European countries have taken initiatives to cut net GHG emissions to negligible levels. But many of these plans have been criticised for being vague on near-term accountability. Ambitious emissions reductions are indispensable. Equally critical is ensuring that Europe honours its financial and technological commitments to developing countries. The heatwave should alert its policymakers to the fact that every unfulfilled climate promise makes future heatwaves more dangerous.

On your next date, show up as you are

ALL ANIMALS play the mating game differently: Peacocks fan out their tail and dance and male nursery web spiders present fly carcasses as gifts. Fortunately or not, humans do not have the luxury of a predetermined script. So, playing the dating game takes work. The World Wide Web’s entry into the chat has further complicated the picture. The most recent experiment is goblintimacy: In an era of curated dating profiles, where it is hard to tell the real from the fake, daters are finally demanding nothing short of radical authenticity.

Goblintimacy is a second-generation trend. In 2022, its predecessor, “goblin mode”, was Oxford’s word of the year. It meant being “unapologetically self-indulgent, lazy, slovenly, or greedy”, or simply being a “goblin”, no shame. Its popularity reflected a cultural fatigue caused by the constant need to present a curated version of oneself. Sometimes, people need to just slouch around, gorge on junk food, be a couch potato. That fatigue born out of the pressure to constantly perform is not limited to the self. Dating, too, has changed in the digital age. Romance has become spectacle: Think “launches”, soft and hard; Instagrammed proposals; selfie corners at weddings. And yet, real connection seems more elusive than ever.

Thankfully, young people seem to be rejecting the new code. Their answer, instead, is: Come as you are. Meeting offline and being vulnerable is unlikely to solve today’s intimacy crisis, but it can be part of the answer. If nothing else, being goblins together makes the process of finding connection more fun.

Next UN chief’s job: Keep conversations alive when others stop talking

DAG HAMMARSKJÖLD, the United Nations’ second secretary-general, once offered what remains perhaps the clearest statement of the organisation’s purpose. The UN, he said, “was not created to take mankind to heaven, but to save humanity from hell”. The remark reflected the hard lessons of the first half of the 20th century, when two world wars, genocide, imperial conquest and the horrors of the Holocaust and Hiroshima devastated much of the globe. The UN was never intended to create a perfect international order; it was designed to prevent the recurrence of such catastrophes. Eighty years after its founding, that mission looks increasingly precarious.

Armed conflicts are multiplying. Nuclear risks have returned to strategic calculations. International law is under pressure, while the Security Council, the world’s principal instrument of collective security, is frequently paralysed by the rival interests of its permanent members. When cooperation is most needed, faith in multilateralism is ebbing as great-power rivalry thrives. Against this backdrop, the race to succeed António Guterres, whose term ends in December 2026, has assumed unusual significance. The next secretary-general will inherit what has often been described as the “most impossible job” on Earth. Yet there are moments when impossible jobs matter most.

The next UN chief will take office as the restraints that have helped contain international rivalry since 1945 visibly weaken. For all its shortcomings, the post-war order achieved something remarkable: It prevented World War III. Proxy wars, regional conflicts and repeated crises occurred, but direct military confrontation between the major powers was avoided. Colonial empires disappeared, dozens of new nations emerged, and institutions of international

cooperation often prevented local conflicts from becoming global disasters. Today, those achievements are under strain. Russia’s invasion of Ukraine, the devastation in Gaza, widening conflicts across West Asia, tensions in the South China Sea and the erosion of arms-control agreements all point to a world more willing to rely on force and coercion. Many smaller countries feel like mere spectators rather than participants in shaping the international order.

It is in moments such as these that the secretary-general’s role assumes particular importance. The office’s most successful occupants understood that preserving peace required more than administrative competence. Hammarskjöld helped navigate the Suez crisis and transformed peace-keeping into a practical instrument of conflict management. U Thant quietly created diplomatic space during the Cuban missile crisis, while Javier Pérez de Cuéllar helped broker settlements from Afghanistan to Central America and contributed to the Cold War’s peaceful conclusion. Kofi Annan became a moral voice for peace and humanity and was widely described as the “secular Pope”. Their influence rested not on formal authority but on credibility, discretion and the ability to help governments change course without appearing to surrender. That tradition has faded.

The secretary-general still commands a global platform unmatched by most political leaders. Yet the office has become increasingly cautious in using that authority. When governments hesitate to speak uncomfortable truths, excessive caution carries its own risks. The next secretary-general should not merely respond to crises but identify dangers before they erupt. Too often, the international community mobilises only after violence and humanitarian disasters have



SHASHI THAROOR



ED MATHEW

The next UN secretary-general will take office as the restraints that have helped contain international rivalry since 1945 visibly weaken

FCRA’s new rules shrink space for civil society



JOHN BRITTAS

SINCE THEIR notification on June 22, the Foreign Contribution (Regulation) Amendment (FCRA) Rules, 2026 have largely been discussed in terms of their impact on NGOs. But the changes compel us to confront a deeper question: Where does legitimate regulation end and executive control begin?

No responsible democracy can object to regulating foreign contributions. The difficulty arises when regulation gradually ceases to concern itself with money and begins to concern itself with institutions. The latest amendments mark such a transition. They prescribe the purposes for which organisations may function, require them to pre-terminate the states in which they may operate, create fresh benchmarks for assessing organisational legitimacy and expand reporting obligations into areas extending far beyond financial accountability.

Civil society occupies the constitutional space between the individual and the state, a space of charitable institutions, educational establishments, etc. Our Constitution consciously protects this plural institutional landscape. It recognises the freedom to form associations. It guarantees freedom of conscience and the right to profess, practise and propagate religion; it protects the rights of minorities to establish and administer educational institutions. These guarantees were never intended to immunise organisations from regulation; equally, they were never intended to permit regulation to become an instrument for narrowing their autonomy.

One provision of the new rules illustrates this concern vividly. The schedule appended to the Rules repeatedly excludes “proselytisation” from specified religious activities. No constitutional democracy can countenance conversion through force, fraud or coercion. Yet, the expression “proselytisation” finds no definition either in the parent Act or in the amended rules. It has no settled statutory meaning in Indian law. In effect, an undefined expression carrying potentially serious consequences has been introduced into subordinate legislation.

Laws cannot leave citizens or institutions guessing where legality ends and illegality begins. When vague terminology is used, its

practical meaning is left to executive interpretation. The danger of vague law is that it discourages perfectly lawful conduct.

Equally significant are the amendments relating to reporting obligations, now requiring disclosures extending to publications, articles, official websites, social-media accounts and descriptions of institutional activities.

There is a distinction between monitoring how an organisation spends money and monitoring what it thinks or communicates. That distinction acquires particular importance after the decision in *Justice K S Puttaswamy (Retd) vs Union of India*, where the Supreme Court recognised privacy as intrinsic to the right to life and personal liberty under Article 21. Privacy is not confined to physical spaces. It also encompasses informational autonomy.

These concerns assume greater significance when viewed alongside the pending Foreign Contribution (Regulation) Amendment Bill, 2026, which proposes even more extensive governmental powers over institutions and assets.

The present amendments must also be viewed against the trajectory of FCRA administration over the past 10 years. The new Rules represent the latest stage in the process of progressively tightening regulatory control over India’s voluntary sector. During this period, thousands of FCRA registrations have been cancelled. Equally disquieting is the diminution of transparency itself. Detailed organisation-wise information once publicly accessible through the Ministry’s FCRA portal has been withdrawn, while even parliamentary questions seeking particulars of FCRA licence cancellations have repeatedly been disallowed on the ground that such information is “secret in nature”.

As compliance obligations imposed on civil society become increasingly intrusive, public transparency regarding the exercise of regulatory power appears to have diminished. A constitutional democracy demands the opposite: Greater executive accountability as regulatory authority expands.

Brittas is Rajya Sabha Member of Parliament belonging to CPM. With inputs from Aneesh Babu

escalated. The most immediate challenge is the widening gulf among the major powers. Relations between the US, China and Russia have deteriorated sharply. The office requires someone capable of combining public candour with private persuasion. Its greatest asset may be the ability to keep conversations alive when others stop talking.

Recent setbacks in negotiations on nuclear disarmament, pandemic preparedness and plastic pollution illustrate a broader problem. International negotiations now struggle to move beyond entrenched positions. Diplomatic breakthroughs rarely occur by accident. The Universal Declaration of Human Rights, the Nuclear Non-Proliferation Treaty and the Paris climate agreement emerged through painstaking negotiations that uncovered common ground despite profound differences. The UN should invest more in mediation, negotiation support and conflict-resolution capacity.

The organisation also faces a legitimacy crisis. Across much of the Global South, governments believe the international system applies its principles inconsistently. Frustration over Security Council reform has accumulated for decades, while institutions designed in 1945 continue to reflect a world that no longer exists. Whether the next secretary-general comes from Latin America or the Caribbean, whose turn it is under the informal regional rotation, geography alone will not solve that problem. What matters is whether the office becomes a persistent advocate for a more representative international order.

The UN must also adapt to a changing landscape in which cities, universities, philanthropic foundations, civil-society organisations and private-sector actors possess capabilities once associated almost exclusively with states. During periods of govern-

mental deadlock, these networks often remain capable of advancing cooperation. Perhaps the greatest challenge lies not within institutions but in political culture. The generation that experienced world war, genocide and nuclear brinkmanship required little persuasion about the consequences of international failure. Today’s leaders are more distant from those experiences, even as many of the dangers that inspired the UN’s creation have returned.

The next secretary-general cannot restore the UN’s relevance alone. But the office can remind governments and the public that multilateralism is not idealism but a practical necessity. Climate change, pandemics, mass displacement, cyber insecurity and nuclear proliferation do not respect borders. As Kofi Annan observed, they are “problems without passports”. The next secretary-general will inherit an organisation under financial pressure, confronting geopolitical fragmentation and facing widespread scepticism about its effectiveness. Yet the history of the UN offers a paradox. The organisation has seldom been most valuable when relations among states were harmonious. Its greatest contributions often came during periods of intense division, when channels of communication were scarce, and mistrust was abundant.

The secretary-general cannot end wars by decree or reshape international politics alone. What the office can do is create opportunities for diplomacy, preserve lines of communication and expand the political space in which compromise becomes feasible. The job remains impossible. The alternative, however, is a world in which nobody is left trying to save humanity from hell.

Tharoor, MP, served the UN from 1978 to 2007. He was India’s candidate for secretary-general in 2006, and came second out of seven candidates. Mathew is a former UN spokesperson

Iran’s World Cup exit is no ordinary heartbreak



SAPTARSHI BASAK

THE THING about being a football fan whose country isn’t playing in the World Cup is that you can support a foreign team for just about any reason: Your favourite players (Argentina or Portugal), a beautiful playing style (Brazil, Spain), or something personal, like the country where you studied (England), or one you visited and absolutely fell in love with (Mexico, Japan). And then there is politics and solidarity. You either identify with a country’s struggles, or that country’s rival is in the tournament, and in this case, hosting it. Add all that up, and I found my heart beating for Iran.

This is a country on the receiving end of a US-Israeli war of choice that has killed thousands of civilians, including 100-plus children in an airstrike on a girls’ school in Minab. But solidarity with Team Melli — as the Iranian national team is known — goes beyond the war. The team was required to fly to the US only the day before each match and leave for Mexico right after. Several coaches, support staff, and officials had their visa applications rejected. Iran has said it will lodge a formal complaint with FIFA, though little can be expected from an organisation that invented a peace prize for the president of the main host country.

And so, my feelings going into this World Cup were simple. Iran beating the US in the knockouts would be too much to ask for; winning the whole thing, almost unimaginable. Expectations were thus kept realistic: Nothing would be more poetic than Iran simply outlasting the US. The road to heartbreak began as early as the 0-0 draw against Belgium, when the most imaginative free kick of the Cup so far found the net, only to be ruled offside by the VAR. And when Iran needed just a win against Egypt, they were held to 1-1 after a stoppage-time goal was again disallowed by the VAR for offside, this time less than half a foot. Betting markets still gave them odds north of 90 per cent to advance as one of the eight best third-placed teams. They needed just one of three results to go their way: Congo not to beat Uzbekistan, Croatia not to beat or draw with Ghana, or Algeria and Austria not to draw.

Croatia beat Ghana; full-time: Congo 3-1 Uzbekistan. Still, of the three possible outcomes between Algeria and Austria, only a draw would eliminate Team Melli. Algeria came back from behind twice, and after the second-half’s hydration break, at 2-2, both teams appeared content to run down the clock because a draw would see them both through. Until Riyad Mahrez scored in stoppage time, sending Iranian hearts — and mine — into pure jubilation. That lasted less than a hundred seconds as Kaladjic headed home the equaliser, also the last touch of the game.

All I can hope for now is the *schadenfreude* of watching the US lose as they play Bosnia and Herzegovina next. But Iran’s backstory provided the most compelling reason to support a team in years. It is over now, by the thinnest of margins. Time to find renewed purpose in this Cup. On to cheering for Senegal, hoping the trophy goes to an African nation this time. The only problem is, in the Round of 32, it faces Belgium — and Kevin De Bruyne.

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Iran’s backstory provided the most compelling reason to support a team in years. It is over now, by the thinnest of margins

40 YEARS AGO

June 30, 1986



Argentina are champions

ARGENTINA WON football’s World Cup 3-2 in a game that pitted the football artistry of the South Americans against West German grit in the face of defeat. In a dramatic last 10 minutes, West Germany fought back from 2-0 down to level at 2-2 only for Argentina to score the winner moments later.

Reshuffle in Karnataka ministry

IN A day of sensational developments, 14 of 15 ministers of state in Karnataka opted out of the ministry, three senior ministers were

dropped and two ministers were inducted into the team by CM Ramakrishna Hegde.

Iraqi raid on Iranian villages

IRAQI WARPLANES raided six Iranian border towns and bombed Iran’s oil export terminal at Kharg Island in retaliation for an Iranian surface-to-surface missile attack on the Iraqi oil province of Kirkuk. Iran reported five civilians killed and 28 wounded in one of the raids and vowed to “retaliate forcefully as before”, a reference to a string of medium-range missile attacks launched on Baghdad last year.

Pranab keeps pot boiling

POLITICS IN West Bengal never stays dull for long. There is always something new to lend piquancy to it. The crusade by Pranab Mukherjee, former Union finance minister, against the Congress-I is a case in point. The expelled Congress-I leader is trying to make the people understand that the process of concentrating all power and responsibility in a single individual (Rajiv Gandhi) has done the party incalculable harm. All dissidence, corruption and indiscipline can be traced back to this single source, he says.



In this season of political heat, finding comfort in the many republics of the mango



DESHKAAL
BY YOGENDRA YADAV

WHY DID the merciful God create the merciless Indian summer? This theological riddle has only one answer that I know: Mango. God rained heat so that mangoes could get sweeter and juicier. They could also be the answer to the current political dilemma. What to do in the face of the political heatwave that is sweeping across the country, from the Bay of Bengal to the Arabian sea? Have mangoes, of course. And read about mangoes, if you can.

And so I did this weekend, devouring a delicate selection of garden mangoes gifted by my friend Faheem Khan while reading *Mangifera Indica: A Biography of the Mango*, a magnificent book written by another friend, Sopan Joshi. Mango, he insists, “is to Indians what the weather is to the English. The more we talk about it, the more it becomes our mirror. When people talk about the mango, they end up revealing something about themselves. Our mangoes define us.”

So let me put my prejudices on the dining table. The part of Haryana where I was born and the corner of Rajasthan where I grew up produce no mango of any note. I like to picture myself, therefore, as a neutral umpire in the debates on best mangoes. In my considered judgement, Alphonso is the most overrated and overpriced mango. Accordingly, I have been the life president of the All India Anti Alfonso Association of India, waiting for its second member. To me, Safaidda was created to cater to mango-shake corners. Dashehri is like Lata Mangeshkar, great but predictable. Langda is a notch above and a

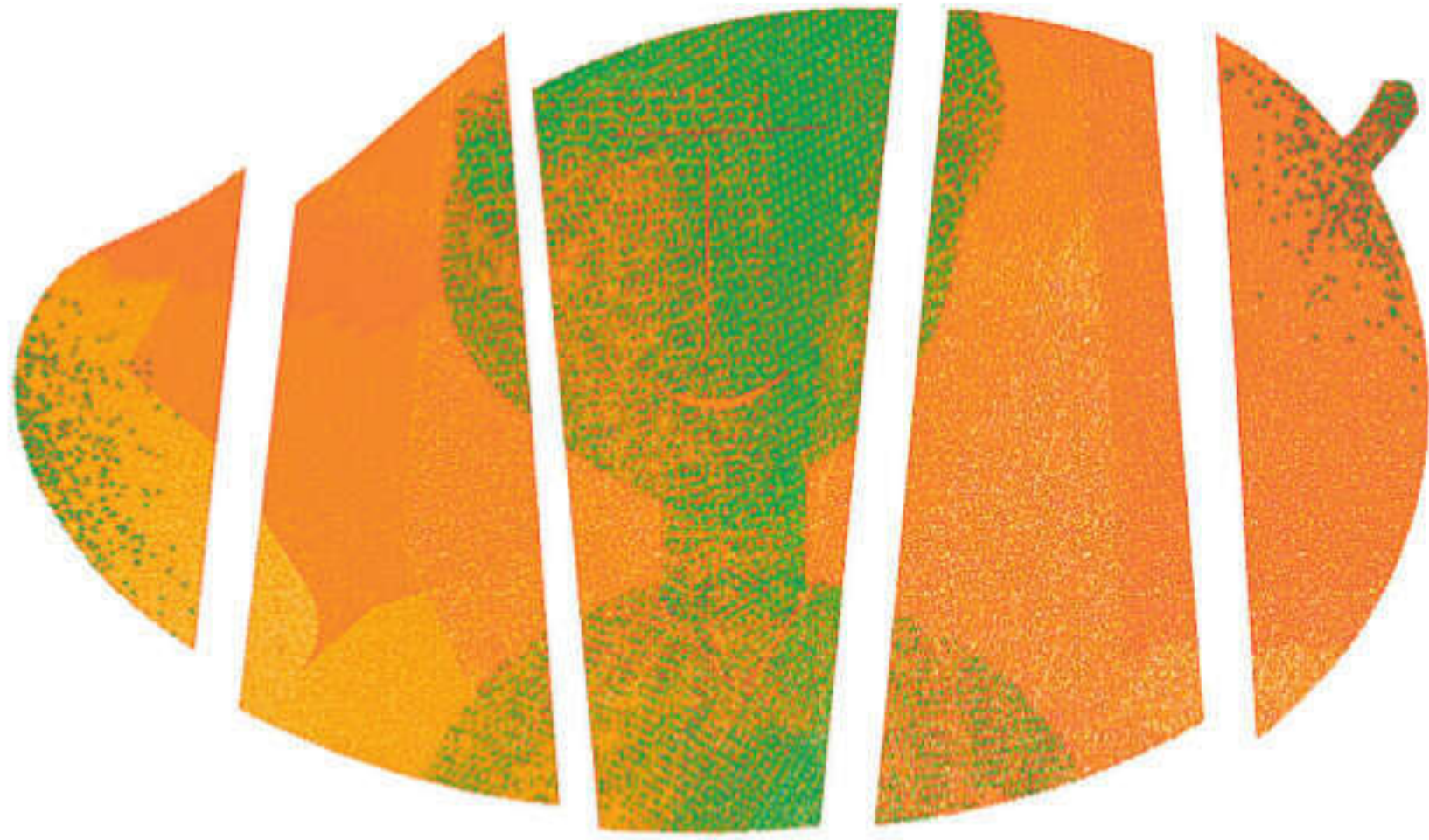


ILLUSTRATION: C.R SASIKUMAR

little naughty, just like Geeta Dutt. And no mango comes anywhere close to the divine Chausa. No simile needed.

As I savoured my gift this weekend, I began a rethink. I wondered why I had never tasted Gulab Jamun before. No, I am not shifting this conversation to a halwai shop. I am staying with mangoes, the centre of my universe for three months every year, between May 18 and August 15. In case you are curious about the precise dates, it has to do with an enforced mango fast due to something called gestational diabetes when we were expecting our first baby. As it invariably does, the fast ended with a feast, a mango binge. As it sometimes does, that event turned into an annual ritual.

Let me come back to Gulab Jamun, the mango I discovered this weekend. This little green mango, which may pass off for a younger Langda, has a texture and flavour that surpasses its elder

The part of Haryana where I was born and the corner of Rajasthan where I grew up produce no mango of any note. I like to picture myself, therefore, as a neutral umpire in the debates on best mangoes

brother. You don't use a knife on it. You just peel it off and sink your teeth in, just as *Babumama* recommended five centuries ago. It is grown close to Delhi, in and around Shahjahanpur (not its namesake district but the cluster of 16 villages near Meerut settled by Mughal emperor Shah Jahan's trusted aide), yet it has not made it to the Delhi mango market. Faheem tells me growers keep it for family consumption. Rataul is another fabulous variety, again from a village close to Delhi. But its famed fragrance is yet to find space on the *rehris* across the NCT. Ask any friend from Bihar, or any other mango-growing state for that matter, and you hear stories of that fantastic Biju mango they had as a child, something they don't find any more.

Here is a story from my family. My mother spent her childhood in Allahabad, with and among mangoes. When she visited the place after her marriage, she and my

father were served cut mangoes on a plate. My mother was both amused and perplexed. She did not know how to eat these. This captures how much has changed in our relationship with mangoes and with ourselves. The story of mango is the story of the triumph of table mangoes over sucking mangoes; of long shelf lives over short ones; of looks over taste; of traders over growers. It is a story of how modern markets transform both the product and its consumers.

Joshi's deeply researched and beautifully crafted book weaves together such stories from all over the country — “a few slices from the lives of people who grow, sell, and eat mangoes” as he puts it. The author travels all over the country — not just to Lucknow, Banaras and the Konkan — to taste mangoes and sample the mango culture of all regions. You travel with him and taste not just the mangoes but experience the place itself.

Not all his journeys are fruitful. To my disappointment, the origins of my favourite Chausa remain unclear. But each journey yields a great story. The stories take him to history, ancient and modern. You discover why Gandhi called mango a “cursed fruit” and how Jawaharlal Nehru's gift of a case of mangoes to the imprisoned Rammanohar Lohia got him into a spat with Sardar Patel. It takes Joshi to the labs and biographies of modern scientists in the fields of geology, genetics, ecology and agriculture. He uncovers the economics of mangoes by meeting retailers, middlemen, and exporters. That is how you understand why, despite producing half the global output and surpassing everyone else in quality, Indian mangoes do poorly in the international market.

Above all, this book, with its inviting description of mangoes from all parts of the country, was the perfect antidote for bigoted mango nationalists like myself. A sobering and soothing read in this summer of bigotry and thuggery.

The writer is member, Swaraj India, and national convenor, Bharat Jodo Abhiyaan. Views are personal

ISI is not IIT. Its society structure needs no change



ARIJIT BISHNU

A BILL has been drafted by the MoSPI, primarily to change the status of the Indian Statistical Institute (ISI) from a registered society to a “body corporate”, and to align it with the IIT/IIM model. A large number of current and former faculty members, employees and alumni of ISI, reputed academicians and civil society members have expressed their dissent. Many — from both within and outside ISI — have also supported its adoption, like the chairman (R A Mashelkar) and a member (Adil Zainulbhai) of the 4th Review Committee of ISI, in an article published in these pages (“To recover lost ground, ISI must look to IITs, IIMs”, *IE*, June 18). This writer and many ISI faculty members have discussed the views presented by Mashelkar and Zainulbhai (hereafter, M&Z); the relevant points from these discussions have been presented.

M&Z have stated that “... when AI and machine learning are remaking every industry, every government function, every research discipline,” ISI “is watching from the sidelines”. This is not true. ISI had established a Centre for Artificial Intelligence and Machine Learning in 2021, which has been conducting research and application projects funded by Google, DRDO, TCS, etc. as well as national-level short-term courses and workshops. ISI has been contributing to capacity-building in this domain since it has introduced AI and ML topics in the syllabi of its core courses, M Stat and M Tech. M&Z have opined that ISI's mandate should formally include AI and allied disciplines. For this, no new “Bill” is required; there is already a provision within the present ISI Act. In 1995, its scope to grant degrees and diplomas was expanded to include “computer science and such other subjects related to statistics”. Surely, AI/ML can be accommodated within this.

M&Z have stated that “ISI admits around 550 to 600 students a year. IITs admit close to 2,500”. They emphasise the demand for data analysts but argue that “the institutional capacity to respond” is “missing”. The demand is real. ISI has tried to respond to it. It currently runs three undergraduate, eight postgraduate, and six diploma/certificate courses in addition to a doctoral programme. Of these, nine were started in the past 15 years. In the past 20 years, the number of graduating students per year has increased almost fourfold.

ISI's mandate is “to develop statistical theory and methods, and their use in research and practical applications”. Increasing student intake reduces the time faculty members can devote to research. There is, therefore, no compulsion for ISI to compete with the IITs with respect to the number of students. During the past 10 years, ISI's student intake has more than doubled, but there has not been a commensurate increase in faculty members. The government has actually imposed constraints on new employment.

M&Z have opined that the governance architecture of IITs and IIMs provides “genuine room to grow”. They have stated that “both systems expanded dramatically in size, quality and global standing. ISI, still running on a society structure from the 1930s, did not.” ISI's “society structure” is not an impediment. It is true that ISI has not grown as rapidly as the IITs and IIMs, but that is a conscious decision based on ISI's objectives enshrined in the Memorandum of Association, and also because of government constraints on employment.

Finally, M&Z have identified “the core problem” of ISI and have stated that the draft Bill addresses it: That the size of the ISI Council is “unwieldy” and that the recommended reduction is appropriate. This is being discussed within ISI, too, and if a reduction is decided, it can be implemented by a simple amendment of the ISI Act, without the transformation of ISI's governance into a “body corporate”. M&Z have also stated that the centres of ISI established in four cities will “get real administrative and financial autonomy”, which they believe is “long overdue”. ISI's headquarters and its four centres have remained members of a “family”, amicably sharing resources, rights and responsibilities, including teaching. Why the issue of “real administrative and financial autonomy” has been suddenly raised is unclear.

It is important for MoSPI to hold regular discussions with various segments of ISI, so that the institute can grow rapidly. Transforming it into a “body corporate” is neither necessary nor desirable.

The writer is professor of Computer Science, Indian Statistical Institute, Kolkata

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

Elephant and dragon

SANJAYA BARU'S advocacy for a parallel-track approach rightly acknowledges the economic pragmatism India must weigh ('It's time to resume the India-China strategic economic dialogue', *IE*, June 29). Yet, a resilient economic architecture cannot be erected upon volatile, friction-ridden foundations. Border resolution is no mere diplomatic hurdle to be deferred until after normalisation; it is the absolute bedrock of state and corporate trust. How can commercial interdependence thrive when massive frontline deployments remain active? Absent territorial clarity, bilateral commerce remains deeply vulnerable to sudden geopolitical shocks, reducing crucial supply chains to fragile liabilities. Resolving the border deadlock decisively is the non-negotiable prerequisite for ensuring that economic engagement becomes genuinely secure and sustainable.

Naman Bhatt, Ghaziabad

Death and grief

THANK YOU, Dr Hansda, for the lyrical piece on death in today's paper ('People die of sadness far away. Here, grief must stand in line', *IE*, June 29). I just finished reading it and had to immediately let you know how much I appreciated it. So many thoughts, feelings, words and sentences expressed what I would have liked to say. It brought a smile, albeit a slightly sad one, to my lips. And thank you, editor, for choosing to publish it unexpectedly amid all the usual depressing mayhem.

Neeta Gadkari, via email

Ram Mandir fund

THE COUNTRY has witnessed many Himalayan scams in the past involving various government schemes and their implementation. But in the holy temple at Ayodhya ('Ayodhya donation theft calls for accountability', *IE*, June 29)? Will the kingpin of the scam and all those involved in the loot be brought to book and punished? Will accountability be fixed on all the stakeholders? If not, let Lord Ram be the judge.

Tharcus S Fernando, Chennai



GOURAV VALLABH

INDIA'S MACROECONOMIC story today presents an unusual contrast. Consumer inflation remains comfortably below the RBI's medium-term target, while wholesale inflation has risen sharply. The rupee, which faced pressure amid recent geopolitical tensions, has regained some ground. Foreign exchange reserves remain robust, and growth continues to outpace most major economies. Yet beneath these reassuring headlines lies a challenge that policymakers cannot afford to ignore.

The widening gap between wholesale and consumer inflation deserves closer attention. Such divergences rarely persist. Producer costs eventually find their way into retail prices. Higher fuel and power prices have already raised production costs across sectors ranging from chemicals and fertilisers to textiles and engineering goods. These pressures are likely to surface in consumer inflation with a lag.

The reopening of key shipping routes has moderated global oil prices. For an oil-importing nation like India, this is more than temporary relief. It is a strategic opportunity.

The temptation is to treat lower oil prices as a windfall. That would be a mistake. Commodity cycles are temporary. Countries that use periods of lower prices to strengthen their fundamentals emerge stronger when conditions reverse. Those who view them merely as an excuse for higher spending often find themselves vulnerable during the next shock. India should use this window to reinforce three pillars of macroeconomic strength: Currency stability, export competitiveness and fiscal credibility.

The opportunity is enormous. Global pension funds, insurance companies and sovereign wealth funds control more than \$110 trillion, much of it seeking stable, inflation-linked, long-term returns

The first priority should be strengthening external buffers. Lower oil prices reduce the import bill and improve the current account position. A portion of these gains should be used to strengthen foreign exchange reserves. Strong reserves provide insurance against future external shocks and help deter speculative pressure on the currency. At the same time, efforts to attract stable foreign currency inflows must continue.

The larger objective should be reducing India's structural dependence on imported energy. Over the past decade, India has expanded renewable energy capacity, promoted electric mobility and encouraged domestic manufacturing through production-linked incentives. The current oil price environment offers an opportunity to accelerate this transition.

The export sector can benefit as well. Lower energy costs reduce transportation and logistics expenses across the economy. Temporary cost advantages should be converted into durable gains in global market share. This is also an opportune moment to attract investment into energy-intensive manufacturing sectors. India's improving infrastructure, expanding domestic market, production-linked incentive framework and lower energy costs together create a compelling proposition for global investors seeking alternative production locations.

However, these opportunities can be undermined if fiscal discipline weakens. Whenever oil prices decline, governments face pressure to expand subsidies or increase recurring expenditure. While such measures may offer short-term

gains, long-term economic benefits lie elsewhere. Savings generated through lower oil prices should primarily support capital expenditure, deficit reduction and strategic reserve accumulation.

Fiscal credibility has become one of India's most valuable macroeconomic assets. It lowers borrowing costs, strengthens investor confidence and supports currency stability. Preserving this credibility must remain a policy priority. There is another reason for caution. A weaker-than-expected monsoon can quickly reverse gains in food inflation and place pressure on household budgets. Policymakers should strengthen food buffer stocks and secure supply chains while conditions remain favourable.

India has spent the last decade building stronger economic foundations through credible monetary policy, improved fiscal management, stronger reserves and accelerated infrastructure creation. These achievements deserve recognition. Yet, economic success is not measured by performance during favourable periods alone. It is measured by how effectively favourable periods are used to prepare for future challenges. The real test is whether India uses today's calm to prepare for tomorrow's turbulence.

The objective should not be to manage the next few months. It should be to use today's advantages to build resilience for the next decade. That is how temporary opportunities are converted into permanent economic strength.

The writer is professor of finance and part-time member, Economic Advisory Council to the Prime Minister. Views are personal

Lower oil prices, a window of opportunity, don't waste it

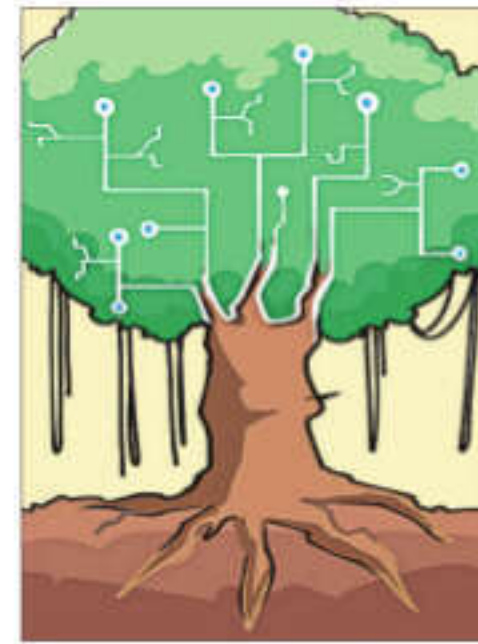


ILLUSTRATION: TANUSHRI MITRA

time faculty members can devote to research. There is, therefore, no compulsion for ISI to compete with the IITs with respect to the number of students. During the past 10 years, ISI's student intake has more than doubled, but there has not been a commensurate increase in faculty members. The government has actually imposed constraints on new employment.

M&Z have opined that the governance architecture of IITs and IIMs provides “genuine room to grow”. They have stated that “both systems expanded dramatically in size, quality and global standing. ISI, still running on a society structure from the 1930s, did not.” ISI's “society structure” is not an impediment. It is true that ISI has not grown as rapidly as the IITs and IIMs, but that is a conscious decision based on ISI's objectives enshrined in the Memorandum of Association, and also because of government constraints on employment.

Finally, M&Z have identified “the core problem” of ISI and have stated that the draft Bill addresses it: That the size of the ISI Council is “unwieldy” and that the recommended reduction is appropriate. This is being discussed within ISI, too, and if a reduction is decided, it can be implemented by a simple amendment of the ISI Act, without the transformation of ISI's governance into a “body corporate”. M&Z have also stated that the centres of ISI established in four cities will “get real administrative and financial autonomy”, which they believe is “long overdue”. ISI's headquarters and its four centres have remained members of a “family”, amicably sharing resources, rights and responsibilities, including teaching. Why the issue of “real administrative and financial autonomy” has been suddenly raised is unclear.

It is important for MoSPI to hold regular discussions with various segments of ISI, so that the institute can grow rapidly. Transforming it into a “body corporate” is neither necessary nor desirable.

The writer is professor of Computer Science, Indian Statistical Institute, Kolkata

India's diplomacy protects citizens, builds resilience

many had waited a lifetime to undertake?

Despite the uncertainty, the pilgrimage happened smoothly. In fact, our Haj Mission, for the first time, won two prestigious awards for coordination and communication in organising pilgrim services at the Khitamahu Misk ceremony in Saudi Arabia. More than 1,75,000 Indian pilgrims were supported with coordinated flights, accommodation, healthcare, and emergency services.

Critics question Prime Minister Narendra Modi's foreign visits, especially during global crises. They miss the reality that diplomacy in today's world is not just about relations between states. It is about protecting citizens. Wars, energy shocks, fragile supply chains, climate disruptions, tech rivalries — a crisis anywhere can ripple everywhere. In this world, foreign policy is protection. When the next shock comes, India will be prepared.

PM Modi's recent five-nation tour was not ceremonial but calculated. In the UAE, the focus was immediate and critical — energy. At a time of volatile oil markets, both sides moved to deepen cooperation. Talks included expanding India's crude reserves and strengthening LNG and LPG ties. Larger reserves mean protection against supply shocks; diversified partnerships spell insulation from price spikes.

Critics question PM Modi's foreign visits, especially during global crises. They miss the reality that diplomacy in today's world is not just about relations between states. It is about protecting citizens

In the Netherlands, the focus shifted to semiconductors, with recent chip shortages exposing the harsh truth that dependence is vulnerability. Partnerships with Dutch firms bring access to advanced manufacturing, logistics, and chip technology. Sweden and Norway added another layer. The focus: The future economy. Artificial intelligence. Clean energy. Advanced manufacturing. Innovation. Countries that lead in these sectors will shape the global order. Partnerships with Nordic nations give India access to cutting-edge ecosystems and accelerate its own transition.

Italy brought the focus back to connectivity and strategy. The elevation of ties to a Special Strategic Partnership signals intent. So does support for the India-Middle East-Europe Economic Corridor. The message is clear: Diversify routes, reduce chokepoints,

strengthen autonomy. Taken together, the tour reportedly unlocked investment potential of nearly \$40 billion. But the real value goes beyond numbers.

It lies in relationships, access and preparedness. Countries with strong partnerships, diversified supply chains, and strategic reserves weather shocks better. Over the past decade, India has expanded its diplomatic reach not for prestige but protection. The Haj this year is one example and the foreign visits another that speak to the same aim — put citizens first. Ensure they can travel safely, the economy stays stable and the country can withstand shocks. In an uncertain world, resilience is power. And increasingly, diplomacy is how you build it.

The writer is chairperson of the Delhi State Haj Committee and a member of the BJP

RAM TEMPLE DONATION THEFT

Cong delegation to visit Ayodhya temple today

Express News Service
Lucknow, June 29

AMID THE political controversy over alleged irregularities in donations at the Ram Temple in Ayodhya, the Uttar Pradesh Congress Committee has decided to send a nine-member delegation to offer prayers at the temple on Tuesday, in what is being seen as an attempted outreach on faith and an attack on the ruling BJP over the row.

The nine-member delegation comprises state Congress chief Ajay Rai, MPs Kishori Lal Sharma (Amethi), Rakesh Rathore (Sitapur), Ujjwal Raman Singh (Prayagraj) and Tanuj Punia (Barabanki), MLA Virendra Chaudhary (Pharenda), former MP A P Gautam, former MLC Deepak Singh, and former MLA Meeta Gautam. As per a letter issued by the party, the delegation will reach Ayodhya around 11 am to offer prayers at the Ram Temple and pray for public welfare.

Speaking to *The Indian Express*, a senior Congress leader, part of the delegation, said the visit should not be viewed through a political lens alone. "Congress leaders have visited Ayodhya and offered prayers to Lord Ram in the past, as well. We are simply going to offer prayers like any other devotee."

However, party sources said senior leaders are likely to raise the issue of the alleged misappropriation of temple donations after offering prayers, with the Congress planning to target the BJP over the alleged theft, and demand greater transparency and accountability in the management of offerings made at the Ram Temple.

‘Heavens won’t fall’: SC declines urgent hearing in petition seeking CBI probe

Express News Service
New Delhi, June 29

THE SUPREME Court on Monday refused to grant an urgent hearing on a batch of PILs seeking a CBI probe into the alleged financial irregularities and embezzlement of donations at the Ram temple.

The matter was mentioned for emergency listing before a vacation bench comprising Justices M M Sundresh and Sheel Nagu. Dismissing the request for an out-of-turn hearing, the bench noted that the petitions would be listed in due course once the Supreme Court resumes full regular functioning. The top court will return to full operational capacity on July 13.

Seeking an urgent hearing, a petitioner told the bench, "The matter is very serious... The urgency is the way the state is dealing with the matter casts doubts..."

Bench notes pleas would be listed once court resumes regular functioning — on July 13

The bench, however, said that it will be listed in the first week after the court reopens. "Heavens are not going to fall," the bench said.

The petition, filed by two advocates, which named the Shri Ram Janmbhoomi Teerth Kshetra Trust, Uttar Pradesh, and the Union of India as respondents, alleged dishonest misappropriation, diversion, and embezzlement of donations intended for the construction of the Ram temple.

An SIT formed by the Uttar Pradesh government is investigating the allegations. However, the petition claims that the

SIT lacks the necessary forensic and investigative resources for a complex financial probe and that it began its inquiry without registering an FIR.

A petitioner told the bench that the SC's listing department informed him that the matter would be heard after the partial working days. He added that his apprehension is that electronic evidence, such as CCTV and DVRs, might be tampered with or corrupted.

But the bench told him, "You heard us earlier. We follow the same procedure."

One of the petitions cited media reports of the controversy, saying, "The allegations, as disclosed in these reports and other publicly available materials, prima facie disclose serious instances of dishonest misappropriation, diversion, embezzlement and breach of trust in relation to public donations and

funds entrusted for religious and charitable purposes."

It said, "The nature and gravity of the allegations warrant the immediate registration of a Regular Case/ FIR and a fair, independent and time-bound investigation in accordance with law, so as to secure relevant documentary and electronic evidence, trace the flow of funds, identify the persons responsible, and prevent any tampering, destruction, concealment or manipulation of material evidence by the suspect(s), if any."

The plea said, "Opaque funds/ assets handling by an institution serving in a fiduciary capacity directly impacts faith, sentiments, and confidence of countless devotees and members of the public who have voluntarily donated funds for construction of Bhagwan Shri Ram Temple at Janmbhoomi."

All eight accused in judicial custody

Lucknow: All the eight accused arrested in the alleged Ram Temple donation theft and embezzlement case were on Monday produced before the Prevention of Corruption Act (PCA) court, Lucknow, which sent them to 14-day judicial custody.

The accused — Ram Shankar Yadav, Lavkush Mishra, Anukalp Mishra, Ramashankar Mishra, Avinash Shukla, Manish Kumar Yadav, Karunesh Pandey and Subhash Srivastav — were produced before the court from jail through video-conferencing. Police avoided bringing the accused to the court in view of the security reasons, an official said. "We have not filed any application before the court for police custody remand of the accused, so far," Ayodhya Circle Officer Ashutosh Tiwari said.



Over 100 houses in Nasirnagar area were demolished in May. PTI FILE

Surat civic chief to HC: No orders were passed to demolish shanties

Kamal Saiyed & Aditi Raja
Surat, Vadodara, June 29

THE GUJARAT High Court on Monday questioned the role of the police, the Surat Municipal Corporation (SMC) and Torrent Power — that supplies electricity to Surat — regarding the controversial demolition drive in Surat, of unauthorised structures, even as the municipal commissioner, in a written reply told the court that neither he nor any one in the corporation had passed orders for the demolition that happened on May 30.

The court observed that senior police officers present at the site "should have intervened" if demolitions were being carried out illegally under the guise of a demolition exercise. The demolition cleared over 100 units that had allegedly encroached on a private plot of land in Surat's Ved Darwaja that came to be known as Nasimagar.

Hearing a petition filed by some of the residents whose homes were allegedly razed without authority of law, Justice Nikhil Kariel of the HC, in an oral order on Monday, remarked that the Surat Police Commissioner, "upon knowing of such an activity i.e. a large-scale demolition, which prima facie was without any authority of law, was not required to wait till a formal complaint is filed and ought to have taken appropriate steps immediately."

Government pleader G H Virk submitted that police personnel had been deployed at the spot only to maintain the law and order situation after requisition from the SMC and were not required to decide whether the

corporation's actions were lawful. The court order, however, noted that the requisition dated May 21 had sought police protection "only for demarcation purpose and for nothing else" and observed that "under the garb of demarcation, the corporation's officials had demolished the properties of some of the petitioners and others."

According to the response by Municipal Commissioner M Nagarajan, "On inquiring about officers of the corporation and checking the record, Respondent no 2 - Commissioner learnt that there was no order passed by any authority of the SMC, muchless by Respondent no 2 - Commissioner, directing such an action of demolition to be taken on May 30, 2026." The reply adds that several SMC Central Zone officials were present on the site for carrying out "task of demarcation of the road line."

The Municipal Commissioner's note in reply states that the land measuring around 20739.64 square metres, is owned by "Parsi individuals" who wanted to develop it through developers, builders and architects. On March 12, 2026, they applied for Plot Validation Certificate, which was rejected by the SMC, because the owners had failed to provide a 40 feet wide public street. He stated that the area was "unauthorisedly encroached upon by various individuals."

The note adds, "The task relating to the public road demarcation was unfortunately followed by removal/ demolition of the unauthorised construction" affecting some "50 to 55 unauthorised structures."

• BRIEFLY



J&K L-G Manoj Sinha at Amarnath Cave Temple on Monday. PTI

JAMMU & KASHMIR

L-G performs pratham puja ahead of Amarnath Yatra starting July 3

PRATHAM PUJAS were held on Monday in Jammu and at the cave shrine of Amarnath, marking the ceremonial start of the annual pilgrimage beginning July 3. Jammu and Kashmir Lieutenant Governor Manoj Sinha performed rituals at the cave shrine, while the *pratham puja* was held for the first time in Jammu city as a part of *maha yagya* on the banks of Tawi river. The annual 57-day pilgrimage is scheduled to begin on July 3 from the twin routes — the 48-km Pahalgam track in south Kashmir's Anantnag and the 14-km Baltal route in central Kashmir's Ganderbal. PTI

BSF constable found hanging in Jammu camp

A YOUNG woman constable of the BSF was allegedly found hanging in her room at the force's frontier headquarters in Jammu on Monday. The deceased, Constable Bishnu Priya Roy, was undergoing a three-month lab assistant course that began on May 25 and was staying in accommodation allotted to her at the Command Hospital inside the BSF's frontier HQ in Pouloura, officials said. The cause of death is yet to be ascertained, and police have initiated inquest proceedings in the matter. ENS

Four dead as car falls into gorge in Uttarakhand

FOUR PERSONS were killed and two severely injured after their car fell into a deep gorge in Almora district's Lamgara on Monday. According to the State Emergency Operation Centre, the accident occurred after the car, on its way to Chaikhan from Lamgara, went out of control and plunged into the gorge. There were six occupants in the car — four of them died, while the two others sustained severe injuries and are being airlifted to Sushila Tiwari Hospital in Haldwani for treatment. PTI

Rs 5 lakh fine on lawyers representing accused: Bar Association

Bhupendra Pandey
Lucknow, June 29

THE AYODHYA Bar Association (ABA) on Monday announced it will boycott the accused in the Ram Temple donation theft case and impose a fine of Rs 5 lakh on advocates representing them.

The ABA made the announcement after holding a meeting of all its office bearers and members at 10.30 am.

An office bearer of the Association stated that the advocates have unanimously de-



The Bar Association president, Kalika Prasad Mishra, addresses the media at the Faizabad district court, Ayodhya, on Monday. PTI

cided to deny legal aid to the accused for hurting the sentiments of the Hindu community.

"The crime was committed within the temple premises by those who were given the responsibility to protect it," the office-bearer said.

Bar association president Kalika Prasad Mishra told mediapersons that a team of advocates would instead help in prosecuting the accused.

A few of the advocates in the meeting even proposed to give a call for an agitation if Ram

Janmbhoomi Teerth Kshetra Trust general secretary Champat Rai and trustee Anil Mishra, both of whom tendered their resignations two days ago, did not leave Ayodhya soon.

Till now, eight people — Ramshankar Yadav alias Tinnu, Lavkush Mishra, Anukalp Mishra, Ramashankar Mishra, Avinash Shukla, Manish Kumar Yadav, Subhash Srivastav, and Karunesh Pandey — have been arrested in the case. All were remanded to 14-day judicial custody by a court in Lucknow on Monday.

EXPRESS special

Learnt to hide emotions, accept uncertainty: Lessons from longest-serving Bastar IGP

Jayprakash S Naidu
Raipur, June 29

AFTER SERVING 14 years in Bastar and leading it through the final phase of the state's anti-Maoist campaign, IGP Sundarraj Pattilingam, 46, is moving to the NIA, leaving behind a region that is now largely free of Left Wing Extremism (LWE).

Sundarraj, the longest-serving IGP of Chhattisgarh's Bastar range, became the face of counter-insurgency operations in what was once India's worst LWE-affected region and home to the nation's top Maoist leadership. Looking back at his years in Bastar, he says the experience fundamentally changed him. "I learnt how to hide my emotions and accept the uncertainty of Bastar," he says. Sundarraj was first posted to Bastar in 2005 as a young officer, when the Salwa Judum movement had just begun, with local tribals being armed to fight Maoists who were often from their own communities.

Across four stints spanning 14 years, he witnessed the deaths of hundreds of security personnel, many of whom he had never met personally. "Bastar changed me in many ways. I have attended numerous final rites of our martyrs over the years, and each one remains deeply painful. There is no formula for deal-



Sundarraj Pattilingam, the longest-serving IGP of Bastar range, is set to join NIA. EXPRESS

ing with such moments. Perhaps the most significant change was learning to regulate my emotions. Whether it was the loss of a colleague or a difficult operational setback, I learned to remain composed because hundreds of officers and jawans looked to their leadership for confidence and direction. I also developed a deeper appreciation for the sacrifices made by police personnel and their families."

Another lesson, he says, was learning to live with uncertainty. "The greatest learning was accepting uncertainty. In Bastar, no day was predictable. The phone could ring at any hour of the day or night with information about an encounter, an IED blast, a surrender, or a civilian incident. Sometimes, it brought encouraging news, and sometimes heartbreaking news. I learned that leadership de-

mands emotional balance irrespective of circumstances. One has to remain calm, take objective decisions, and continue moving forward despite the emotional highs and lows that come with such responsibility."

Even holidays, he says, were never truly holidays. "I, as well as personnel from our forces, spent our holidays fulfilling family commitments before returning to duty." Sundarraj's tenure as Bastar IGP from 2019 until the Government's March 26 deadline to eradicate LWE witnessed some of the biggest anti-Maoist operations in the region. By 2019, Bastar had entered a decisive phase, with an expanded security presence and a growing network of camps steadily shrinking Maoist influence.

Though reluctant to count his victories, Sundarraj says the killing of CPI (Maoist) general secretary Nambala Keshava Rao alias Basavaraju in May 2025 marked a significant turning point, along with the neutralisation of several members of the Maoists' Central Committee. He says he ensured security forces didn't celebrate such operations. "We consciously discouraged celebrations after successful operations because our objective was never revenge," he says.

Asked about his biggest regret, Sundarraj says it is the loss of security personnel over the

years. "The greatest pain remains the lives we lost during operations and thinking about their grieving families. While we continuously learned from every setback and refined our methods, the loss of even a single jawan remains something that weighs heavily on the conscience of every commander," he says.

On how he coped with the emotional toll of losing personnel, Sundarraj says his upbringing helped shape his outlook.

"I come from a farming family where life itself was demanding and challenging. There are years of abundant harvest and years of loss, despite putting in the same hard work. Farming teaches humility, resilience, and the ability to accept outcomes that are beyond one's control. Those lessons stayed with me throughout my service," he says.

As he prepares to leave Bastar, Sundarraj says preserving the gains made over the years will require collective effort. "Lasting peace and sustainable development can only be achieved if we all work together to protect this hard-earned stability," he says.

He also has a message for surrendered Maoists: "Choosing peace requires courage. Surrender is not the end of a journey but the beginning of a new one."

Corruption charges to quality certification: UDF U-turn on labour society

Shaju Philip
Thiruvananthapuram, June 29

WHILE IN Opposition, the Congress had dubbed the Uralungal Labour Contract Co-operative Society (ULCCS), a major civil infrastructure developer in the cooperative sector, as Pinarayi Vijayan's Adani. A month after coming to power, the Congress-led government has stated in the Assembly that the society is delivering quality work.

Replying to questions from Congress members about ULCCS and the unusually large number of works awarded to it during the last decade of the CPI(M) government, Public Works Minister and IUML leader P K Basheer said on Monday, "The society is executing quality works and hence their workload has increased." To repeated questions from the ruling bench on ULCCS, he said the government has found no anomalies in the award of works to the society over the past decade.

The century-old ULCCS has been under attack from the Congress-led UDF in recent years after the Kozhikode-based labour contract movement emerged as the successful bidder for key highway projects in Kerala. During the Assembly poll campaign in April, AICC general secretary (organisation) K C Venugopal had said,

"ULCCS is at the epicenter of the corruption under Pinarayi Vijayan government. They are winning projects without a tender. ULCCS is the main financial source of CPI(M). Just as Adani is to PM Narendra Modi, ULCCS is to Vijayan. Everything goes to ULCCS." Venugopal had added that if the Congress came to power, all dealings related to ULCCS would be probed.

In 2023, then Opposition leader and present Chief Minister V D Satheesan had alleged that the CPI(M) was using ULCCS to park corruption money. He had said the society enjoyed unusual patronage from the LDF government. Satheesan and other Congress leaders repeatedly raised the issue and urged then government to review works awarded to ULCCS.

Basheer's statement in the Assembly that the government had found no anomalies either in awarding works to ULCCS or in fixing project costs marks an embarrassing volte-face for the ruling alliance, which had earlier alleged that ULCCS was a benami entity of CPI(M) leaders.

Former Cooperation Minister and CPI(M) leader V N Vasavan said it was heartening that the UDF had finally acknowledged ULCCS and the quality of its work. "When we had pointed out the excellence of ULCCS, Congress leaders were ridiculing the LDF," he said.

plateau regions in Ratnagiri and Sindhudurg districts of coastal Maharashtra. The carvings mainly comprise figurines, including turtles, elephants, peacock and rhinoceros. These were discovered throughout expeditions and excavations carried out between 2017 and 2023.

According to archaeologists and experts, the origin of these carvings ranges between 20,000 BC and 10,000 BC and is older than the Harappan civilization whose earliest phase dates back to 7,000-5,000 BC. The carvings have an average size of 50 square metres by 20 square metres. Tejas Garge, director at Directorate of Archaeology and Museums, Maharashtra, said that these carvings cover 150 square



The stone carvings were found in Sindhudurg and Ratnagiri districts. THE DIRECTORATE OF ARCHAEOLOGY & MUSEUMS MAHARASHTRA

kilometres spread across 107 villages in the Konkan region.

In 2025, these structures were added to the temporary list of UNESCO world heritage sites in India. However, permanent status is yet to be granted.

The state government has now appointed IIT Pravartak — the technology innovation hub of IIT Madras — for carrying out a digital assessment and documentation of these petroglyphs.

"These petroglyphs are the earliest evidence of art in the Indian context on such a large canvas. The figurines clearly depict the cognitive ability of human beings to visualise nature and replicate them in the form of these carvings," Garge said. Among the carvings discovered, there was none depicting horse or bull. It appeared uncanny to the experts initially, since bulls and horses are common in the pre-historic drawings and art forms in the Indian sub-continent where horses arrived be-

tween 1,500 and 1,000 BC, while agriculture was introduced during the 9,000 BC, he said.

"The absence of horse figurines indicated that the carvings were created during the pre-historic era and the absence of bulls established that they were created during the pre-agricultural era. So, it became clear to us that the origin of these carvings dates back to the Mesolithic era or the middle stone age period," Garge said. The petroglyphs were discovered in 2007 by a group of people from Ratnagiri led by local resident Sudhir Risbud (52). In 2021, Risbud, through a non-profit body Nisarga Yatri, secured funding from the Department of Science and Technology (DST) for documenting these fi-

gurines. More than 150 villages were surveyed in the Konkan belt where petroglyphs were found in 107 villages. The initial survey involved photographing the structure and recording the locations and their size.

"We started identifying these carvings from 2012 by using our own funds and till date have been able to find out 3,000 such figurines. They are huge in size, so manual documentation is not possible. High-end drone cameras are needed to carry out proper documentation of these carvings," Risbud said. Now, the state has appointed the IITM Pravartak for a scientific assessment of each of these figurines.

FULL REPORT ON
WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM



Karnataka SIR begins today; final rolls to be out on Oct 7

Express News Service
Bengaluru, June 29

WITH THE ruling Congress seeking clarification on logical discrepancy and Home Minister Priyank Kharge citing Tamil Nadu, Kerala and West Bengal where the exercise, he said, has “robbed the poor of their rights”, Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls will begin in Karnataka on Tuesday over a period of almost a month until July 29 and culminate in the publication of final electoral rolls on October 7.

A total of 59,050 booth level-officers (BLOs) will distribute enumeration forms to residents and undertake house-to-house visits until July 29. The Election Commission has mapped 91.61% or 5.07 crore of 5.54 crore voters in Karnataka after comparing legacy and current electoral rolls. While 46.53 lakh voters are still unmapped, the mapping exercise is ongoing, Chief Electoral Officer V Anbu Kumar said Monday.

“In the current phase of the SIR, the EC will not seek any documents from the people. They will just have to fill the enumeration forms and submit them,” he said. If family members are not present for any reason, an adult member of the family can sign the SIR enumeration form on their behalf, he said.

COURT SAYS CASE FALLS UNDER ‘RAREST OF THE RARE’ CATEGORY

Death penalty to convict in Pune toddler rape-murder

Sushant Kulkarni
Pune, June 29

OBSERVING THAT ‘even the punishment of death may not be adequate’, a special fast-track court in Pune Monday sentenced a 65-year-old man to death for the rape and murder of a three-year-old girl, less than 60 days after the crime, holding that the case fell in the “rarest of the rare” category.

Special Judge S R Salunkhe awarded three death sentences, ruling that “the judicial conscience of this court leads to the irresistible conclusion that the only punishment the accused can deserve is the death sentence. The accused deserves maximum punishments provided for all the offences which are conclusively proved by the prosecution, including the death sentence for three offences under section 103(1) (murder) and 65(2) (rape) on a woman under twelve years of age) of the BNS and under section 6 of the POCSO Act. As the death sentence cannot be executed consecutively, it is to be awarded concurrently.”

“A man of 65 years of age, having seven married daughters and a son lures a child of three years of age, saying her to show her a calf and give her sweet gathi shev and commits aggravated sexual assaults on her...

and kills her due to resistance and even after killing her, he sexually assaults her. Needless to say that the behaviour of the accused was uncommon and punishment of life imprisonment for such crime would be grossly inadequate. Even the punishment of death may not be adequate but it is the greater punishment that can be awarded for such a crime,” the court observed.

The act of the convict was “brutal, inhuman and barbaric”, said the court as it observed that the crime shocked not just the judicial conscience but also the public conscience. The court cited incidents of rape in Jammu and Kashmir’s Kathua and UP’s Unnao in the judgment, while referring to brutal crimes and subsequent public outrage. This incident too had caused massive public outrage, with people blocking the Pune-Bengaluru Highway for several hours.

The convict was produced before the court under tight police security at 11 am as the courtroom filled with family members of the victim, lawyers, journalists, and members of the public. The judge read out key parts of the judgment for over an hour. The victim’s parents and family members broke down after Special Judge Salunkhe announced the sentence. On June 25, the court had convicted the man and posted the matter for

sentencing Monday. Special Public Prosecutor Ajay Misar, investigating officer Inspector Vijaymala Pawar, and Sandeep Singh Gill, SP, Pune Rural, were present in the court.

“The brutality of the crime, the manner in which it was committed and the inhuman behaviour of the accused with a three-year-old child takes him away from thinking of any alternative to the death sentence, and the possibility of awarding life imprisonment, which is the normal rule, is unquestionably foreclosed in this case. This case will definitely come under the category of ‘rarest of the rare cases,’” the court observed.

‘Last seen together’ theory

The victim girl, who was visiting her grandmother’s house, was raped and murdered on the afternoon of May 1. The accused lured her and took her to a cowshed. He then raped the girl, gagged her with a cloth and then killed by brutally assaulting her with his hands. He then tried to destroy the evidence of his crime by dumping her body in the cowshed.

The court observed, “The presence of the accused with the victim in proximity of the time of death of the victim has been clearly proved. Thus, the ‘last seen together’ theory has also

been established. The prosecution has conclusively proved by medical evidence, electronic evidence and the forensic evidence that the accused was that person who has sexually assaulted the victim and he has committed her murder and tried disappearance of the evidence by concealing her dead body under a gunny bag in tin sheet shed,” the court observed.

Testimony of child witnesses

The court observed: “The story put up by the accused does not inspire confidence and can be straight away thrown away. The version of the three children was natural and inspires confidence... All the witnesses relating to the incident have unanimously stated that the accused and the victim were found together at about 3.12 pm on May 1 proceeding towards the tin sheet shed... Thereafter, the victim was found dead in that shed. Medical evidence showed that she was brutally raped, sexually assaulted and then killed. There was evidence of an attempt of sexual assault even after her death. The forensic evidence confirms, on the basis of DNA profiling, that the accused committed the sexual assaults... All these circumstances leave no room for doubt that the accused committed the crime.”

Chambal dacoit Jagan Gurjar killed in prison by his cellmate

Hamza Khan
Jaipur, June 29

NOTORIOUS DACOIT Jagan Gurjar, who had over a 100 police cases against him, was allegedly murdered by his cellmate in a high-security prison in Rajasthan’s Ajmer on Monday, police said.

Ajmer SP Harsh Vardhan Agarwalla said, “Prima facie, what has come to light so far is that Jagan Gurjar was killed by a jail inmate using a *gamcha* (traditional cotton towel) to strangle him by his neck.” He said initial indications — before the post-mortem and further investigation — are that there were no other marks or injuries on his body other than the strangulation marks on his neck.

The accused was identified as Vishnu Jat, who was in jail in connection with the 2023 murder of another murder accused. The SP said there was no “gang war” angle to the murder as per initial information, and that it was likely the result of a “petty fight”.

So far, no direct involvement of a third person has been found, the officer said, adding that only Gurjar and Jat were in the cell at the time of the incident. It took place after they returned to the cell after having their morning meal, police said.

Jail superintendent Paras Jangid said Gurjar was killed sometime before 3 pm.

“Jagan (Gurjar) and Vishnu (Jat) were in the same barracks.



Jagan Gurjar (sitting), held in 2022, was strangled with a ‘gamcha’. FILE

They were together between 11 am and 3 pm. A recording from 11 am shows that they were cleaning together. But what happened between 11 am and 3 pm is part of the investigation. When the sentry went at 3 pm to unlock barracks for tea, Jagan did not get up... (and) it was found that Jagan was dead,” he said.

Vishnu Jat then confessed to jail officials, the jail superintendent said. “He said they had done some cleaning at around 11 am, and then they played Ludo, too. What happened afterwards will be clearer in the investigation,” he said. The SP said a Forensic Science Laboratory (FSL) team visited the spot. Gurjar’s body has been kept in the Jawaharlal Nehru Hospital in Ajmer. Jat has been in the Ajmer jail for around 3 years, officials said, and Gurjar was moved there in March 2026.

Mainly active in the Chambal region, Jagan Gurjar had several robbery, kidnapping and

looting cases against him.

In 2008, in light of the Gurjar agitation, Jagan Gurjar was among the dacoits who had threatened to blow up then Rajasthan chief minister Vasundhara Raje’s palace in Dholpur.

However, in January 2009, he surrendered before then MP Sachin Pilot during the latter’s rally in Karauli. At the time, he was wanted in over 70 cases in Rajasthan, Madhya Pradesh and Uttar Pradesh, and carried a reward of Rs 11 lakh on his head. Surrendering, Jagan had bowed and touched Pilot’s feet, vowing to give up his life of crime if police treated him well and if there was a fair trial.

Vishnu Jat was among those arrested by Bharatpur police after Kuldeep Singh Jaghina, an accused in the 2022 murder of BJP leader Kripal Singh Jaghina, was shot dead inside a Rajasthan Roadways bus near Amoli toll plaza, Bharatpur, in July 2023.

Govt sets up study group to strengthen film industry; Parsons Joshi to lead team

Amrita Nayak Dutta
New Delhi, June 29

THE MINISTRY of Information and Broadcasting on Monday decided to constitute a study group to explore the opportunities and challenges facing Indian cinema and suggest ways to strengthen the industry and improve its competitiveness on a global scale.

The study group, comprising industry experts and technology partners, will be led by Prasar Bharati CEO Parsons Joshi. It is expected to submit its findings and recommendations to the ministry within three months.

According to a statement from the ministry, the decision was taken in a high-level review meeting on Monday chaired by

Union Minister of Information and Broadcasting Ashwini Vaishnav.

The statement noted that the group will look at making Indian films more competitive in the world market and study the impact of new technologies such as Artificial Intelligence and virtual production on cinema. It will also suggest how Indian filmmakers can use these tools and can access institutional finance from the market and new funding options for film production.

It will evaluate the challenges filmmakers encounter while securing funds for production and distribution. Additionally, it will identify best practices by collaborating with states and other stakeholders

and propose a comprehensive policy framework for the long-term growth of Indian cinema.

The ministry has drafted a set of model regulations for the permissions required for cinemas and theatres, which have been sent to all the states. The states have been asked to adopt these Model State Cinema Regulations.

As the regulation of cinemas and theatres falls under the state list, different states have established varying rules for the required permissions. According to the ministry, this inconsistency has posed a significant obstacle to the growth of cinema infrastructure, particularly in small towns and rural areas, leading to the creation of these model rules.

3 killed as under-construction resort wall collapses in Jaipur

Jaipur: Three persons died while at least three others were injured when the wall of an under-construction resort collapsed on Monday afternoon, trapping multiple labourers under the debris, officials said.

The incident occurred around 12:30 pm at the resort located on the Jaipur-Delhi Highway in the Chandwaji police station area.

Chandwaji police station

SHO Heera Lal Saini said, “Three persons - including two women - and all hailing from Gaya district in Bihar, have died in the wall collapse.

The deceased have been identified as Rinku Devi, 32; Savita Devi, 30, and Ramji Manji, 28. The three were buried under the collapsed wall. All the bodies have been retrieved while the injured have been rescued.” ENS



कर्मचारी भविष्य निधि संगठन
EMPLOYEES' PROVIDENT FUND ORGANISATION
(श्रम एवं रोजगार मंत्रालय, भारत सरकार)
(Min. of Labour & Employment, Govt. of India)
क्षेत्रीय कार्यालय, कानपुर / Regional Office, Kanpur
भविष्य निधि भवन, सर्वोदय नगर, कानपुर 208005
Bhavishya Nidhi Bhawan, Sarvodaya Nagar, Kanpur - 208005
दूरभाष : 0512-2217464, 0512-2295307, ईमेल : ro.kanpur@epfindia.gov.in
पत्रांक 204/क.भ.नि. सं/आर.ओ. कानपुर/प्रशा-II दिनांक 29/06/2026

सार्वजनिक सूचना

समस्त सम्मानित कर्मचारी भविष्य निधि खाता धारकों को सूचित किया जाता है कि भविष्य निधि दावों के आवेदन एवं निपटान की प्रक्रिया को अधिक सुगम एवं सुदृढ़ बनाने हेतु सोफ्टवेयर के अपडेशन की प्रक्रिया चल रही है। इस कारण से कर्मचारी भविष्य निधि संगठन की वेबसाइट के माध्यम से प्रदत्त सुविधाएं 01 जुलाई, 2026 तक के लिए रोक दी गयी हैं। जिसके लिए खेद है एवं सोफ्टवेयर अपडेशन की प्रक्रिया दिनांक 01 जुलाई, 2026 तक पूर्ण हो जाने की सम्भावना है। जिसके पश्चात कर्मचारियों/नियोजकों को उपलब्ध सुविधाएं पूर्ववत् चालू हो जाएंगी।

कर्मचारी भविष्य निधि संगठन सम्मानित हित धारकों से सहयोग की अपेक्षा करता है। इस बीच कार्यालय में उपलब्ध रजिस्टर में अपना मोबाइल संख्या के साथ अपने कार्य का विवरण दर्ज कर दें ताकि संपर्क स्थापित कर समस्या का निस्तारण किया जा सके।

आपको हुयी किसी भी प्रकार की असुविधा के लिए कार्यालय को खेद है।

भवदीय
(प्रतीश सिंह)
क्षेत्रीय भ.नि. आयुक्त (प्रशा.)



SECURITY GUARDS BOARD FOR BRIHAN MUMBAI & THANE DISTRICT
(Constituted by the Government of Maharashtra)
Central Office : D-301/E-301, Sanpada Railway Station Complex, Sanpada, Navi Mumbai - 400 705. Tel. No.: 022-35252348/347/348/349/350
E-mail : sgb_sanpada@yahoo.co.in

NOTICE FOR E-TENDER

Tender Notice No.SGB/SEC/2026-5459 Date:- 30.06.2026

The Security Guards Board for Brihan Mumbai & Thane District invites Tenders on-line, from reputed and experienced Companies or Authorised Dealers, Authorised Dealers, on the Website <https://sgb.etenders.in>. The Tenders are as under:

Sr. No.	Tender No.	Subject	Last Date & Time For Submission Of Tender	Opening Date & Time Of Tender
1.	SGB/ Uniform Cloths/ 2026-27	Purchase of Uniform Cloths for Regd. Security Guards of the Board	20.07.2026 At 17.00 hrs	21.07.2026 After 14.00 hrs (As per Board's Convenience)
2.	SGB/ Leather Shoes/ 2026-27	Purchase & Supply of Leather Shoes for Regd. Security Guards of the Board	20.07.2026 At 17.00 hrs	21.07.2026 After 14.00 hrs (As per Board's Convenience)
3.	SGB/ Nylon Socks/ 2026-27	Purchase & Supply of Nylon Socks for Regd. Security Guards of the Board	20.07.2026 At 17.00 hrs	21.07.2026 After 14.00 hrs (As per Board's Convenience)
4.	SGB/ Rainy Wear & Gumboot/ 2026-27	Purchase & Supply of Rainy Wear & Gumboot for Regd. Security Guards of the Board	20.07.2026 At 17.00 hrs	21.07.2026 After 14.00 hrs (As per Board's Convenience)
5.	SGB/ Woolen Sweter/ 2026-27	Purchase & Supply of Woolen Sweter for Regd. Security Guards of the Board	20.07.2026 At 17.00 hrs	21.07.2026 After 14.00 hrs (As per Board's Convenience)
6.	SGB/ Uniform Accessories/ 2026-27	Purchase & Supply of Uniform Accessories for Regd. Security Guards of the Board	20.07.2026 At 17.00 hrs	21.07.2026 After 14.00 hrs (As per Board's Convenience)
7.	SGB/ Caps/ 2026-27	Stitching of Uniforms Caps for Regd. Security Guards of the Board	20.07.2026 At 17.00 hrs	21.07.2026 After 14.00 hrs (As per Board's Convenience)
8.	SGB/ Stitching of Uniforms/ 2026-27	Stitching of Uniforms for Regd. Security Guards of the Board	20.07.2026 At 17.00 hrs	21.07.2026 After 14.00 hrs (As per Board's Convenience)

For detailed information, Tender Documents, Specification and etc. please visit the E- procurement portal <https://sgb.etenders.in>. For any queries please contact on Mob. No. mention in Website.

Sd/-
(Gauravkumar R. Nalinde)
Secretary
Security Guards Board For Brihan Mumbai & Thane District.

Lucknow fire: NICH notice to DM, police commissioner; seeks action report in 2 weeks

Press Trust of India
New Delhi, June 29

THE NICH has issued a notice to the district magistrate and the commissioner of police of Lucknow in the wake of a recent fire incident at a multi-storey building in the Uttar Pradesh capital that resulted in the death of several students and injuries to many others.

It alleged in the complaint students were “trapped inside due to thick smoke, and some had to jump from the building to save themselves”, says the proceedings dated June 29. The complainant, Pawan Dubey, and O P Vyas, based in Delhi, also raised concerns regarding “possible violations of fire safety norms, lack of emergency exits and evacuation systems, negligence by regulatory authorities, and failure to ensure a safe environment for students”, it adds.

The complainant sought the Commission’s intervention to ensure the safety of students and educational institutions, adequate emergency preparedness and evacuation systems, fix accountability of regulatory authorities and “erring delinquent public servants”, and provide necessary medical treatment to all injured students.

other commercial establishments, and it resulted in the death of several students and injuries to many others.

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The complainant sought the Commission’s intervention to ensure the safety of students and educational institutions, adequate emergency preparedness and evacuation systems, fix accountability of regulatory authorities and “erring delinquent public servants”, and provide necessary medical treatment to all injured students.

PUBLIC NOTICE

Whereas, Director Town and Country Planning, Haryana ("DTCP") has granted License No.75 of 2022 dated 15.06.2022 in favour of Kvell Infrastructure LLP (LLP IN-ABC 4924) for setting up a Group Housing colony ("Colony") on land area measuring 4.5875 acres situated in in the revenue estate of Village Gwal Pahari, Sector-02, Gwal Pahari, Gurugram. DTCP had earlier approved the building plans of the said Colony vide Memo No.ZP-1835 / JD (RA)/ 2024/1287 dated 11.01.2024. Now vide memo No.ZP-1835-4/J SD(PK)/2026/22429 dated 25-06-2026, DTCP has granted in-principle approval for the revised building plans. Before granting final approval to the revised building plans, DTCP has directed the company to invite objections from existing allottees of the colony regarding the said revision in the building plans through a News Paper Advertisement/ Public Notice and informing each/allottee through a registered post/email for seeking their objections/ consent. Hence, this Public Notice is being issued by the company, requesting the existing allottees to submit their objection, if any, to the proposed revision of the building plans. For facilitating such submission of objections, a copy of the earlier approved building plans and in-principle approved building plans have been hosted on the company website namely www.kvellinfrastructure.com

A set of above said plans have also been kept in the office of Senior Town Planner, Gurugram at 3rd Floor, HSVP Complex, Sector -14, Gurugram & at the site office of the Colony at Sector -2, Gwal Pahari, Gurugram, for perusal of the existing allottees. Any of the existing allottee having objection to the in-principle approved revised building plans may file the same in the office of the Senior Town Planner, at 3rd Floor, HSVP Complex, Sector 14, Gurugram within thirty (30) days (i.e 29.07.2026 upto) from the publication of this Public Notice, failing which it shall be assumed that there are no objections to the in-principle approved revised building plans.

Place: Gurugram Date: 30.06.2026
KVELL INFRASTRUCTURE LLP
E-931, Lower Ground Floor, Chittranjan Park New Delhi-110019

GOVT. OF BIHAR

BIHAR COMBINED ENTRANCE COMPETITIVE EXAMINATION BOARD
I.A.S. Association Building, Near Patna Airport, Patna-14.

Website : bceceboard.bihar.gov.in / Helpdesk : helpdesk.bceceboard@bihar.gov.in
Adv. No.- BCECEB-2026/02 Dated 28.06.2026

सूचना

विज्ञापन संख्या-BCECEB/UGMAC)-2026/01 दिनांक 02.04.2026 के क्रम में NEET (UG)-2026 / NEET (PG)-2026 / AIAPGET-2026 के आधार पर UGMAC-2026 / UGMAC (Ayush)-2026 / PGMAC-2026 / PGMAC(Dental)-2026 / PGMAC(Ayush)-2026 में भाग लेने वाले Disable Quota / NRI Quota / Minority Quota के अभ्यर्थियों को एक बार पुनः सूचित किया जाता है कि पर्यटन द्वारा आयोजित होने वाले UGMAC-2026 / UGMAC (Ayush)-2026 / PGMAC-2026 / PGMAC(Dental)-2026 / PGMAC(Ayush)-2026 हेतु वर्गीकृत कोटा का लाभ लेने के लिए Online Application submit करने के समय वांछित अभिलेख अपलोड करना अनिवार्य होगा, तभी उनका आवेदन सम्बन्धित कोटि में स्वीकार्य होगा। Upload किये गये प्रमाण-पत्रों को Concerned Competent Authority से सम्युक्त कराया जायेगा। अभ्यर्थी सम्बन्धित अभिलेखों की तैयार रखें। अभिलेखों की विवरणी पर्यटन के वेबसाइट पर उपलब्ध है।

परीक्षा निबंधक



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India leads democracies in transparent polls: CEC

Express News Service
Srinagar, June 29

CHIEF ELECTION Commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar, who is on a three-day visit to Jammu and Kashmir, on Monday said India is leading the world's major democracies with a transparent electoral process.

Kumar, who visited central Kashmir's Budgam district to interact with the Booth Level Officers (BLOs), said: "I had an interaction with the pillars of democracy, the Booth level workers in Budgam... We discussed that preparation of

voter lists, voting and vote counting are part of the world's most transparent electoral process."

"All of them are audited by political parties or the candidates concurrently," Kumar said. He said after the 2026 electoral process, India is now leading the largest democratic countries and is the chairperson of the International Institute for Democracy and Electoral Assistance (IDEA). Kumar arrived in Srinagar on Sunday.

On Monday, he visited the Mata Kheer Bhawani temple at Tulmulla in Ganderbal.

ANDHRA PRADESH CAPITAL REGION DEVELOPMENT AUTHORITY
APCRDA Project Office, Amaravati, Rayapudi Post, Thulluru Mandal, Guntur District - 522237, Andhra Pradesh.
NIT No. MAU61-USJHB/BG/13/2026-HB
Dated: 29/06/2026

PROCUREMENT SHORT TENDER NOTICE
NAME OF WORK: APCRDA - "Construction of Judicial Residence (Hon'ble Chief Justice Bungalow), Architectural Finishes, Internal & External Electrical, Plumbing & Sanitary Fixtures, Fire Fighting Provisions, Lifts, DG, HVAC, Security Systems, External Development and Land Scaping etc., near Nelapadu, Amaravati, Andhra Pradesh".
The bid can be downloaded on AP e-procurement portal from **30.06.2026 to 20.07.2026 up to 14.00 Hrs.** Due date for submission of Bid is **20.07.2026 up to 15.00 Hrs.** Technical bid opening **20.07.2026 @ 16.00Hrs.** For further details Please refer to **www.apcprocurement.gov.in** and **www.crda.ap.gov.in**.

Sd/- COMMISSIONER, APCRDA, RAYAPUDI

भारतीय कंटेनर निगम लिमिटेड
CONTAINER CORPORATION OF INDIA LTD.
(एन एन डीपी बिल्डिंग) (ANAND NIDHI BUILDING)
NSIC New NIDBI Building, 2nd Floor, Okhla Ind. Estate (Opp. NSIC Okhla Metro Station), New Delhi-110020

NOTICE INVITING E-TENDER
CONCOR invites E-Tender in Single Packet System of tendering for the following work:-
Tender No. CONEP/Area-1/CML/AMC/2026-28/E-98825
Name of Work Annual Civil Maintenance Contract at MMLP-Khatwas (2026-28)
Estimated Cost Rs. 196.80 Lakhs
Completion Period 24 months from the 15th day after date of issue of LOA
Earnest Money Deposit Rs. 3.93,600/- (through e-payment)
Cost of Tender Document NIL
Tender Processing Fee (Non-refundable) Rs. 3540 (inclusive all taxes & duties through e-payment.)
Date of sale of Tender (online) 30.06.2026 (15:00 hrs) to 21.07.2026 (upto 17:00 hrs)
Date & Time of submission of Tender (online) 22.07.2026 (upto 17:00hrs)
Date & Time of Opening of Tender (online) 23.07.2026 at 15:00 hrs
For financial eligibility criteria, experience with respect to similar nature of work, etc., please refer to detailed tender notice available on website www.concorindia.co.in but the complete tender document can be downloaded from website www.tenderwizad.com/CCLOnly. Further, Corrigendum / Addendum to this Tender, if any, will be published on website www.concorindia.co.in, www.tenderwizad.com/CCLand and Central Procurement Portal (CPC) only. Newspaper press advertisement shall not be issued for the same.

General Manager (Engg), Phone No.: 011-41222500

BENGALURU WEST CITY CORPORATION
Office of the Executive Engineer, Mahalakshimpuram Division, 12th Main road, 11th Cross road, West of chord road, Bengaluru-560086

NO.EE/MLP/TENDE/E-PROC/08/2026-27 Dated: 29/06/2026
INVITATION FOR TENDERS (Short Term)
(Through kpp.Portal only)
The Executive Engineer, Mahalakshimpuram Division invites Item Rate tenders from eligible tenderers for the work details in the table given below. The Bidders shall be a registered in /CPWD/KPWD/Railways/MES / any State or Central Govt. organization. Tender documents may be downloaded from Government of Karnataka e-Procurement website <https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in/eportal/index.seam> under login for Contractors:

Sl. No.	Name of the Work/Amount put to tender in lakhs / EMD amount in Rs./Period of Completion
1	Improvements to Roads, drains and development of parks in Ward No- 36 Nalvadikrishnaraja Wodeyar, 37-Dr. Puneeth Rajkumar ward and ward no-38 Nandini Layout of Mahalakshmi Layout Assembly Constituency. Amount put to Tender : Rs.800.55 Lakhs, EMD (in Rupees): Rs.12,01,000/-, Period of Completion : 09 Months.
2	Improvements to Roads, drains and development of parks in Ward No. 40-Mahalakshimpuram, 41-Nagapur, 43-Kethamaranahalli, 39-Jaimaruthi Nagara, 42-Raja Mayuravarma, 44-Shankarmutt, 45-Shakthiganapathinagara,46-Kamalanagara and 47-Vrushabhavathi Nagara of Mahalakshmi Layout Assembly Constituency.Amount put to Tender: Rs.2321.75 Lakhs, EMD (in Rupees): Rs.23,21,750/-, Period of Completion : 09 Months.

Calendar of events:
1. Date of downloading of tender documents : **01-07-2026**
2. Last date of submission queries : **04-07-2026 within 3.00 P.M**
3. Date & time for Pre Bid Meeting : **04-07-2026 at 4.00 P.M**
4. Last Date & Time for receipt of tenders : **08-07-2026 Upto 4:00 P.M.**
5. Date & Time for Opening Technical bid : **09-07-2026 at 4.30 P.M**
6. Date & Time for Opening Financial bid : **10-07-2026 at 4.00 P.M**
7. Validity of Tenders : **180 Days**
Bid document may be referred for other terms and conditions and any Corrigendum/Addendum will be published & notified only through <http://kppp.karnataka.gov.in>, or Contact KPP Portal.
Sd/- Executive Engineer, Mahalakshimpuram Division, BECC

UP Rajya Vidyut Utpadan Nigam Ltd.
MALAWAN -ETAH - 207001
PUBLICATION OF GEM-TENDER NOTICE (IN/OUT OF STATE)

1. GEM Bid No: GEM/2026/B/7698614, Name of Work "Procurement of Outsourcing manpower of Paramedical Staff (04 nos Staff Nurse), for Project Hospital for 01 year at 2X660MW JTPP. Malawan, Etah" Estimated cost. Rs. 12,27,739.97 (Including GST) EMD Rs-15000.00, Last Date of uploading Bid -04.07.2026 12:00 hrs.
2. GEM Bid No: GEM/2026/B/7704350, Name of Work- "Procurement of Electrical Lighting Materials and DIN type fuses at 2X660MW JTPP, Malawan, Etah" Estimated cost: Rs. 8,12,109.64 (Including GST) EMD Rs-7000.00, Last Date of uploading Bid-09.07.2026 16:00 hrs.
3. GEM Bid Number: GEM/2026/B/7706589 Name of work:- Environment Assessment for Pollution Abatement at Jawaharpur Thermal Power Project, Malawan, Etah for the period of 01 year. Estimated cost: Rs.485433 /- (Including GST) EMD: Rs. 8,500.00/- Last Date of uploading Bid -06.07.2026 12:00 hrs.
4. GEM/2026/B/7711047, Name of work:- "Preparation of monthly accounts etc. with programming to the accounting relevant in the nigan on computer along with providing computer operator, computer, printer, ups and their consumable for office of the dy.cao, cfa & bo, 2x660mw Jawaharpur Thermal Power Project, malawan dist. etah,for the period of 01 year." Estimated cost: Rs. 4,22,055.00/- (Including GST), EMD Rs-8500.00, Last Date of uploading Bid -06.07.2026 15:00 hrs.
5. Gem Bid No: GEM/2026/B/7702071, Name of Work : "CONSTRUCTION OF NEW STAIRCASE IN 12 NOS OF WATCH TOWERS AT 2X660MW JAWAHARPUR THERMAL POWER PROJECT, MALAWAN DISTT- ETAH" Estimated cost: Rs. 23,09, 217.47/- (GST extra) EMD Rs. 46,200.00/-, Last Date of uploading Bid 14-07-2026 14:00 hrs.
6. Gem Bid/2026/B/7710707, Name of Work- "Work of Round the clock Operation of entire Signal & telecommunication (S&T) System and, Routine / Dail Monthly, Quarterly Half yearly and Annual schedules maintenance of Signal & telecommunication of Jawaharpur Thermal Power Station, from interchange point at Etah Rly Station to inside plant for 2 years." Estimated cost: Rs. 1,58,13,736.00/- (GST extra), EMD 3,20,000.00/-Last Date of uploading Bid-17-07-2026 16:00 hrs.
For information regarding Addendum/Corrigendum/Rejection of Bids kindly regularly visit Website <https://gem.gov.in>
पत्रक : 75 /अडीअभिप(नू)/2-660 मेवा/जलाशय/ दिनांक: 29.06.2026
"Save Electricity for Nation"

TET paper leak accused linked to Odisha JEE case, claims SIT

Hunt for kingpin launched, police widen probe across four states

Manish Kumar Pathak
Mumbai, June 29

THE SPECIAL Investigation Team (SIT) probing the Maharashtra Teacher Eligibility Test (TET) paper leak has launched a nationwide manhunt for the alleged mastermind, Bijendra Kumar Gupta (44), widening its investigation beyond Maharashtra to unravel what police suspect is an inter-state racket.

Police said Gupta, who allegedly operated under multiple aliases, is suspected to have been involved in around five examination paper leak cases, including the 2023 JEE paper leak in Odisha. Another case is also registered against him in Odisha. "We are trying to obtain details of that case from the concerned police station," an officer said.

The SIT has dispatched teams to Delhi, Haryana, Uttar Pradesh and Bihar to trace Gupta and uncover the wider network behind the racket. Police said Gupta was in constant contact with absconding accused Kapil Shrikrishna Dahiya and the three arrested accused, Dhiraj Singh, Akash Kumar and Rajiv Kumar.

Investigators said Dhiraj and Kapil had arrived in Bhiwandi several days before the examination to identify prospective buyers, primarily operators of coaching classes preparing students for the TET. Acting on a tip off, Thane Police laid a trap after an officer posed as a buyer. Once the accused were convinced they had found a customer, they allegedly contacted Gupta, who sent Rajiv and Akash with four sets of leaked question papers.

Police arrested Dhiraj, Akash and Rajiv at a hotel in Kongaon while they were allegedly attempting to sell the papers. Kapil, who had left for Pune a day earlier in search of another buyer, fled to Delhi after learning about the arrests

and has since gone underground. Thane Police has initiated the process of issuing a Look Out Circular against him.

Investigators found that the accused were operating in two separate groups, Dhiraj and Kapil in one, and Akash and Rajiv in another. Police believe the two groups were unaware of each other's activities and were independently managed by Gupta. The SIT has sought details from the Education Department on the printing, handling and transportation of question papers and is examining everyone involved in the chain. The Maharashtra State Council of Examination has a long standing contract with Agra based Mahim Patram Private Limited for printing exam papers.

Officials said the leaked papers recovered from the accused carried three different code numbers corresponding to examination centres in Washim, Latur and Jalna. Preliminary findings suggest the leak may have occurred during the printing or transportation stage, although investigators said all angles remain open. Police said Dhiraj Singh (28), a native of Panipat in Haryana,

became the sole earning member of his family after the death of his parents. His cousin alleged that Gupta had promised him a government job and taken money. When Dhiraj demanded a refund after failing to secure the job, Gupta allegedly sent him to Mumbai with Kapil, assuring him he would recover the money. Dhiraj's lawyer Sitander Redu said, "His client was unaware of the paper leak conspiracy".

Akash Kumar, a commerce graduate from Patna, is the only son in his family. Rajiv Kumar, also from Patna, holds a BSc degree. Police said Kapil's father is a retired armed forces personnel, while Gupta, a native of Samastipur in Bihar who operates from Delhi and Haryana, has allegedly been involved in cheating cases. The three arrested accused have been remanded to police custody until July 6. Police said the gang planned to sell each leaked TET question paper for Rs 2 lakh- Rs 3 lakh and expected to make nearly Rs 1.5 crore.

The Maharashtra TET, scheduled to be held on June 28 at 1,028 centres, was postponed after the leak came to light.

'China encroaching on ancestral land': Arunachal to probe

Sukrita Baruah
Guwahati, June 29

ARUNACHAL PRADESH Home Minister Mama Natung said on Monday that the state government would constitute a committee to investigate claims by a community organisation in Upper Subansiri district that the Chinese military had allegedly encroached on Indian territory along the border in the district.

The Nah Welfare Society (NWS), a community organisation based in Taksing in Upper Subansiri, which borders China, had recently written to the Deputy Commissioner of the district alleging the "establishment of Chinese camps inside Indian territory at the border" in the Taksing circle.

The letter alleged, "The Chinese government is very fast expanding its territory by occupying new and important places of our land situated in the border area. They have constructed roads, bridges, and set up military camps at many locations along the border in our ancestral lands, which were our hunting grounds where we

freely roamed and collected forest produce just a few years ago. Our cattle grazing areas are now under the occupation of the Chinese PLA."

The letter claimed that these activities have "increased manifold" in the last "10-15 years". "The intention and speed of the present activities of the Chinese PLA in the Taksing area is very alarming and a matter of grave concern for us. We are losing our land inch by inch by day to them," the organisation alleged.

Govt takes notice

Arunachal Pradesh Home Minister Mama Natung told The Indian Express that the state government is awaiting an official report from the district on these claims.

"Currently, these are still claims, and we are awaiting an official report on this based on findings by the district administration, elected representatives, locals and panchayat committees. If encroachment has happened, it will be very wrong. We will constitute a committee to find out what's going on," he said.

Lohagad fort murder: Police to conduct Chetan's gait analysis

Shubham Kurale
Pune, June 29

THE VADGAON Maval court on Monday extended the police custody of Siya Goyal and Chetan Chaudhary, accused in the Ketan Agarwal murder case, by four days till July 3, accepting the prosecution's argument that a forensic study of the accused's walking pattern, among 18 other investigative requirements, remained pending.

Among the more unusual grounds cited by the investigating officer was the need to conduct a gait analysis of Chaudhary, a forensic examination of a person's unique walking pattern.

The analysis is expected to be used to match Chaudhary's gait with footage obtained from CCTV cameras with a hoodie near the crime scene at Lohagad Fort.

A senior police officer said, "Chaudhary would be dressed in his original Hoodie attire and made to walk again at the same spot at Lohagad Fort, and the new video-recorded walk would be compared with that of CCTV footage recorded on June 18. Using AI tools, we will analyse the similarity, and it will help confirm his presence."

Both accused were produced before Judicial Magistrate First Class A M Vibhute at the Vadgaon Maval court in Maval taluka of Pune district.

Vipul Dushing represented Goyal, and Ram Shahane appeared as defence counsel for Chaudhary. Advocate Rajashri Virkud represented as the assistant public prosecutor. Senior Police Inspector Dinesh Tayade is the investigating officer.

The prosecution, presenting its case for police custody extension, listed 18 grounds on which further interrogation and investigation it said was necessary.

भारतीय कंटेनर निगम लिमिटेड
CONTAINER CORPORATION OF INDIA LTD.
(एन एन डीपी बिल्डिंग) (ANAND NIDHI BUILDING)
NSIC New NIDBI Building, 2nd Floor, Okhla Ind. Estate (Opp. NSIC Okhla Metro Station), New Delhi-110020

INVITATION FOR E-TENDER
CONCOR invite E-Bids for Open e-Tender (Single Bid System) for " Zonal Annual Maintenance Contract (AMC) for services pertaining to Sub stations and electrical installations at MMLP-Bali & MMLP-Mundra for 02 years." The brief of tender is as under:
Tender No. CONA-II/ZONAL/AMC/ELECT/ Bali&Mundra/2026-27
Total Estimated Cost **₹ 1,26,59,310 (Inclusive of GST)**
Cost of tender documents (Non-refundable) **₹1120/- (Inclusive all) through e-payment**
Tender Processing Fee (Non-refundable) **₹3540/- (Inclusive all) through e-payment**
Earnest Money **₹ 2,53,187 (through e-payment)**
Date of sale of tender (online) From 30.06.2026 at 17:00 Hrs. to 20.07.2026 upto 12:30 Hrs.
Last Date & Time of submission 20.07.2026 up to 14:00 Hrs. (E-Tendering Mode Only)
Date and time of Opening Tender 20.07.2026 at 15:00 Hrs.
The complete Tender Document for eligibility criteria and other details can be viewed & downloaded only from the website (www.tenderwizad.com/CCLIL). The tender notice is also available on the website www.concorindia.co.in and website of Public Procurement Portal (<http://eprocure.gov.in>). Bidders are requested to visit the websites regularly.
Group General Manager/P&S/Area-II

Bihar Museum, Patna
(An Autonomous Society under the Department of Art, Culture & Youth, Government of Bihar)
Nehru Path, Patna-800001
Notice Inviting Tender.

Tenders (Price Bids) in a two-bid system are invited for the execution of following work at Bihar Museum, Patna from registered contractor. The last date for submission of the bid is **22.07.2026 upto 3:00 pm**. The bid will be opened the same day at 3:30 p.m. The information can be obtained from the office of the Director General, Bihar Museum, Patna on any working day. Bid documents can be downloaded from the website <http://biharmuseum.org> /www.state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar / <https://state.bihar.gov.in/yac>

Sl no	Description of item	Unit	Qty.	Estimated Cost in Rupees	EMD In Rupees	Cost of Bid in Rupees.	Time of Completion
1	Supply, installation, testing and commissioning of Audio-Visual items and well on GT interactive in Children Gallery at Bihar Museum, Patna.	As mentioned in the BOQ		As quoted by the bidders.	1,20,000.00	10000/-	Two months

(Additional Director-Admin)
Bihar Museum

PR. No. 006686 (Art & Culture) 2026-27
नशामुक्त हो जाए बिहार, सुरक्षित रहे घर परिवार।

GOVERNMENT OF ODISHA
OFFICE OF THE CHIEF CONSTRUCTION ENGINEER,
CENTRAL RURAL WORKS CIRCLE, BHUBANESWAR

No. 3687/ Dated.25.06.2026
NOTICE
FOR PRADHAN MANTRI GRAM SADAK YOJANA (PMGSY)
NATIONAL COMPETITIVE BIDDING THROUGH "e"-Procurement
Bid identification No. Tender-Online-C.C.-10 of 2026
The Chief Construction Engineer, Central Rural Works Circle, Bhubaneswar on behalf of Odisha State Rural Road Agency invites the percentage rate bids in electronic tendering system for construction of roads & Bridges under Pradhan Mantri Gram Sadak Yojana [PMGSY-IV (B-I)] in the District of Khordha for 07 (Seven) Nos. of Packages with estimated cost totaling to Rs.13.45 Cr. including their maintenance for five years from the eligible contractors registered with State PWD / CPWD / MES / Railways. The registered bidder of outside Odisha, can also participate in this process, but shall have to subsequently undergo registration with the appropriate authority of the State Govt. preferably within a month of the deadline for bid submission, but prior to signing of the contract
Date of release of Invitation for Bids through e-procurement. Dtd. 03.07.2026
Availability of Bid Documents and mode of submission: The bid document is available online and should be submitted online in www.pmgstyenders.gov.in. The bidder would be required to register in the web-site which is free of cost. For submission of the bids, the bidder is required to have a valid Digital Signature Certificate (DSC) from one of the authorized Certifying Authorities.
The bidder shall transfer online the EMD @2% of the amount as specified for the work in the table Col No. 10 in the Annexure of NIT.
Last Date/Time for receipt of bids through e-procurement: 17.07.2026 upto 5.30 P.M
For further details and corrigendum (if any) please log on to www.pmgstyenders.gov.in.
Sd/-
Chief Construction Engineer
Central Rural Works Circle, Bhubaneswar
OIPR-25001/25082/1/26-27/0010

NORTHERN RAILWAY
(E-Auction Notice)

The Sr. Divisional Commercial Manager/ G, Northern Railway, Delhi Division, New Delhi invites e-Auction through IREPS (<https://ireps.gov.in/>) for allotment of Misc contracts of NFR at following railway stations:

E-Cats logue No.	Type of Asset	Station	Date & Time for e-auction
Advt- Jun-05-26	Passenger Announcement System (PAS)	New Delhi, Delhi, Hazrat Nizamuddin, Anand Vihar Terminal, Delhi Sarai Rohilla, Karnal, Kurukshetra, Panipat, Sonapat, Meerut Cantt., Meerut City, Muzaffarnagar, Sahibabad, Ghaziabad, Rohtak, Delhi Shahdara, Faridabad, Patwal.	Start: 09.07.2026 at 11:00 hrs
Advt- Jun-06-26	Vinyl Stickers/ Wrapping Exterior	Train No. 22479/80 and 22485/86	Start: 10.07.2026 at 11:00 hrs
Advt- Jun-06-26	DDIS UTS	290 UTS Counters over Delhi Division.	Start: 10.07.2026 at 11:00 hrs
Advt- Jun-06-26	DDIS PRS	165 PRS Counters over Delhi Division.	Start: 10.07.2026 at 11:00 hrs
Advt- Jun-06-26	Glow Ball Towers	4 Glow Ball Towers at Hazrat Nizamuddin.	Start: 10.07.2026 at 11:00 hrs
Advt- Jun-06-26	Emergency Medical Room (EMR)	Meerut City, Ghaziabad, Sarai Rohilla, Panipat, New Delhi, Anand Vihar Terminal, Hazrat Nizamuddin, Delhi, Rohtak, Railway Station	Start: 10.07.2026 at 11:00 hrs
Advt- Jun-06-26	Procurement and Supply of Linen Bag	Reserved Coaches of Mail/ Express Trains of Delhi Division.	Start: 10.07.2026 at 11:00 hrs
Advt- Jun-06-26	Unipole	Modinagar.	Start: 10.07.2026 at 11:00 hrs
Advt- Jun-07-26	Waiting Rooms	Karnal, Budhlada, Baghapat Road, Shami, Khakra, Jakhla, Tohana Railway Station	Start: 10.07.2026 at 11:00 hrs

Website particulars where complete details of E-Auction can be seen. <https://ireps.gov.in/> (E-Auction-Leasing)

No. 7PUB/E-Auction/NIT-2026 Date: 29.06.2026
SERVING CUSTOMER WITH A SMILE 2230/2026

MINISTRY OF ROAD TRANSPORT & HIGHWAYS, NEW DELHI
OFFICE OF THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER
NATIONAL HIGHWAY DIVISION,
DIN DAYAL NAGAR, BOOTY ROAD, RANCHI-834008
Pho. No. 0651-2360428, E-Mail ID- eenhranchi-jhr@nic.in

INVITATION FOR BIDS (IFB)
NATIOAL COMPETITIVE BIDDING
Tender Reference No. NH/RANCHI/EPC/2026-27/01 Dated- 29.06.2026
1. The Executive Engineer, National Highways Division, Ranchi invites item rate bids on-line for the work detailed in the table given below. The bidder is advised to read & examine carefully all instructions including addendum/amendments to ITB, conditions of contract, contract data, forms, terms, technical specifications, bill of quantities etc. in the Bid Document before bidding.

Sl. No.	Name of work	Approximate value of work (In Rs.)	Bid Security (In Rs.)	Cost of Document (in Rs.)	Period of completion
1	Maintenance of road from Km.39.100 to Km.85.560 of NH-143AG for year 2026-27 in the State of Jharkhand under SR	21,39,42,302/- (exclusive of GST & LC)	21,40,000.00	Tender cost Rs. 10000.00 and GST-1800.00 Total-11800.00	9 (Nine) Months including rainy season.

2. Website e-tendering portal of MORTH <https://eprocure.gov.in> may be referred for detailed terms and conditions of the Invitation for Bids (IFB) and Bidding Documents (including e-Tendering instruction to applicants), which is available online.
3. Tender will be available online on MORTH portal <https://eprocure.gov.in> and e-tendering portal of MORTH <https://eprocure.gov.in> from 06.07.2026 at 10.30 A.M. to 27.07.2026 upto 17.00 P.M. Bids must be submitted online only at e-tendering portal of MORTH <https://eprocure.gov.in> on or before 17:00 P.M. on 27.07.2026 and technical bids received online will be opened on 30.07.2026 at 15.00 P.M.
4. The prospective bidders who do not posses Digital Signature Certificate (DSC) may get the same issued from approved agencies.
Executive Engineer
National Highway Division, Ranchi
Phone: 8757650998, e-mail : eenhranchi-jhr@nic.in
PR 383618 Road(26-27).D

कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय
पेयजल एवं स्वच्छता प्रमंडल, मेदिनीनगर

शुद्धि-पत्र
पेयजल एवं स्वच्छता प्रमंडल, मेदिनीनगर अन्तर्गत आमंत्रित ई-प्रोक्योरमेन्ट निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना संख्या—DWSD/RPWS/Med-04/2026-27 (1st Call) (पाण्डू ग्रामीण जलापूर्ति योजना) जो PR No. 382286 (Drinking Water and Sanitation) 26-27*D द्वारा विभिन्न समाचार पत्रों में प्रकाशित है। जिसे अपरिहार्य कारणों से निविदा की तिथि निम्न प्रकार संशोधित किया जाता है :-

क्र० सं०	विवरण	पूर्व में प्रकाशित तिथि एवं समय	संशोधित तिथि एवं समय
1	वेबसाइट पर निविदा प्रकाशन की तिथि एवं समय	19/06/2026 / 12.30 बजे अपराह्न में।	10.07.2026 / 12.30 बजे अपराह्न में।
2	प्री बीड की तिथि एवं समय	24/06/2026 / 12.30 बजे अपराह्न में।	13/07/2026 / 12.30 बजे अपराह्न में।
3	बीड प्राप्ति की अंतिम तिथि एवं समय	04/07/2026 / 05.00 बजे अपराह्न तक	23.07.2026 / 05.00 बजे अपराह्न तक
4	सरकार के सचिव, सूचना प्रौद्योगिकी एवं ई-गवर्नेंस, झारखण्ड मंत्रालय, के ज्ञापन क्र 120 दिनांक 03.10.2023 के आलोक में विपत्र का मूल्य एवं अग्रधन की राशि Online जमा करने की अंतिम तिथि एवं समय	04/07/2026 / 05.00 बजे अपराह्न तक	23.07.2026 / 05.00 बजे अपराह्न तक
5	निविदा खोलने की तिथि एवं समय	06/07/2026 / 05.00 बजे अपराह्न में।	24.07.2026 / 05.00 बजे अपराह्न में।

यह शुद्धि—पत्र परिमाण विपत्र का भाग होगा एवं शेष पूर्ववत् रहेंगे।
कार्यपालक अभियंता, पेयजल एवं स्वच्छता प्रमंडल, मेदिनीनगर
PR 383477 Drinking Water and Sanitation (26-27)_D

ACTION COMES AFTER LATEST SIT REPORT

Sabarimala ‘gold theft’ scandal: Court orders fresh case against CPM and CPI leaders

Shaju Philip
Thiruvananthapuram, June 29

THE KERALA High Court on Monday directed the SIT, probing the alleged theft of gold from Sabarimala temple, to register a criminal case against two LDF leaders and senior executives who were at the helm of the Travancore Devaswom Board (TDB), which manages the temple, from 2023 to 2025.

The latest involves CPI(M) leader and TDB ex-president PS Prasanth and TDB ex-member and CPI leader A Ajikumar.

Last year, the SIT had registered two other cases in which CPI(M) leader and former legislator A Padmakumar was arrested. The cases pertained to the theft that allegedly took place in 2019 during the period of the first Pinarayi Vijayan-led LDF government in the state.

The new case involves allegations regarding further transportation of the idols to Chennai in 2023, during LDF government’s second consecutive term.

The cases were registered after the HC found that the Dwarapalaka idols at the temple, originally gold-clad in 1998, were transported in 2019 to a firm in Chennai at the behest of Unnikrishnan Potty, allegedly under the guise of funding and overseeing a fresh gold-plating. However, it was found that when returned, the idols were allegedly missing some of the gold that was already on them.

2023 gold-plating

The court said, “In order to conceal the pilferage and misappropriation of the gold in 2019, the sponsor (Potty), the TDB leadership, and others at the temple entered into a crimi-

nal conspiracy to once again transport the Dwarapalakas to Chennai under the guise of carrying out fresh gold plating.”

In the latest case, apart from the LDF leaders, Potty is among the other accused. The charges against them include criminal conspiracy, criminal breach of trust and forgery.

The Bench of Justices Raja Vijayaraghavan and K V Jayakumar directed registration of the case when the SIT submitted its latest probe report.

Referring to the alleged conspiracy behind the decision to take the items again for gold plating in 2023, when P S Prasanth was TDB president, the court said, “This was done despite being aware that such action was contrary to the provisions of the Devaswom Manual as well as the court directions, and despite knowing that the same was intended to conceal the earlier acts of misappropriation and would result in further loss to the Devaswom.”

The court said Potty allegedly influenced Prashanth to support the 2023 plan. The SIT informed the court about the roles of others, too, including other TDB members, in the latest case. The court directed the SIT to file an additional report.

The scandal surfaced September last year when the Sabarimala Special Commissioner informed the court that the gold-plated copper coverings of the Dwarapalaka idols had been removed without prior notice. Prasanth was the TDB president then.

The items were reportedly sent to Chennai for maintenance. They were returned after the court’s intervention.



The devastated Keyi Panyor district on Monday. Several villages were cut off due to floods and landslides, prompting rescue operations. PTI

Rain ravages Arunachal: 3 killed, 12 districts affected

Sukrita Baruah
Guwahati, June 29

WITH MONSOON rain causing flash floods and landslides in Arunachal Pradesh, seven local residents who set out to rescue four fishermen stranded in the swollen Sisiri river in Lower Dibang Valley found themselves stranded after their raft overturned in the strong current.

Following a multi-agency rescue operation, during which people even attempted to use elephants to reach those trapped, the four fishermen and the seven locals were rescued.

At least three people have died as rain continued to wreak havoc in Arunachal Pradesh over the past week, and the state’s infrastructure, particularly roads and highways, has

sustained significant damage.

Normal life was disrupted in at least 12 districts as floods and landslides damaged infrastructure, cut off villages and triggered large-scale rescue operations, officials said.

Amid this, a well-meaning rescue effort by seven locals of Dambuk in Lower Dibang Valley went askew on Sunday when their rubber raft overturned while they were trying to rescue the four fishermen stranded in the river as a result of flash flooding.

“The four men had gone to lay bamboo traps for fishing in a stream. The water level in the stream itself was low, but it flooded suddenly and they got stranded on a river island. A private group of locals, on humanitarian grounds, tried to rescue them on a rubber boat.

They located three of them and were returning in the evening, but when they tried to dock on the riverbank, the boat overturned,” said Dambuk MLA Puinnyo Apum.

According to state disaster management authority, five of the people on the raft were able to swim back to the shore, but five of them were swept away. Four of them later found their way to a river island, and one caught hold of a drifting log.

As of 10.30 pm Sunday night, the NDRF was able to rescue the person who was trapped on the log, but five people remained stranded, with rescuers not able to ascertain the location of one of the four fishermen.

On Monday morning, an IAF helicopter arrived at the site and airlifted two stranded

people by 11 am. The remaining, including a stranded fisherman who was located on another river island, were rescued by boat by the NDRF. In East Siang, eight major road stretches remained blocked, leaving Yagrun, Tekang and Sibut villages cut off from Pasighat.

In the meantime, another potential disaster de-escalated Monday, said Arunachal SDMA secretary Dani Sulu, after a massive landslide blocked the flow of Siji river in Lower Siang district. The landslide had created a “temporary natural dam”, causing water to collect into a lake-like formation, which prompted the district administration to issue a warning about potential of a “serious and life-threatening situation”. WITH PTI

Minister: Schools that don’t make Marathi must to lose recognition

Express News Service
Mumbai, June 29

THE MAHARASHTRA government on Monday warned that schools failing to make Marathi a compulsory subject will face stringent action, including cancellation of recognition.

Replying to a starred question during Question Hour in the Legislative Assembly, School Education Minister Dada Bhuse said all schools in the state, irrespective of their medium of instruction, are legally bound to teach Marathi from Class 1 to 10 and conduct examinations in the language. “If any school fails to comply with government’s order, it will first be fined Rs 1 lakh. Continued non-compliance will lead to the cancellation of its recognition,” Bhuse said.

He also announced a state-wide verification drive to ensure schools are implementing the Marathi mandate. Physical inspections will be carried out, and reports will be sought from education department officials. Schools found violating the rules will face action. The issue was raised by BJP MLA Atul Bhatkhalkar, who sought clarity on whether schools will be required not only to teach Marathi but also hold exams in the language.

Prey density healthy in core areas, low in territorial forest: Project Cheetah director

Nikhil Ghanekar
New Delhi, June 29

GOATS AND cattle together make up for 50% while Chital (spotted deer) formed 42% alone of the detected kills by 19 free-ranging cheetahs under Project Cheetah in the Kuno National Park and wildlife division landscape, according to the latest Project Cheetah progress report, which also identified continuous prey augmentation and improvements in habitat as central to sustaining reproductive cheetahs and the growing size of cubs.

The progress report for September 2024 to December 2025, released by the Union Environment Ministry on Sunday, reflecting dietary diversity and



Cheetah Gamini with her cubs at Kuno National Park. @BYADAVBJP

prey availability challenges faced by the project. It noted that the dietary diversity reflects ‘ecological adjustments’, with evidence of small Indian civet kills, as well as opportunistic preying of birds and other small mammals.

India has 53 big cats under Project Cheetah.

“Continuous monitoring of the cheetahs, as found during the previous two years, showed that the main prey species hunted by cheetahs in and around Kuno NP was chital. In the free-ranging environment,

chital accounted for 42% of detected kills, followed by goat (30%), cattle (20%), Nilgai (2%), hare, sambar, chinkara, sheep, and wild pig contributes (1% each),” the report stated.

Free-ranging mothers with cubs, such as Jwala and Gamini, demonstrated higher hunting frequencies, indicating elevated energy demands, the report noted. “Notably, certain free-ranging groups exhibited predation on domestic livestock, particularly goats and cattle... underscores the importance of proactive

negative interaction mitigation and community engagement measures,” the report noted.

Jwala and her cubs, released into free-ranging areas in early 2025 predominantly relied on domestic goat kills, accounting for 40%, followed by cattle and chital. Agni and Vayu male cheetahs fed mostly on chital (39%), followed by domestic cattle (26%), domestic goats (19%), sheep (10%) and Nilgai and wild pigs (3% each).

Detailed tracking and analysis of their movements also showed the free-ranging cheetahs are moving far and wide, with some like the male cheetah Agni exploring a vast area of 3,198 sq km in the first 30 days since its release from the enclosed area. This was also witnessed recently in April as KP-2, a young male cheetah, made his way into Ranthambore’s tiger forest, and had to be immobilized to get him back to Kuno.

Project Cheetah Director Uttam Kumar Sharma said it is natural for cheetahs to explore long distances and vast territories, and they have been found to have covered 12 dis-

tricts, six each in Madhya Pradesh and Rajasthan.

On concerns regarding sufficient prey availability, Sharma told *The Indian Express*, “The prey density is healthy in the national park boundaries, especially in core areas, at around 23 chitals per sq km. However, in territorial forest of the wildlife division, wild prey density is low. This is the region where the cheetahs prey on goats and cattle, in a multi-use area with competing interests from local communities. However, kill trends are still developing, evolving, so they should be seen in that context.”

Kuno national park in Sheopur district is spread over 748.76 sq km with adjoining forest areas falling within Kuno wildlife division, collectively covering 1,235 sq km, now increased to nearly 1,800 sq km. The national parks form part of the larger Sheopur-Shivpuri dry deciduous open forests spanning 6,800 sq km, and Kuno River traverses the park area.

Along with Kuno, three cheetahs are hosted at Gandhi Sagar sanctuary in Neemuch and Mandsaur districts, MP.

ROW OVER URDU CLASSES

BJP town president arrested over school principal assault in Telangana, gets bail

Nikhila Henry
Hyderabad, June 29

TWO DAYS after a school principal, Aamir Khan, was assaulted by BJP workers for allowing Urdu to be taught in a school in Armoor, Nizamabad district, Telangana Police on Monday took the party’s Armoor town president, M Balu, into custody. His arrest was recorded late Monday night.

Balu, however, got conditional bail from a local court.

Balu and other BJP workers had allegedly manhandled Khan, an English teacher and principal of Bharat Chandra High School, because a woman teacher at the same school taught Urdu instead of Hindi for “two days”. The alleged assault occurred on June 27.

Khan, who is now unavailable for comment, had earlier told *The Indian Express* that Urdu was taught in the school “only for two days”, at the insistence of a section of parents. Khan had explained that the management stopped teaching the language, which is a second language in Telangana, soon after another section of parents objected to it.

“However, the issue was escalated by the BJP leadership,” Khan had said.

When contacted, Balu had told *The Indian Express* that the school was teaching kalima and namaz to students “under the garb of teaching Urdu”. When enquired, Khan had justified the teaching of Urdu by saying “it is the sec-



Principal Aamir Khan

ond language in the state”, Balu had said.

The Telangana Police had booked two cases — one against Khan and the school correspondent, Mallaiiah, for “promoting enmity between communities”, and the other against Balu and others for allegedly assaulting Khan. Khan was booked based on a complaint by the Armoor tehsildar, who accused the school management, including Khan, of teaching the language without taking permission. Balu was booked based on the complaint filed by Khan.

The BJP called for a bandh in Armoor Monday. The bandh remained total, though no untoward incidents were reported.

Meanwhile, P Rakesh Reddy, BJP MLA from Armoor, told *The Indian Express*: “Why should Urdu be taught in an English medium school? Who is behind this? They were also teaching students kalima and namaz to convert them into Islam. Who is funding this?”

The school management has, however, stated that “no religious texts were taught to the students”.

Chargesheet too late, what’s the point now: Sarla Bhat’s family

Kashmiri Pandit Sarla Bhat, a nurse, was abducted, killed by JKLF militants in 1990

Arun Sharma
Jammu, June 29

THE STATE Investigation Agency may have filed a chargesheet against Jammu Kashmir Liberation Front chief Yasin Malik and four others for the 1990 abduction and killing of Kashmiri Pandit nurse Sarla Bhat, but the Bhat family believes it has come too late.

A Kashmiri Pandit nurse at the Sher-e-Kashmir Institute for Medical Sciences (SKIMS), Sarla was abducted from her hostel by JKLF militants on April 14, 1990, and her bullet-riddled body was found five days later in old Srinagar city.

In its 737-page chargesheet filed in a special court in Srinagar, the SIA named Malik as a key accused in her abduction and killing.

Officials have called it a “historic milestone in the pursuit of justice for victims of terrorism” and “one of the most significant breakthroughs in the investigation of legacy terror crimes in Jammu and Kashmir”.

But Bhat family says the government should have acted sooner. “What kind of justice is it? It’s much too delayed,” says

her cousin, Prediman Krishan Bhat. “What’s the point now? For us, it’s a joke. It has no relevance.”

In an earlier conversation with *The Indian Express*, Bhat spoke of the blast outside the family home after Sarla’s funeral and the subsequent attack by a mob when the family went to the cremation ground to collect her ashes.

The attacks forced the family to leave Kashmir with “just a briefcase of documents and a bag of clothes”, he had said.

On April 14, 1990, Sarla had just finished her shift and was leaving the SKIMS main building when JKLF militants abducted her in a waiting vehicle, accusing her of being a police informer.

After her body was found, allegations of torture and sexual assault emerged.

“We visited her home in Anantnag after the body was found, and stayed the night,” Prediman said. “The next morning, an uncle and I were given the duty of collecting her ashes from the cremation ground while the rest of the family gathered their valuables so they could move to Jammu.”

First trip to a city: How 40 women from remote UP village fulfilled their ‘lifelong dream’ in Varanasi

Manish Sahu
Lucknow, June 29

IN THE remote village of Pandi in Uttar Pradesh’s Chandauli district, a group of 40 women left for a trip to Varanasi, along with their families. They had never visited any city before. For many, a lifelong dream of praying at the revered Kashi Vishwanath Temple was fulfilled Monday morning with the help of the Uttar Pradesh Police.

The pilgrimage, organised by the UP Police, came after the villagers shared their longcherished dream of visiting Varanasi during a community outreach programme last week. As part of the Mission Shakti, senior police officers reached out to the women residents during a community outreach programme in Pandi.



The group of women at Kashi Vishwanath Temple in Varanasi on Monday. EXPRESS

Located near the Uttar Pradesh-Bihar border, Pandi is a remote forest village cut-off from the outside world. For many women, their lives are limited to Pandi, without ever travelling beyond the village. Pandi is about 120 km from

Varanasi, yet for many residents the journey had remained beyond their reach.

“Our village is located on the Bihar border and is surrounded by forests. Because of its remoteness, we have remained largely cut off from the outside

world,” says Prabhavati Kumari, one of the women who joined the trip.

“When the police officers asked if we wanted to visit Varanasi, all the women immediately agreed. Most of us had never seen a city before,” she said.

Prabhavati travelled with her husband, America Kharwar, and their two children.

The 40 women — most over the age of 40 — boarded a police-arranged bus, many accompanied by their young children. Five men from the village also joined the pilgrimage.

A police escort led by an inspector-rank officer travelled in a separate vehicle to assist the group throughout the journey. The convoy left the village at around 9 am, with the police also arranging meals and other logistical support for the travellers.

Pandi, a predominantly Dalit village in Naugarh block of Chandauli district, lies about 80 km from the district HQs and just 3 km from the Bihar border. Home to around 80 families, the village depends largely on subsistence farming, daily wage labour and forest produce. Most households earn barely enough to cover basic necessities such as food and clothing, while only a handful of younger residents have left the village in search of work.

“It has always been our dream to step outside our village, but visiting the Kashi Vishwanath Temple was an even bigger dream,” said Beena Kumari, who was with her four-year-old child. “... We never imagined that one day we would stand inside the temple and offer prayers.”

Nimbooda to Rind Posh Maal: Row over Bollywood songs in Odisha textbooks

Sujit Bisoyi
Bhubaneswar, June 29

A CLASS 8 Odia textbook’s mention of Bollywood numbers ‘nimbooda...nimbooda’ and ‘Rind Posh Maal’ as examples of folk songs has kicked up a row, bringing more scrutiny to a state already reeling from a controversy over blunders in school textbooks.

The Class 8 book, Kruti (art education), features the lyrics of ‘nimbooda...nimbooda’, from the 1999 Bollywood hit ‘Hum Dil De Chuke Sanam’ as an example of a Rajasthani folk song. It also has ‘Rind Posh Maal’, popularised by the 2000 movie ‘Mission Kashmir’, as an example of a Kashmir folk song.

The mention of these songs, along with the Odia song ‘Raja Doli’ in Class 5 English book Pallavi and ‘Bumbro...Bum-

bro’ in Class 3 book, as examples of folk songs have sparked a row. All four songs have folk roots, with ‘Rind Posh Maal’ originally penned as a love poem by the late 18th Century Kashmiri poet, Rasul Mir.

Meanwhile, the Class 6 textbook Kaushala Sikshya (skill education) teaches students how to prepare ‘Jhal Mudi’, fruit salad, buttermilk, ‘lassi’, ‘mint chutney’, ‘sandwich’ and ‘Kachumber raita’.

When contacted, a senior School and Mass Education Department official said the songs were included to familiarise students with the culture of various states.

“It has been done under the ‘Ek Bharat...Shresta Bharat’ initiative. Both songs are there in the NCERT books from which we have brought it to books prepared by Odisha govt,” the offi-

cial said, requesting anonymity.

This comes at a time when State Council of Educational Research and Training (SCERT) textbooks are under increased scrutiny after 1,678 errors were found in them. At 705, the Class 8 textbooks account for the highest number of errors, including factual inaccuracies, grammatical mistakes, spelling errors and wrong references.

Meanwhile, officials in the Odisha Text Book Production and Marketing wing admitted that part of the textbook printing work was outsourced to private presses at a cost of Rs 21 crore. They said the wing alone could not meet the entire printing requirement for new textbooks.

Odisha School and Mass Education Minister Nityananda Gond said revised pages carrying the corrections will be distributed to schools and DEOs.

Classifieds

PERSONAL

I, TANVEER FATEMA, W/O, AZAM ABBAS, R/O, E-11, 2, Gali No.02, Shastri Park, Seelampur North East Delhi-110053, Have Changed My Name To TANVEER FATIMA, For All Purposes.

0040863131-1

I, Kamal Kishore Gupta, R/O U-265, Jail Road, Sector-67A, Vaishnav Enclave, Badshahpur-122101, have changed my Minor Son name from Krish to Krish Gupta.

0040863170-5

I, Prince s/o Shamsher Gahlawat r/o Plot No.-663, Gali No.-2, Saini Vihar, Mundka Village, Delhi-110041 have changed my name as PRINCE GAHLAWAT permanently.

00408663033-4

I, KM ABHA ARAYA, W/O- PRAVIN KUMAR, R/O-395 396C NYAY KHAND-2 INDIRAPURAM, GHAZIABAD U.P.201014, HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO ABHA ARYA, FOR ALL, FUTURE PURPOSES.

0040863132-5

I, TABSSUM @ TABSSUM W/o Mohd. Danish, R/o D-First-233-34, Madangari, New Delhi-110062, have changed my name to TABASSUMNIGAR for all purposes.

00408663091-1

I, Mohd Danish Wahab Ansari, Son of, Abdul Wahab Ansari, Residing at, House No.B-3/1, MIG-Flats, Sarai Khaili, Sadar-Bazar, Delhi G.P.O., North Delhi, Delhi-110006, have changed my name to DANISH WAHAB ANSARI, permanently.

0040863149-6

I, Pradeep Indrabahadur Singh Rathaur S/o Rathaur Indrabahadur Bhuresingh R/o F-1402, J M AROMA, SECTOR 75, NOIDA GAUTAM BUDH NAGAR, UTTAR PRADESH -201301, have changed my name from Pradeep Indrabahadur Singh Rathaur to Pradeep Singh Rathaur. Henceforth I would be known by the name of Pradeep Singh Rathaur for all future purposes.

0071044805-1

I, ABHISHEK, S/O RAGHVENDRA KUMAR MISHRA, R/O D-135 2ND FLOOR CHHATARPUR EXT.N, 110074, have changed my name to ABHISHEK MISHRA for all purposes vide affidavit No. IN-DL41135601420042Y dated 27/JUN/2026.

0071044686-1

I, ANJANA ROY W/O SUDARSHAN MALAKAR R/O -125 A/5 S BLOCK GALI NO 13 BHOLA NATH NAGAR SHAHDARA DELHI-110032 HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO ANJANA MALAKAR

0040863066-1

I, VK Sharma, S/o-Suresh Kumar Chandra Sharma, R/O-616/1- A, Shastri Gali, Vishwas- Nagar, Shahdara, Delhi-110032, have changed my name to Vinod Kumar Sharma, for all purposes.

0040863131-10

I, Rekha Rani W/O Shri Hemant Kumar Gupta R/O B-6/335-336, Upper Ground- Floor, Sector-7, Rohini, Delhi-110085, have changed my name to Rekha Gupta.

0040863133-2

I, Vijay Kumar, S/O-Mehendra Singh, R/O-150A, 3rd Floor, Sant-Nagar East Of Kailash, Srinivas Puri Delhi-110065, I, Have Changed My Name From Vijay Srivastava

0040863129-7

I, HANS RAJ, S/O ATTAR SINGH, R/O-FLAT-NO.5061, TOWER-4, BLOCK-A, GH-07, CROSSING REPUBLIK GHAZIABAD, UP-201016, HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO HANS RAJ PANWAR FOR ALL FUTURE PURPOSES

0040863131-3

I, RAMESH NEHRA W/o-Surendar Mohan Nehra R/O-3/137, Sunder Vihar New Delhi-110087, have changed my Name from RAMESH NEHRA to RAMESH SOOD, permanently

0040863170-7

I, Jyoti Nagi W/o Shri Gurcharan Singh, R/O 2421, Second Floor, Hudson Lines, Kingsway Camp, Delhi -110099 have changed my name to Jyoti for all purposes.

0040863028-2

I, JATIN BEDI S/o Sushil Bedi, 824, Sector-14, Escortsnagar, Faridabad -121007 have changed my name to JATIN.

0071044774-1

I, INDRAJEET KAUR, W/O PUNEET SINGH MARWAH, R/O-C-BLOCK 1004, GAUR GREEN VISTA, NYAY-KHAND-1, INDIRAPURAM, GHAZIABAD, UP-201014, HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO INDRAJEET KAUR MARWAH, FOR ALL, FUTURE PURPOSES

0040863132-7

I, Yograj Sharma S/O Sh. Gopal Lal R/O B-183, FF, Janta colony, Shivaji Vihar, Tagore Garden, New Delhi-110027, have been changed my name from Yograj to Yograj Sharma for all future purpose.

0050292249-1

I, Rajesh Singh Kataria, R/o-Tule Ram, R/o-House-No.1, Near-Sheetla Gas Dodawan, Ashok-Vihar Phase-3, Gurugram (Haryana)-122001, have changed my name to Rajesh Kataria, for all, Purposes.

0040863149-8

I, Mohd. Tufail S/o Mohd. Jamal Uddin R/o House No-D-631, Gali No.-2, Chauhan Banger, Seelampur, North East, Delhi-110053, have changed my name to TUFAIL AHMAD for all future purposes.

0071044691-1

I, PIVUSH MADAN S/O PREM KUMAR MADAN R/O BA-3 SHALIMAR BAGH DELHI-110088, HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO PIVUSH MADAAAN

0040863132-1

I, Anam Khatoun D/o Intzar Ahmad R/O H.No-E-100, New Seelampur, North East, Delhi-110053, have changed my name to Anam Malik.

0040863071-1

I, Ritu Bhardwaj, W/o-Rajesh Bhardwaj, R/O-C-505, Third-Floor, Back-Side-Market, Block-C, Yojna-Vihar, East Delhi, Delhi-110092, have changed my name to Ritu Sharma. Ritu Bhardwaj and Ritu Sharma is one and the same-person.

0040863131-12

I, MOHAMMED AZHAR, S/O-MOHD YAMIN, R/O-7978, GALI SHAMSHUDDIN MOHALLA SHEKHAN, BARA HINDU-RAO, DELHI-110006, CHANGED MY NAME TO MOHD AZHAR, for all, future purposes.

0040863149-1

I, KM SEEREN AKHTAR W/o Shahbaz Ahmed, E-12/20, 2nd-Floor, Haux Rani, Delhi-17 have changed my name to SEEREN AKHTAR.

0071044777-1

I, VIPIN KUMAR GUPTA, S/O-SATISH KUMAR GUPTA, R/O-669 MUKIMPURA SUBZI MANDI MALKA GANJ DELHI-110007, HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO VIPIN KUMAR.

0040863129-9

I, PRITI GUPTA W/O NISHU SINGHLA R/O 2515/191, 1st FLOOR, TRI NAGAR, GANESH PURA, DELHI-110035, HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO PREETI SINGHLA FOR ALL FUTURE PURPOSES.

0071044695-1

I, PIYUSH KAPOOR S/O-INDER MOHAN KAPOOR R/O A-156, MALJIS PARK, ADARSH NAGAR, DELHI-110033, have changed my MINOR CHILD name RIDWIN to RIDWIN KAPOOR.

0040863131-5

I, Sangita W/o Anil Kumar Mittal, R/O RZ-22, Rati Ram Park, Naya Bazar, Najafgarh, Delhi-110043 have changed my name to Sangita Mittal permanently.

0040863170-9

I, Chaudhary Safaati Ali, S/O Khurshed Ali R/O-H.No-538, A-Block, Gali No-10, Shri Ram Colony, Delhi-110094, Have Changed My Name To CHAUDHARY SHAAFAAT ALI.

0040863132-9

I, Ankit Tomar S/o Dalveer Singh Tomar, R/o A-091, Sector XU-1, Greater Noida , UP-201308, have changed my name to Ankit Singh Tomar

0071044767-1

I, Samer Singh Ramrup S/o Ramrup, R/O 2053-A, 4th Floor, Block-C, Vyapar Kendra, Sushant Lok Phase-1, Gurugram (Haryana)-122009, have changed my name to Samer Singh.

0040863149-10

I, Rahul Mohan Lal s/o Satish Mohan Lal r/o D-765, 3rd Floor, Chitrnjan Park, Delhi-110019 have changed my name as RAOUL LAL permanently.

0040863033-1

I, HUSAN ARA KHAN, D/O-HAFIZ UR REHMAN, R/O-M2 TF, BLOCK-M, JOGA BAI-EXTN OKHLA, NEW-FRIENDS COLONY, SOUTH-DELHI 110025, CHANGED MY NAME TO HUSAN ARA, for all, future purposes

0040863129-2

I, Basanti darji, W/o-Dipak darji, R/o-198/55 F/Floor Right-Side, Saraka Mohalla, Ramesh Market, East Of-Kailash, South Delhi-110065, Have changed my name to Laxmi darji

0040863129-11

I, AMEETA DEVI W/O-ANIL MATHUR R/O 197 SATGHARA VILLAGE KARALA DELHI-110081. HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO AMEETA FOR ALL PURPOSES.

0040863132-2

I, TUNTUN JHA @ TUNTUN JHA ACHAL S/O Mahabir Jha, Ward-18, Angna Pro Colony, Digli, Lalbagh, Darbhanga Bihar-846004, have changed my name to TUN TUN JHA ACHAL.

0071044739-1

I, ROHIT JASWAL, S/O-UJAJANT KUMAR JAISWAL, R/O-C-190 STF-1, RAMPARSHA COLONY Ghaziabad Uttar Pradesh 201011 have changed my Name To ROHIT JAISWAL permanently.

0040863149-3

I, MOHAMMAD KAIF S/o Deen Mohd, 185-A, Gali No-6, J-Extension, Laxmi Nagar, Delhi-92 have changed my name to MOHD KAIF.

0071044779-1

I, GAUSIYA SULTANA SHAIKH MAHMOOD, W/O Shaikh Mahmood Shaikh Ibrahim, residing at 8-10-159, Kat Kat Gate, Yonous Colony, Chhatrapati Sambhajinagar, Maharashtra, hereby declare that my correct name is GAUSIYA SULTANA SHAIKH MAHMOOD. Due to a clerical error, my name was earlier recorded as SHAIKH GAUSIA BEGUM MAHMOOD in my son's passport. Henceforth, I shall be known and identified as GAUSIYA SULTANA SHAIKH MAHMOOD for all purposes.

0040863026-1

I Arvind Kumar, Son of Braham Singh, Resident of SG-10, Sector-63A, Noida, 201306. Change My name from Arvind Kumar Chauhan to Arvind Kumar for all future purposes.

0130066310-1

I, PIYUSH KAPOOR S/O-INDER MOHAN KAPOOR R/O A-156, MALJIS PARK, ADARSH NAGAR, DELHI-110033, have changed my MINOR CHILD name SATWIK to SATWIK KAPOOR

0040863131-7

I, SHANTI, W/O MR. MOHARBAN, R/O-H.No-1, 7, SIDDHARTH-BASTI, HARI NAGAR, ASHRAM, NEW DELHI-110014, have changed my name shanti devi to Shanti, for all future purpose

00408663032-1

I, SHUBHANGI GUPTA W/o Aditya Jindal R/O C1 Block House No-48 Ashok Vihar Phase-2 Delhi-110052 have changed my name to SHUBHANGI JINDAL

0040863170-11

I Md Yusuf S/o Mohmad Munsareem Khan R/O House No A -90, Kharak Riwara, Near Rashid General Store, Satbari, South Delhi, Delhi -110074 have changed my name to Yusuf Khan for all purposes.

0040863028-6

I, MOHD TAYYAB, MOHD TAIYAB, S/O- SHAMSHAD ALI, R/O-7058, GALI JAMUN WALI, BERI WALA BAGH, AZAD MARKET, DELHI-110006, have changed my name to MOHAMMAD TAYYAB, for all, future Purposes.

0040863132-11

I, Priyanka Dewan, D/o Sunil Priyan, R/o 81, 3rd Floor, Navjivan Vihar, Delhi-110017 wish to clarify that my correct name is Priyanka Diwan and henceforth I shall be known as Priyanka Diwan for all purposes.

0040863102-2

I, NEERAJ S/O JOGINDER SINGH LAMBA R/O H. No. A-4/121, Sector-17, Rohini, Delhi-110089, have changed my name to NEERAJ LAMBA

0040863170-1

I, HAFIZ MASHKOUR AHMED, S/O- AWAZ ALI, R/O- HOUSE-NO-3497, 4TH-FLOOR KUCHA LAL MAN, DARYAGANJ, CENTRAL, DE LHI-110002, Changed my name to MASHKOUR AHMED, for all, future purposes.

0040863129-4

I, Veena Rani W/O-Rajiv Kalra R/O-631 Sec-7b Faridabad, Haryana, have Change Name To Veena Rani Kalra For All

0040863129-13

I, Shilpi @ Shilpi Rani W/o-Nitin Aggarwal R/O H.No.179-C, Miya Wali Gali, Gurgaon (Haryana)-122001, have changed my name to Shilpi Aggarwal.

0040863170-4

I, Neelam w/o Shamsher Gahlawat r/o Plot No.-663, Gali No.-2, Saini Vihar, Mundka Village Delhi-110041 have changed my name as NEELAM GAHLAWAT permanently.

0040863033-3

I, RAJ KUMAR, S/O-LATE JAGDISH CHANDER MANOCHA, R/O-115, MANOCHA APARTMENTS, H-BLOCK, VIKAS-PURI, DELHI-110018, HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO RAJ KUMAR MANOCHA, FOR ALL FUTURE, PURPOSES.

0040863132-4

I, Someshwar Kumar S/o Dina Nath Jha, RZ-1127, Gali No-10, Sadh Nagar, Palam Colony, Delhi-45, have changed my name to Kumar Someshwar.

0071044746-1

I, Anshul Yadav, S/o- Shri Raj Singh, R/O-House- No.64/4, Hans Enclave, Naharpur Rupa, District Gurugram, Haryana-122001, have changed my name from ANSHU YADAV to ANSHUL YADAV, for all future purposes.

0040863149-5

I, ASHOK NARAYAN, S/O PREM NARAYAN SAXENA R/O FLAT NO E-204 BLOCK E 2ND FLOOR EXPRESS GREENS PLOT NO GH-1/1 SECTOR 1 VAISHALI I.E. SAHIBABAD GHAZIABAD UTTAR PRADESH -201010 have changed my name ASHOK NARAYANN SAXENA for all future purposes

0071044802-1

I, GEETA BIST WIFE OF VIKRAM SINGH BISHT RESIDENT OF 57 BELTARI KAWARBAN PITHORAGARH UTTARAKHAND 262520. HAVE CHANGED MY NAME FROM GEETA BIST TO GEETA DEVI VIDE AFFIDAVIT DATED 22 JUN 26.

0071044674-1

I, Anisha Jain W/o Vikram Poddar R/O 130, Sunder Nagar, Mathura Road, Delhi-110003, have changed my name to Anisha Poddar for all purposes.

0040863034-1

I, Darvesh, S/o-Kalicharan, R/O-P-28, Gali, No-3, Bhari-Colony, Shahdara, East Delhi-110032, have changed my name to Darvesh Anand, for all purposes. Darvesh and Darvesh Anand is one and the same-person.

0040863131-9

I, Hardeep Kaur Sharma W/O Ashish Sharma C-6/24, Third Floor, Sector-5, Rohini, Delhi-110085, have changed my name to Hardeep Kaur.

0040863133-1

I, DIGVIJAY SINGH S/o Inderjeet Singh Saini, RZ-1/19, Gali No-4, SF, Tuglakabad Extn., Delhi-19, have changed my name to DIGVIJAY SINGH SAINI.

0071044772-1

I, Vivek Kumar, S/o Ashok Kumar R/O W-31, 4th Floor, Uppals Southend, Sector -49-50, Gurgaon (Haryana), have changed my name to Vivek Mittal.

0040863170-3

I, MITALI AGGARWAL, W/O-TUSHAR RAJAWAT, R/O-FLAT. NO-601, TOWER-KM-01, JAYPEE GREENS, WISH-TOWN SEC-134, NOIDA MAHARISHI-NAGAR, GAUTAM-BUDDHA NAGAR, UTTAR PRADESH 201304, HAVE CHANGED MY-MINOR CHILD-NAME KIARA KANDHARI TO KIARA AGGARWAL, for all, future purposes.

0040863129-6

I, Sarjeet Kumar, Son Of, Jagmohan Gupta R/O KP-140 2nd Floor Have Changed My Name To Sarjeet Goel .

0040863131-4

I, KRISHAN, S/O-RAMESH CHANDER, R/O-97/12, Gali No-12, Devi-Lal Nagar, Gurgaon, Haryana-122001, HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO KRISHAN DAHIYA.

0040863129-10

I, Doshi Sweta Satishkumar, W/o-Roshan Mehta, R/O-G-65 Second-Floor, Gujrat Vihar, Vikas-Marg , East-Delhi, Delhi-110092, have changed my name to Sweta Mehta , for all Future Purposes.

0040863131-2

I, Manoj Kumar Yadav, father of, Umang Yadav, R/O-Chandi Pur, Dadra, Amethi, Musafirkhana, U.P.-227813, have changed my son's name, from Suraj to Umang Yadav and he shall hereafter be known as Umang Yadav.

0040863170-6

I, Jagdish Sindhwani S/o Chiman Lal, R/O A-3/302, First Floor, Paschim Vihar, West Delhi-110063 have changed my name to Jagdish Kumar for all purposes.

0040863028-1

I, ROHIT GUPTA/ROHIT S GUPTA, S/O- SUBHASHCHANDRA GUPTA, R/O SG-1/1006 SAYA GOLD AVENUE, VAIBHAV KHAND, INDIRAPURAM, GHAZIABAD, U.P. 201014, HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO ROHIT SUBHASHCHANDRA GUPTA, FOR ALL, FUTURE PURPOSES.

0040863132-6

I, Madhumita Das W/o Biswendu Das R/O F4 1404 Panchsheel Greens-1 Sec-168 Greater Noida West G.B.-Nagar U.P.-201318 Have changed my name to Madhumita Deb for all future purposes

0071044751-1

I, SANDEEP KUMAR, S/o-Late VIJAY KUMAR, R/o D -245, Gali No.5, Nalanda School, Mandawali Fazalpur, Delhi-110092, have Changed my Name to SANDEEP SINGH, for all Purposes.

0040863149-7

I, Rathaur Upasana Pradeepsingh W/o Pradeep Singh Rathaur R/o D-903, Richmond Grand, Corporate Road, Makaraba, Ahmedabad City, Ahmedabad, Gujarat, 380051, have changed my name from Rathaur Upasana Pradeepsingh to Rathaur Upasana. Henceforth I would be known by the name of Rathaur Upasana for all future purposes.

0071044809-1

I, Girish Kumar Kapoor S/o J.R Kapoor R/o A-201, Skytech Metrott, Sector-76, Noida, Distt-Gautam Buddha Nagar (U.P.)-201301 have changed my name from Girish Kumar Kapoor to Girish Kapoor. Hencefore I would be known by the name of Girish Kapoor for all future purposes.

0071044690-1

I, Santosh Kumar Paswan, S/o-Navmi Paswan, Residing at, Banjaria, P.O.Bankata, Dist.Deoria, UP-274704, have changed the name of my minor daughter, Palvi alines Pallavi Kumari, Aged-8-Years and she shall hereafter be known as Pallavi Kumari.

0040863131-11

I, Vimla, W/o Late Hari Singh, R/O D 293 A /1, Pratap Vihar, Ghaziabad, UP declare that in my husband's Army records (BEG, No: 1403177H), my DOB is wrongly recorded as '06/01/1961' instead of correct DOB '10/01/1961'. Further, I have changed my name from 'Bimla Devi' to 'Vimla'. Both are one and the same person.

0040863102-1

I, ANUPAM KUMARI, W/O-RAJEEV KUMAR, R/O-FLAT, NO.E-1903, SECTOR-1, APEX GOLF AVENUE, SPORTS CITY, GREATER NOIDA WEST, GAUTAM BUDDHA-NAGAR, UTTAR PRADESH-201009, have changed my name to ANUPAM, for all purposes.

0040863129-3

I, Shweta Kalra w/o Raoul Lal r/o D-765, 3rd Floor, Chitrnjan Park, Delhi-110019 have changed my name as SHWETA LAL permanently.

0040863033-2

I, ANITA BALA, W/O-RAJ KUMAR MANOCHA, R/O-115, MANOCHA APARTMENTS, H-BLOCK, VIKAS PURI, DELHI-110018, HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO ANITA MANOCHA, FOR ALL, FUTURE PURPOSES

0040863132-3

I, BIJENDRA SONI S/o Ratan Lal Soni, WZ-225, Gali No-6, Sadh Nagar, Palam Colony, Delhi-45, have changed my name to Bijender Soni.

0071044742-1

I, NISCHAY MASAUN, S/o SH. DEEPAK KUMAR, R/O-17/158, SUBHASH NAGAR, NEW DELHI-110027, have changed my name from NISCHAY KUMAR to NISCHAY MASAUN, for all future purposes.

0040863149-4

I, Muani Devi W/o Ramnath Sah R/o Village Khurian, Konkli, Rohtas, Takiya Bazar, Bihar-821113, have changed my name to Kalpato Devi

0071044797-1

I, DIVESH GOEL S/o-Sanjay GOYAL, R/O-H.No.161-162, Upper Ground Floor, Pocket-8, Sector-22, Rohini, Delhi-110086 have changed my name to DIVESH GOYAL for all-purpose.

0040863077-1

I, Puneeta, w/o-Rajesh Tyagi, r/o-Flat

● **RESULTS**
ROUND OF 32
South Africa 0-1 Canada
Los Angeles Stadium
Brazil 2-1 Japan
Houston Stadium

● **MATCH SCHEDULE**
ROUND OF 32
Netherlands vs Morocco
Monterrey, **6.30 am** (Tuesday)
Ivory Coast vs Norway
Dallas, **10.30 pm** (Tuesday)
France vs Sweden
New Jersey, **2.30 am** (Wednesday)
Mexico vs Ecuador
Mexico City, **6.30 am** (Wednesday)

ZEE5 OTT & UNITE8 CHANNELS



Hong Myung-bo . AP

Hong quits as Korea boss after group-stage exit

HONG MYUNG-BO resigned as head coach of South Korea on Sunday following the country's group-stage exit from the World Cup. Hong made the announcement at the team's training camp in Guadalajara after results on Saturday meant the Koreans would not advance to the last 32 as one of the eight third-placed finishers in the group phase. "I would like to sincerely apologise to the citizens who have loved Korean football and always supported the national team," Hong said. Hong was appointed in July 2024 as the long-term replacement for Juergen Klinsmann. REUTERS

Czechia coach resigns after woeful campaign

CZECH NATIONAL team coach Miroslav Koubek resigned his post on Monday after the team's poor World Cup showing that generated harsh criticism at home over the 74-year-old's decisions during the tournament. Koubek blamed "stupid mistakes" and exhaustion from heavy travel for his team's World Cup exit after a 3-0 defeat by co-hosts Mexico in their last match left them bottom of Group A with only one point gained in a draw with South Africa. "A media campaign based on a number of half-truths and fabrications against me also contributed to my decision," Koubek said in a statement. "In this atmosphere, my work for the Czech national team would no longer make sense." REUTERS

● **PUNCHING STEREOTYPES AWAY**

The safe hands of Black goalkeepers breaking down football's racial barrier

Shuvaditya Bose
New Delhi, June 29

WHAT UNITES Ghana's Benjamin Asare, Ivorian Yahia Fofana, Japanese Zion Suzuki and Senegalese Edouard Mendy? Besides none wanting to guard the goal at the outset of their careers, they are also all Black goalkeepers. For much of football history, those two words have not coexisted. The game has produced elite Black strikers, wingers and defenders, but Black goalkeepers have been a rare commodity. This World Cup, in particular, has challenged perceptions. Statistics corroborate. Six of the 20 goalkeepers with the highest save percentages so far in this competition are Black — a dramatic increase from the corresponding figure of just one from 20 at the 2022 World Cup. On raw saves, six of the top 20

Substitute Martinelli's stoppage-time winner cleans out Japan

Sandip G
Boston, June 29

BRAZIL MAKES grand stages; just as grand stages make Brazil. Down a goal, their ageing legs showing, Brazil produced a stirring comeback, masterminded by their sagely manager Carlo Ancelotti and his tireless troops. The 1-2 defeat was cruel on the persevering Japanese, heartbroken in stoppage time, but the mightiest footballing empire would live another day, even if precariously. The Brazilians in the stands were exhausted after a game of seesawing drama that ended with Gabriel Martinelli's serene winner. He didn't start the game, was not hyped as his fellow forwards, but in the clutch of clutch moments, a grand footballing tradition in jeopardy, he struck the goal of his life.

There was nothing spectacular about the goal, but every element of it was note-perfect; from Bruno Guimaraes's pass, his first touch and the shot past a crushed Zion Suzuki, the Japanese goalkeeper who had kept them in the game. Brazil's first half meltdown was not surprising. Given Brazil's fragility, the conception of Japan's goal was foreseeable. Receiving the mis-passed ball from Danilo near the centre circle, Kaishu Sano teed off, twisting and tearing past the slumberous Brazilian shirts, and nailed a low shot past Alison's outstretched arms. Casemiro was not far from him at one juncture, but was left chasing the shadow of Sano's shadow. Only minutes ago had he been brandished a yellow card. In the momentum of the shot, Sano slumped onto the



Brazil's Martinelli scored the winner in added time. REUTERS

ground. When he dragged himself back onto his feet, he felt the sweet taste of the earth again, as teammates piled on his back. It was his first goal for his country. The defensive midfielder starting the game proved to be an inspired choice. The yellow wave in the stands

sat muted in shock. The Japanese revelled, the white flag with the red sun fluttering proudly in the arena. A goal secured against the run of play, the narrative of the contest until Brazil equalised was predictable. Japan would defend resolutely, often with

five men at the back, wait, latch onto any loose ball and maraud upfield, like an unstoppable wave. Brazil's nerves snapped, a lurid fear seized them. In their overeagerness to equalise, they lost the cohesion they had exhibited in the pre-hydration break spell, when they had four shots. Japan gradually asserted themselves in the game, dripping Brazil's will and hope, drip by drip.

No room

Japan's backline functioned like an impenetrable wall, confiscating Vinicius Junior and reducing him to a passenger. The Brazil talisman hardly got a sniff on goal. Only Matheus Cunha breathed in relative comfort, and saw his low drive finger-tipped by Japan's goalkeeper. Ancelotti is no magician. He had inherited the weakest Brazil iteration. No profound

speech or novel tactic could rouse the team from mediocrity. In modern football, a team cannot win merely on its attacking riches. His face betrayed little anxiety, even though he hooked Luis Pacqueta, who looked discomfited, for Endrick in the second half. Brazil needed a surge of inspiration to defend its proud legacy.

The kiss of life nearly arrived in the 51st minute, but Suzuki defiantly blocked Guimaraes' thunderbolt header. Japan stretched every sinew and spent every ounce of their energy as Brazil buzzed, ravenously seeking the equaliser. The Selecao finally barged the door open, Casemiro singing his redemption song with a bullet header. Brazil then could have snatched the lead through a piece of unalloyed wizardry. Vinicius zig-zagged through narrow lanes, guarded by fer-

ocious Japanese sentinels, and poked a shot from the outside of his boot, only to brush Suzuki's glove and clank the far post.

The third quarter was a tactical triumph for Ancelotti. Endrick's entry necessitated the shift to a more enterprising 4-2-4, a necessary gamble. An extra attacker at the front defanged the teeth of Japan's supersonic fullbacks.

They had to contain a quartet with cunning and tricks. Their relentless harried them. It was such a tense game that the usually solemn Ancelotti whipped up into a blizzard of emotions. He nearly tripped himself when Ryan's whiplashed free-kick deflected off a Japanese shirt. But by the skin off their teeth, Japan clung on, and even enjoyed a brief spell of possession towards the end of normal time. But the unkindest blow was waiting.

Cape Verde captain accused of rape: Report

Express News Service
New Delhi, June 29

WORLD CUP debutants Cape Verde's historic qualification for the knockout stage on Saturday has been marred by an investigation into rape charges levelled by a Brazilian woman against their captain on Sunday.

According to Brazilian news outlet *Globo*, forward Ryan Mendes is accused of sexually assaulting a woman who worked as a translator with the team in New Zealand during the FIFA series tournament played between March 27-30 this year. *Globo* reported that the woman alleged that Mendes entered her hotel room in Auckland and physically and sexually assaulted her.

The alleged incident was reported to authorities, and she underwent a sexual assault examination. The woman is said to have reported the incident to three Cape Verde officials, who did not respond to the allegations.

Football's global body, FIFA, said in a statement to USA Today that "any allegations of misconduct" will be taken seriously and that they were in contact with the New Zealand authorities. "Please understand we cannot comment further at this stage," FIFA's statement said. The 36-year-old Mendes, who featured in all three group-stage matches at the World Cup, has featured in all by 17 minutes in the group stage.

Since making his national debut, Mendes has won 100 international caps and recorded 22 goals. Having spent a majority of professional career in France and the UAE Pro League, Mendes currently represents Turkish second division club Iğdır.

Cape Verde's qualification has been among the heartwarming stories of the World Cup's expanded 48-team pool. An archipelago of 10 volcanic islands not far from the Western African coast, Cape Verde finished second in Group H, securing a berth in the World Cup knockouts at their first attempt.



Stephen Eustaquio (second from left) scored a last-minute goal against South Africa. REUTERS

The refugee sons who carried Canada into the round of 16

Sriram Veera
Mumbai, June 29

DEBEAH DAVIES remembers the guns — not the crack of them, but their presence as a fact of daily life in Monrovia. When the Second Liberian Civil War erupted, Debeah and Victoria fled to a refugee camp in Ghana. They built a life in a tin hut not much larger than a minivan. Their fourth-youngest child was born there and given the name Alphonso.

Less than one percent of the world's refugees are resettled every year. In 2005, Debeah's family were among that fraction. A country called Canada said yes. They went to Edmonton, where a shy boy with broken English started kicking a ball with the other boys.

On Sunday in Los Angeles, Alphonso Davies — captain of Canada, Champions League winner, UNHCR Goodwill Ambassador, former resident of a refugee camp — made his first appearance at this World Cup, having missed the group stage with a hamstring injury. He came on, and Canada were transformed. They won 1-0, Stephen Eustaquio — who had lost both parents within the

previous 12 months — scoring in the 92nd minute. They are in the Round of 16 for the first time in their history.

In goal was Milan Borjan, whose family fled the Balkan war and settled in Canada when he was 13. After Canada's win over the United States in January 2022, he put it simply: "Canada gave my family everything. When somebody gives you that much love, you have to return it."

Ten days ago in Vancouver came a moment that tells one everything about this team. Nathan Saliba — 22, from Montreal, his father Claude having played football back in Haiti — had just scored Canada's fourth goal in a 6-0 win over Qatar, their first-ever World Cup victory.

He ran to the corner and held up a jersey with the number 8 on it. The number wasn't his. It belonged to Ismael Kone, stretched off 40 minutes earlier with a broken tibia and fibula.

Kone was born in Abidjan. He was seven when his mother landed with him at Montreal's Trudeau airport. "I came to give a good life first of all to my son," she told CBC Sports.

He learned to play at a neighbourhood park, and became one

of the best midfielders in this tournament before a knee-high tackle ended his World Cup.

Jonathan David scored a hat-trick that evening. Haitian parents, Brooklyn birth, Port-au-Prince childhood, Ottawa youth football, rejected by Salzburg and Stuttgart, recruited by Belgian club Gent. His mother Rose died of cancer before he was 20. He was already in Belgium by then.

Men from Liberia, Serbia, Haiti, Ivory Coast, Portugal, Nigeria, England, and every province of Canada — including a 20-year-old who emailed his way onto the roster — have come together to form this team. It's nothing that has represented Canada on a major sporting stage before.

At 17, Alphonso Davies stood in front of FIFA delegates, voice cracking, lobbying for North America's World Cup bid. He said: "A country called Canada welcomed us in, and the boys on the football team made me feel at home. My dream is to someday compete in the World Cup."

Debeah Davies said once that Canada had done a lot for his family. Every time his son steps on the pitch, it's for them.



Japan's Zion Suzuki has suffered racial abuse throughout his career. AP

posedly require leadership and decision-making, like goal-keeping.

Prior to 2026, France had never arrived at a World Cup with a Black first-choice goalkeeper, until Mike Maignan. Steve Mandanda has played in this competition, but he has al-

ways been an understudy to Hugo Lloris. Maignan, though, is reshaping boundaries. Born to a Haitian mother and a Guadeloupean father, he honed his skills at the Paris Saint-Germain academy. As first-choice at AC Milan, and now for France, Maignan's is

“I know I am being criticised, but I would like people to stop writing racist things. I will not let this break me”

ZION SUZUKI,
AFTER RECEIVING RACIST ABUSE.

the biggest breakthrough.

The AC Milan custodian had once walked off a Serie A game after being racially abused by Udinese fan. Addressing the incident, he wrote on X: "It's not the player who was attacked. It's the man, it's the father. It's not the first time it's happened to me and I'm not the first person it's happened to. We've had statements, publicity campaigns, protocols and

nothing has changed. Today it's a whole system that must take responsibility."

Senegalese Mendy is one of the few Black goalkeepers to win the UEFA Champions League. "It (racial abuse) has happened to me many times. There are few of us (African goalkeepers). That's why as an African goalkeeper in the Premier League, I have to give my best to sweep the stereotypes away and open the way for others," he had said.

Zion Suzuki, of Japan, switched off his Instagram comments after a 2-1 defeat to Iraq at the AFC Asian Cup. His DMs were flooded with racial abuse. "I know I am being criticised, but I would like people to stop writing racist things. I will not let this break me," he stated. Lionel Mpsasi, of DR Congo, faced the same during a match against Toulouse in 2021.

Benjamin Asare still plays his club football in Ghana, and throughout his career, has had to juggle numerous odd jobs. Bus conductor. Mason. Polythene bags seller. Steel Bender.

Mendy was unemployed at 22, queuing up outside a job centre in Le Havre. Mpsasi, once French number 1 Mike Maignan's teammate at Paris Saint-Germain, found no takers and had to work as a school supervisor to make ends meet.

Cape Verde's Vozinha and Haiti's Johnny Placide are free agents, and can only hope their World Cup saves save them from unemployment. Curaçao's Eloy Room faces similar uncertainty, with his contract due to expire in November.

Ordinary men, by every measure. Except, they are doing the extraordinary task of punching one of football's oldest typecasts.

Wimbledon: Sinner made to sweat in Rd 1



Jannik Sinner beat Miomir Kecmanovic in five sets. AP

Reuters
London, June 29

WORLD NUMBER one Jannik Sinner survived an early scare in his Wimbledon title defence but the Italian shook off the rust and fought past Serb Miomir Kecmanovic 4-6 6-3 6-7(6) 6-2 6-3 on Monday to reach the second round.

Victory in Sinner's first competitive grass court match of the season following his premature French Open exit last month was his 94th win at the Grand Slams, drawing him level with Nicola Pietrangeli for the most by an Italian.

It was far from comfortable as Sinner lost the opening set to spark concerns among fans recalling his second-round shock at Roland Garros, but normal service soon resumed in the second set which the 24-year-old secured with a fiery ace.

But more tense moments followed as Sinner grimaced after a fall in the next set and later appeared to have bloodstains on his shoe for a separate issue, and though he soldiered on, he crumbled in a tiebreak that looked his for the taking. The four-time Grand Slam champion roared back to life and cruised through the fourth set to force a decider, where he prevailed to book a second-round meeting with Portugal's Nuno Borges.

Serena to return

Former world number one Serena Williams will be the centre of attention on Tuesday when she sets foot on the grass at the All England Club for the first time in four years to face Maya Joint in the first round at Wimbledon.

Williams, who has won 23 Grand Slams, has set herself a relatively low bar at this year's Wimbledon in what will be her first singles appearance at a Grand Slam since the 2022 U.S. Open. The 44-year-old American, who will also compete in the doubles alongside her sister Venus, has won seven Wimbledon singles titles but said before the tournament that she was just focused on enjoying herself.

• ORDER OF PLAY

CENTRE COURT: Taylor Townsend v 3-Iga Swiatek; Alexander Blockx v 2-Alexander Zverev; Serena Williams v Maya Joint

COURT NUMBER 1: 6-Taylor Fritz v Dusan Lajovic; Lois Boisson v 2-Elena Rybakina; Stan Wawrinka v Matteo Berrettini

Live on JioHotstar & Star Sports Network, 3.30pm onwards

Team India can't slip up in race to qualify for 2028 Olympics

Mihir Vasavda
Mumbai, June 29

THE QUALIFICATION system for cricket's return to the Olympic Games has made one thing abundantly clear: India can no longer afford to treat bilateral T20Is as expendable. India lost two T20Is to Ireland last week. More such defeats could cause India to drop in the rankings and potentially impact its 2028 Olympics qualification.

Under the qualification criteria released by the International Olympic Committee (IOC), only six teams will feature at the Los Angeles Games. One berth is reserved for hosts USA, provided they meet a minimum ranking require-

ment — the US must be ranked 15 or better by the end of the qualification period in December this year.

Four other direct places will not simply go to the top four teams in the ICC rankings. Instead, they will be awarded to the highest-ranked eligible nation from four different continents. And the final spot will be decided through a final global qualification tournament involving the eight highest-ranked teams that haven't qualified. For India, that makes every ranking point precious. The team is comfortably placed at the top of the ICC charts at the moment. With a rating of 272, India is ahead of the second-placed England, at 262.

If India holds on to its spot, Olympic qualification becomes straightforward. But should Pakistan — the next best Asian

• Number Plate

6

• Number of teams in the Olympics. **USA**, as hosts, will get **one spot. Four top-ranked continental teams**, as on December 31, 2026, will qualify directly. **One** remaining spot will go to a team that wins the **qualification tournament** involving eight highest-ranked unqualified teams.

team — overtake India in the rankings at the end of the qualification window on December 31, 2026, they would claim Asia's direct berth, leaving India to fight through the eight-team Final Olympic Global Qualification Tournament for the last available place.

That is why seemingly insignificant T20Is suddenly assume enormous importance.

In recent years, India have frequently rested senior players and experimented with combinations in bilateral series. Surprise defeats — such as the loss to Ireland — have been viewed as little more than statistical blips. Under the Olympic qualification system, however, every defeat has the potential to affect ranking points and, ultimately, direct qualification.

India will play five T20Is in England, starting July 1 and travel to Zimbabwe from there for three more T20Is. India will then host the West Indies for five matches in October before travelling to New Zealand for a five-match series.

The five games in New Zealand and will be of significance. If New Zealand — just behind Aus-

tralia — improve their position, it would mean Australia will miss the direct berth.

The qualification system also opens the door for both India and Pakistan to qualify — either by being the highest-ranked eligible nation from Asia or through the final global qualification tournament. The possibility of an Olympic India-Pakistan clash is now very real.

The system also addresses one of cricket's Olympic complications: the West Indies.

Unlike ICC events, the Olympics recognise only sovereign National Olympic Committees. The West Indies, a composite team made up of multiple Caribbean nations, cannot participate as a single Olympic side. To account for that, if the West Indies occupies one of the eight places for the final Olympic qualification

tournament, the ICC will first stage a regional playoff among the eligible Caribbean nations.

The winner of that tournament — not the West Indies — will represent the region at the final Olympic qualifier. Countries such as Jamaica, Barbados, Trinidad and Tobago and Guyana could therefore end up competing against one another for a chance to keep the Caribbean's Olympic hopes alive.

A similar Olympic quirk applies to Britain. The pathway explicitly states that only England will be considered for Olympic qualification because Great Britain competes as a single Olympic entity. The qualification criteria released by the IOC states: "As Great Britain takes part in the Olympics, only one British nation, England, will be considered as part of the quotas."

Women qualify for LA Games

THE INDIAN women's cricket team has qualified for the 2028 Los Angeles Olympics, the ICC confirmed on Monday.

The Indian women's team's T20 World Cup campaign ended in the group stage on Sunday but they are the highest placed team in the tournament from Asia.

"The ongoing ICC Women's T20 World Cup 2026 has confirmed the first participants for LA28, with Australia, Great Britain (via England), India and South Africa qualifying as the highest-placed teams from Africa, Asia, Europe and Oceania," said the ICC.

EXPRESS NEWS SERVICE

No identity, no consistency: How India's WC ended early

Batting lacked power, the bowling combinations kept changing, and fielding faltered at key moments

Shankar Narayan
Mumbai, June 29

INDIA'S 2026 Women's T20 World Cup campaign ended in the league phase with a six-wicket loss to Australia at Lord's on Sunday, but the exit felt less like a shock and more like confirmation. The cracks had been visible for a while.

India never found a clear identity: the batting lacked power, the bowling combinations kept changing, the middle order remained unsettled and the fielding faltered at key moments. While other sides arrived with defined roles and plans, India spent the tournament searching for theirs.

Perhaps the clearest example was India's ever-changing playing XI. Following the win over Bangladesh, captain Harmanpreet Kaur defended the constant tinkering, saying combinations were determined by opposition matchups. "I think when we came here, one thing was very clear in our mind that every game is a different opposition and they have different positives and negatives, and accordingly we have set our playing XI. So we were very open about our playing XI, and we just thought about what is the best combination on that part. We will be well with that," she said.

Yet that flexibility led to uncertainty.

India shuffled batters between Nos. 3, 4 and 5 without anyone settling into a defined role. Jemimah Rodrigues moved across positions through the middle order, scoring only 92 runs in five matches, while Harmanpreet batted between Nos. 4 and 6 be-



India's T20 World Cup campaign ended in the league phase after losing to Australia on Sunday. AP

fore producing her lone stand-out knock at No. 4 — a 27-ball 56 against Australia — after 85 runs in her first four innings.

The team numbers reflected that struggle. India's batters between Nos. 3 and 5 scored only 281 runs at a strike rate of 128.31, the ninth-best among the 12 teams. Australia topped the charts with 415 runs at 157.20, England scored 381 at 144.32 and South Africa scored 328 at 134.43. Australia struck 55 fours and England 53, while India managed only 28. "I think we really have to rethink our strategy or our T20 game. We really need to put our heads around what combination we are going to play," head coach Amol Muzumdar admitted after the defeat to Australia.

The lack of stability also exposed India's biggest batting weakness: absence of sustained power. Only Deepti Sharma (171.42), Richa Ghosh (153.84) and opener Shafali Verma (151.69) struck at above 150, while Rodrigues (119.48) and Harmanpreet (131.77) struggled to accelerate consistently. India also appeared reluctant to promote Richa often enough to get the best out of her.

If the batting lacked clarity, the bowling was in even greater flux. India fielded five different pace-bowling combinations in

five league games, rotating Kranti Gaud, Renuka Singh Thakur, Arundhati Reddy and Nandani Sharma. The experimentation yielded little as they claimed just five wickets.

The inability to strike with the new ball has left them chasing games for a while now. Among the top 10 teams in T20Is since the 2024 World Cup, India's Powerplay bowling has the worst economy rate (7.8), the highest bowling average (36.8) and the most deliveries per wicket (28), showing an inability to contain runs or take wickets. The lack of wickets from pacers at this World Cup meant burden fell almost entirely on the spinners.

Left-arm spinner Sree Charani emerged as India's player of the tournament with 14 wickets. All-rounder and off-spinner Deepti Sharma, however, could not maintain the momentum after her 5/10 against Pakistan, managing only two wickets in the next four matches. Shreyanka Patil's injury further weakened India's attack.

Overall, India's bowling was respectable without being exceptional. Their 36 wickets were the fifth-most in the tournament, but the difference lay in how teams like England, Australia and South Africa had more settled attacks sharing

the workload.

As Muzumdar said: "Sree Charani has... gone to the number one bowler in the chart... it just speaks volumes about how she has approached international cricket."

One bowler alone, however, was never going to win a World Cup. India's fielding compounded those issues. Eleven dropped catches across five matches repeatedly undermined the bowlers' efforts, with South Africa in particular punishing the lapses. "I don't think our bowling or our fielding helped the cause, to be very honest," Muzumdar admitted.

The next T20 World Cup is two years away, allowing India to reassess personnel, leadership, roles and the team's overall blueprint. Asked if he expected Harmanpreet to continue as captain, Muzumdar replied: "It's up to the selectors to decide the captain. I think, yes. My short and sweet answer would be yes."

Whatever direction India opt for moving forward, the campaign never took off — because they never managed a single complete performance against the tournament's strongest sides when it mattered most.

With stats inputs from Lalith Kalidas

Not playing in V hurt Indian batsmen during Ireland series

Venkata Krishna B
Chennai, June 29

AN HONEST assessment of India's series loss to Ireland, the first in three years, came from their assistant coach Ryan ten Doeschate. Candid and frank, the former Dutch captain said there is disbelief in the camp. But equally important was what he said next.

"That (the conditions) was essentially our undoing. It's things we spoke about before, but we just didn't address it well enough out in the middle. I think the big thing was the wind. Again, absolutely no excuses, but when presented with a different challenge we have to find solutions of playing in a different manner, in a better manner," Ten Doeschate said after the series loss that came just three months after India won their second successive T20 World Cup.

Over two days in Belfast, where they failed to chase 183 and 155, the batsmen's performance before the England series begins Wednesday is worrisome. This batting group has been together for a while. Before landing in Ireland, they played all their cricket in India, with their last away trip being in November in Australia. At home, they have been playing mostly on flat beds right through this period, which included the T20 World Cup and the IPL. In Belfast, the conditions were different with seam movement for the fast bowlers. It meant, adjustments had to be made. Indian batsmen have provided an exhibition of six hitting over the last six months, but when there is help for the bowlers, it becomes a different ball game.

Take the dismissal of Sanju Samson. Despite seam movement on offer, instead of taking guard outside the crease — which is common in UK conditions to negate the swing — he chose to stay deep like he has done all season. Off the first delivery, he was trapped in front. Abhishek Sharma tried to break the shackles, but when the white-ball moves, there is a strong chance it finds the edge.



Tilak Varma plays a shot during the second T20I vs Ireland. CREIMAS

'Sooryavanshi will have to wait'

VAIBHAV SOORYAVANSHI will have to bide his time on the bench before being marked for his debut, assistant coach Ryan ten Doeschate said.

"He's absolutely ready to play international cricket, there's no doubt about that. But also, I think it's not a question to say you can leave Sanju Samson out. A guy who went a long way to winning India the World Cup three months ago. A guy who's had a fairly good IPL," Doeschate said. "It's important in terms of giving players confidence, and the message we're sending to players. We want to give guys a long run in the team." ENS

Batsmen have to identify where they ought to score depending on the conditions. In both the matches, Ireland's batting group did something that India didn't. They scored predominantly in the V. It is the pocket where runs come in UK.

"That (not getting hit down the ground) was the central focus of our discussion, particularly for the second game. I thought Ireland did that very well with the ball. They never let us hit straight. In two matches, I think we hit two straight sixes. They were both off the spinner. They just did the basics really well and we couldn't combat that. I don't think there was one ball

pitched up from the seamers and their spinners, and again it was reflected in the economy rates. We need to learn from that. We need to adapt quicker," Ten Doeschate reflected.

For a team that won the T20 World Cup with its six-hitting capability, their first six came in the 18th over on Sunday. In this series they hit only 8 sixes to Ireland's 15. It is again a reflection of how this batting unit, if not presented with tailor-made conditions, doesn't always adjust their game accordingly.

Different tempo

"We're probably too used to a sort of a tempo and style where you can hit sixes more freely. I think, this will be the case when you go to England as well, you know, maybe slightly quicker wickets, maybe slightly less wind, but we're going to have to adapt and be a lot smarter about how we'd like to play if we're going to get wins there," Ten Doeschate said.

Next up is England. They may be in the middle of their own crises, but in home conditions, in particular T20s, they have a formidable batting unit that knows how to get the job done by playing in the V. India will have just one day to train at Chester-le-Street before the first game. It will be the story right through the tour, where they travel, have a training session a day later and play a game on the third day. How well they adjust to the conditions and adapt will show the mettle of the two-time defending world champions.

ELECTRICITY GENERATION FROM RENEWABLE SOURCES JUMPED 18% IN MAY

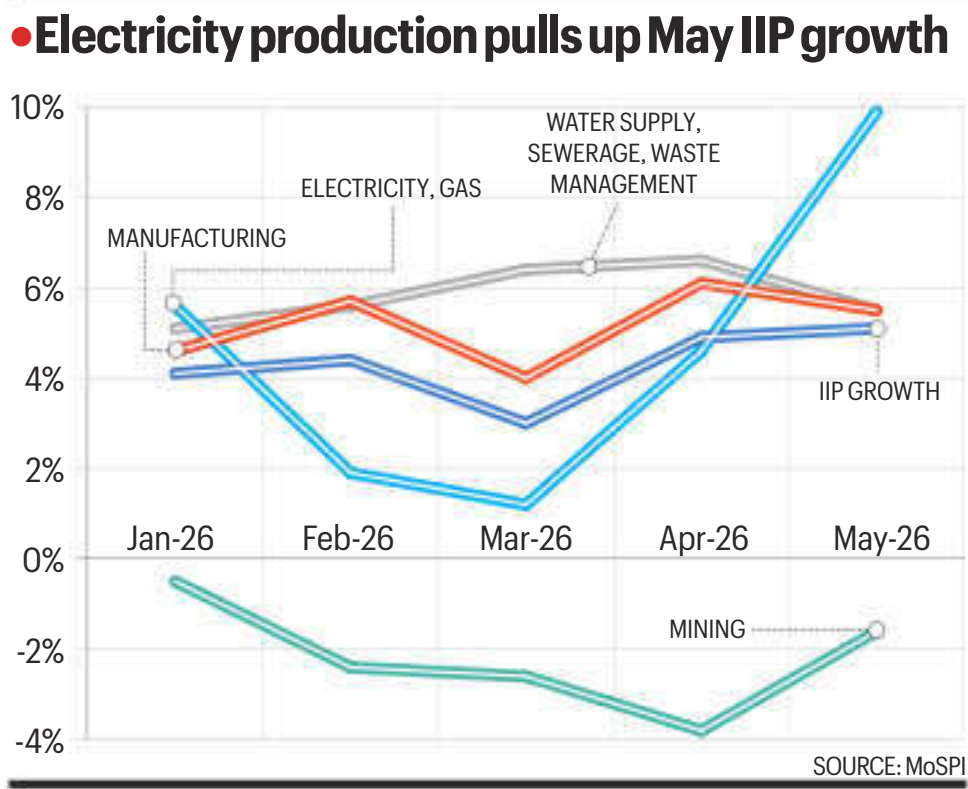
Jump in electricity output pulls up May industrial growth to 5.1%

Siddharth Upasani
New Delhi, June 29

THE COUNTRY’S industrial production rose by 5.1% in May — the fastest increase in five months — pulled up by a double-digit increase in electricity generation, according to Index of Industrial Production (IIP) data released by the Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation (MoSPI) on Monday. In April, industrial growth was 4.9%.

In May, electricity generation from renewable sources jumped 18% while that from non-renewable sources increased by 8.8%, leading to overall electricity production rising by 11.1% as high temperatures boosted demand for power. However, gas supply was 7.1% lower in May, resulting in the output of the ‘electricity and gas’ category increasing by 9.9% compared to the same month last year.

According to Megha Arora,



Director at India Ratings & Research, the impact of the West Asia crisis was “visible in continued gas supply contraction”. In April, gas supply had fallen 7.7%.

Meanwhile, the manufacturing sector — which accounts for more than three quarters of

the IIP — saw its output grow by 5.5% in May, down from an increase of 6.1% in April. Mining output fell again, this time by 1.6%, while output of the ‘water supply, sewerage & waste management’ category increased by 5.5% year-on-year.

Of the 23 categories within

the manufacturing sector, 16 saw a year-on-year rise in their production in May.

“Like previous months, electrical equipment, and motor vehicles, trailers and semi-trailers continued to surge at 20.8% and 14.5%, respectively. Electrical equipment continued to report growth due to small transformers, circuit breakers, and others,” Arora of India Ratings noted, adding that traditional export sectors such as leather and apparel contracted.

In terms of use-based classification of the goods produced, output of primary goods was 2.6% higher in May, while that of capital goods rose 12.9% and intermediate goods 5.8%. Infrastructure goods’ production was 5.9% higher. On the consumer front, durable goods posted a growth of 7.2% in May and non-durables 3.6%.

According to Rajani Sinha, Chief Economist at CareEdge Ratings, while the uptick in pro-

duction of consumer durables and non-durables is positive, the durability of recovery needs to be monitored amid the ongoing geopolitical volatility, inflationary pressures, and slow progress of the monsoon.

Moving forward, even though the decline in global energy prices is a source of relief, economists see some downside risks to industrial production as manufacturing and construction face cost pressures for imported inputs. “Even if shipping resumes through the Strait of Hormuz, repairs to the damaged oil and gas infrastructure in West Asia will take time and elevated war risk premiums, among other factors, would keep pressure on input costs,” said Dipti Deshpande, Principal Economist at Crisil.

The weak monsoon is another big risk for the industry as it could dampen rural demand, Deshpande said.

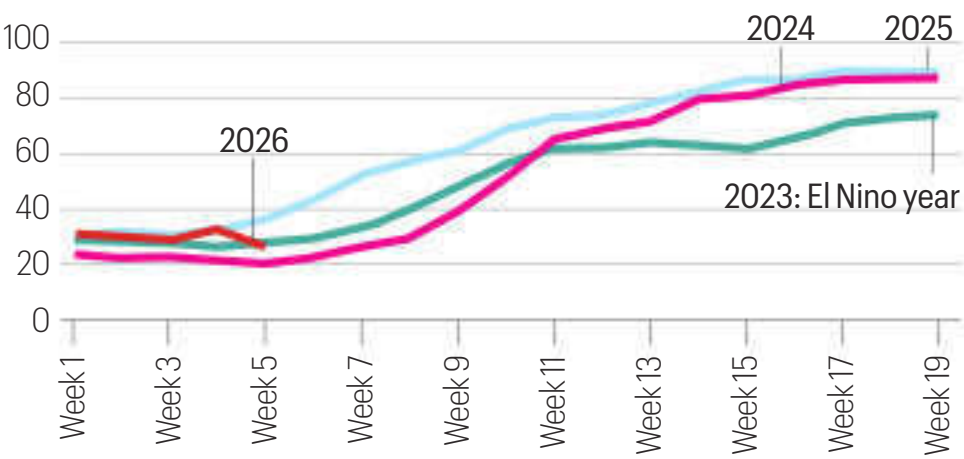
FULL REPORT ON
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● Weak rains hit reservoir storage levels

India’s monsoon remained weak despite progressing in the central region and moving towards the north, with the cumulative rainfall deficit widening further to 43.1% as of June 28 from 42.2% as of June 21.

Reservoir storage levels

Storage as % of live capacity at full reservoir level during monsoons



● With sowing set to begin from July, Barclays economists Aastha Gudwani and Amruta Ghare said in a note on Monday that “early indicators for soil moisture are not encouraging”.

● While economists debate the influence of rainfall on agricultural production and food inflation, a

key factor is how much water is stored in reservoirs. And this crucial number is sliding: as of June 25, storage in India’s key reservoirs was 26% of total capacity, down from 33% a week ago and 36% last year. Gudwani and Ghare noted that such a sharp weekly fall “is quite unusual”.

Ex-CEC Rajiv Kumar named HDFC Bank’s part-time Chairman

George Mathew
Mumbai, June 29

HDFC BANK’S board has approved the appointment of former Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) Rajiv Kumar as the bank’s part-time Chairman for a three-year term, subject to approval from the Reserve Bank of India (RBI).

The appointment comes after a search process that lasted more than three months following the resignation of former part-time chairman Atanu Chakraborty in March.

Kumar, 66, a former IAS officer of the 1984 batch and a former finance secretary, has also been appointed as an additional director (independent) for a four-year term effective June 30, 2026, the bank said in an exchange filing.

Chakraborty resigned with immediate effect on March 18. The appointment of a new chairman comes as the bank prepares for the reappointment of Managing Director and Chief Executive officer Sashidhar Jagdishan, whose current term ends on October 26, 2026.

FULL REPORT ON
WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

Deepak Parekh bats for reforms among PSU banks

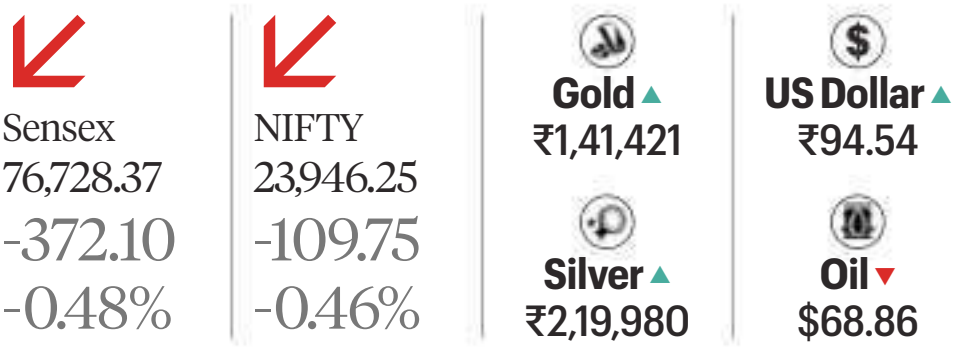
George Mathew
Mumbai, June 29

DEEPAK PAREKH, former chairman of the erstwhile Housing Development Finance Corporation (HDFC) Monday called for further reforms and consolidation among public sector banks and an increase in foreign direct investment limits in both public and private sector banks.

“The public sector banks have already consolidated, but there is a case for further consolidation. Raising foreign direct investment limits in public and private sector banks too will be beneficial,” Parekh said while addressing the annual general meeting of the Indian Merchants’ Chamber. “India’s banking sector needs new reforms, and the time to do this is when the sun is shining, or when the banks are at their strongest,” he said.

FULL REPORT ON
WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

● MARKETS



Axis Bank, Bandhan Bank CFOs resign

Mumbai: Chief financial officers (CFOs) of Axis Bank and Bandhan Bank have resigned for various reasons. Puneet Sharma, CFO of Axis Bank, tendered his resignation on June 28 to pursue next phase of his professional journey, the bank said.

Further, Rajeev Mantri, CFO and key managerial personnel, tendered his resignation on June 29 to pursue another opportunity from career growth perspective, Bandhan Bank said. ENS

● BRIEFLY

India’s external debt hits \$763 bn

Mumbai: India’s total external debt stood at \$762.8 billion at the end of March 2026, registering an increase of \$26.3 billion over the year-ago period, according to the RBI data released on Monday. The RBI said that the external debt to GDP ratio increased to 20.8% at end-March 2026 from 19.8% during the corresponding period a year ago. PTI

Cabinet clears Rs 30k cr NIIF boost

New Delhi: In a significant step to deepen India’s investment commitment for infrastructure and other nationally important sectors, the Union Cabinet last week approved an additional investment commitment of Rs 30,000 crore by the Centre towards new and upcoming funds of the National Investment and Infrastructure Fund (NIIF). PTI

DISTRICT COLLECTOR, BULDHANA
E-mail- auschikhli@gmail.com | collector.buldhana@maharashtra.gov.in
Contact No. 07264-244253/9922956531 District Deputy Registrar’s Office, Buldhana
No. DDR/AUCS/RO/29/AS/2026 Date: 29/06/2026

NOTICE OF THE GENERAL MEETING (ONLY FOR MEMBERS)

The Cooperative Election Authority, by virtue of powers given by section 45K(1) of the Multistate Cooperative Societies Act, 2002 and rule 19F(a) of the Multistate Cooperative Societies Rules, 2002, has appointed District Collector, Buldhana as Returning Officer for conducting election of Board of Directors of **Shri Ambika Urban Multistate Co-operative Credit Society Ltd. Chikhali** for the period 2026-2031. Accordingly, **I, Dr. Pravinkumar Deore**, Returning Officer, District Collector, Buldhana by virtue of powers given by Rule 19H(4), hereby declare that the **General Meeting for elections of Board of Directors of Shri Ambika Urban Multistate Co-operative Credit Society Ltd. Chikhali** is scheduled on **Sunday, 26th July 2026 at 8.00 AM** at **Shri Ambika Urban Multistate Co-operative Credit Society Ltd. Chikhali R. No. 492, Head Office Hall, Makardhwaj Khandala Road, Chikhali, Tq. Chikhali, Dist. Buldana (Maharashtra)**. The General Meeting shall be continued till the declaration of results of the election and members are requested to attend the meeting on scheduled time. The agenda of the meeting is as follows-

AGENDA OF THE MEETING

- 01) Election of the 15 members of the Board of Directors for the term 2026-2031.
- 02) Constituencies as per By-laws No. 35 (b), (c)
 - i. General Member Constituencies
 - ii. Constituency reserved for Scheduled Cast/Scheduled tribe member
 - iii. Constituencies reserved for Women members
- 03) The eligibility criteria to be elected as member of the Board of Directors specified as per M.S.C.S. act 2002 and By laws No. 37 as follows-

The member is eligible to be elected as Director if,

 - i. He / She Should be continuously Attended Three Consecutive General Meetings
 - ii. He/she is individual member of the Society for 1 year before the date of election. sec. 43 (1) (e).
 - iii. He/She is not defaulter of the Society. (37 1 (f))
 - iv. They should have deposited 2 year before the date of election a sum of Rs. 500000/- (In words five lakh) rupees in a fixed deposit account. (37B a) iii
 - v. They should hold shares worth Rs.100000/- (In Words - one lakh rupees). (37B a) iv
 - vi. He/She is not ineligible by virtue of provisions of Act, Rules or by-laws.
- 04) The election program of the Board of Directors is as follows-

Sr.	Particulars	Date / Time	Address
01.	Publication of Provisional List of Delegates and individuals eligible to Vote on website & notice board	29th June 2026 (Monday) By Evening	Office Of The Returning Officer, Shri Ambika Urban MultiState Co-operative Credit Society Ltd. Chikhali R. No. 492 Head Office, Chikhali, Tq. Chikhali, Dist. Buldana (Maharashtra) & On website & all branch's notice board of the society.
02.	Time Window for Raising Objection to the provisional list	30th June 2026 to 03rd July 2026 (Tuesday to Friday) 11.00 AM to 3.00 PM	Office Of The Returning Officer, Shri Ambika Urban MultiState Co-operative Credit Society Ltd. Chikhali R. No. 492 Head Office, Chikhali, Tq. Chikhali, Dist. Buldana (Maharashtra).
03.	Scrutiny of objection received to the Provisional List (if any)	06th to 08th July 2026 (Monday to Wednesday) 11.00 AM to 3.00 PM	Office Of The Returning Officer, Shri Ambika Urban MultiState Co-operative Credit Society Ltd. Chikhali R. No. 492 Head Office, Chikhali, Tq. Chikhali, Dist. Buldana (Maharashtra).
04.	Publication of final list of Members/ Delegate, eligible to vote on website & notice board of the society	08th July 2026 (Wednesday) By Evening	Office Of The Returning Officer, Shri Ambika Urban MultiState Co-operative Credit Society Ltd. Chikhali R. No. 492 Head Office, Chikhali, Tq. Chikhali, Dist. Buldana (Maharashtra) & On website & all branch's notice board of the society.
05.	Issue and Filing of Nomination Form	09th to 15th July 2026 (Thursday to Wednesday) (Except Saturday & Sunday) 11.00 AM to 3.00 PM	Office Of The Returning Officer, Shri Ambika Urban MultiState Co-operative Credit Society Ltd. Chikhali R. No. 492 Head Office, Chikhali, Tq. Chikhali, Dist. Buldana (Maharashtra).
06.	Display of nominations received by Returning Officer on website & notice board of the society	15th July 2026 (Wednesday) By Evening	Office Of The Returning Officer, Shri Ambika Urban MultiState Co-operative Credit Society Ltd. Chikhali R. No. 492 Head Office, Chikhali, Tq. Chikhali, Dist. Buldana (Maharashtra).
07.	Scrutiny of Received Nomination Forms	16th July 2026 (Thursday) Till Completion of Scrutiny	Office Of The Returning Officer, Shri Ambika Urban MultiState Co-operative Credit Society Ltd. Chikhali R. No. 492 Head Office, Chikhali, Tq. Chikhali, Dist. Buldana (Maharashtra).
08.	Publication of List of Valid Nominations	16th July 2026 (Thursday) Immediately of Scrutiny	Office Of The Returning Officer, Shri Ambika Urban MultiState Co-operative Credit Society Ltd. Chikhali R. No. 492 Head Office, Chikhali, Tq. Chikhali, Dist. Buldana (Maharashtra).
09.	Withdrawal of Nominations	17th July 2026 (Friday) 11.00 AM to 3.00 PM	Office Of The Returning Officer, Shri Ambika Urban MultiState Co-operative Credit Society Ltd. Chikhali R. No. 492 Head Office, Chikhali, Tq. Chikhali, Dist. Buldana (Maharashtra).
10.	Publication of Final List of Contesting Candidates.	17th July 2026 (Friday) By Evening	Office Of The Returning Officer, Shri Ambika Urban MultiState Co-operative Credit Society Ltd. Chikhali R. No. 492 Head Office, Chikhali, Tq. Chikhali, Dist. Buldana (Maharashtra).
11.	Date of Polling, if Necessary	26th July 2026 (Sunday) 8.00 AM to 4.00 PM and all those who have entered polling station at 04 PM or before should be allowed to cast vote	Will be announced in due course.
12.	Counting of Votes	28th July 2026 (Tuesday) 08.00 AM onwards	Will be announced in due course.
13.	Submission of From 19M with recommendation for seeking approval of CEA before declaration of result of BOD	28th July 2026 (Tuesday)	Office Of The Returning Officer, Shri Ambika Urban MultiState Co-operative Credit Society Ltd. Chikhali R. No. 492 Head Office, Chikhali, Tq. Chikhali, Dist. Buldana (Maharashtra).
14.	Declaration of Result of Board of Directors	On or before 04/08/2026	Office Of The Returning Officer, Shri Ambika Urban MultiState Co-operative Credit Society Ltd. Chikhali R. No. 492 Head Office, Chikhali, Tq. Chikhali, Dist. Buldana (Maharashtra).

C) Election Program of Office Bearer (After Declaration of Result of Board Members' Election)		
Announcement of Election Schedule	06th August 2026 (Thursday)	
I. Time Window for filing nomination	09.30 AM to 11.30 AM	Office Of The Returning Officer, Shri Ambika Urban MultiState Co-operative Credit Society Ltd. Chikhali R. No. 492 Head Office, Chikhali, Tq. Chikhali, Dist. Buldana (Maharashtra).
II. Scrutiny of nominations papers	12.30 PM to 02.00 PM	
III. Time and date for withdrawal	02.00 PM to 04.00 PM	
IV. Display of list of the contesting candidate and schedule of election	By Evening	
Meeting of Newly Constituted Board & Publication of List for valid Nominations, Polling (if required)	07th August 2026 (Friday) 11.00 AM Onwards	Office Of The Returning Officer, Shri Ambika Urban MultiState Co-operative Credit Society Ltd. Chikhali R. No. 492 Head Office, Chikhali, Tq. Chikhali, Dist. Buldana (Maharashtra).
Declaration of Result of Election of Office Bearers	On or before 13th August 2026	Office Of The Returning Officer, Shri Ambika Urban MultiState Co-operative Credit Society Ltd. Chikhali R. No. 492 Head Office, Chikhali, Tq. Chikhali, Dist. Buldana (Maharashtra).

NOTES :

1. Form of application for nomination can be obtained free of cost.
2. The members filing nominations from reserved constituencies are required to submit valid Cast Certificate certified by Competent Officer along with nomination form.
3. The decision of the Election Returning Officer shall be final in respect of validity of nomination forms.
4. The Election Returning Officer shall publish list of election centres on notice boards of Head Office as well as all branches within reasonable time.
5. As per section 39(1)(O) of the Multistate Cooperative Societies Act, 2002, the election program is being conducted in the General Meeting to facilitate voting of members. The attendance of the voting members shall be considered as attendance of the meeting.
6. All the eligible members of the society shall vote to elect 15 members of the Board of Directors.
7. The member shall carry photo identity (any one of IDs applicable to General Elections) at the time of voting.
8. The list of members of the Society shall be published at Head Office and all the branches of the Society. Any member can obtain such list by paying Rs. - 5000/- (In Words – Five Thousand Rs. Only)

Chikhali
Date : 29/06/2026

(Dr. Praveenkumar Deore)
Returning Officer
Shri Ambika Urban Multistate Co.Op. Credit So.Ltd. & District Collector, Buldhana

‘INDIA’S STATISTICAL SYSTEM CAN RECLAIM ITS PAST GLORY’

PMO a facilitator in MoSPI’s modernisation: PK Mishra

Siddharth Upasani
New Delhi, June 29

THE MODERNISATION of the statistics ministry is a “success story”, with the Prime Minister’s Office playing the role of “a catalyst and a facilitator” to encourage the ministry’s leadership and senior officers, PK Mishra, Principal Secretary to Prime Minister Narendra Modi, said.

Speaking Monday at the 20th Statistics Day, organised by the Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation (MoSPI) to commemorate the birth anniversary of famed statistician PC Mahalanobis, Mishra also said India’s statistical system can reclaim its past glory that had seen it become one of the finest survey-based statistical systems in the world starting in the 1950s.

“After about half a century of this journey, the Indian statistical system witnessed a gradual decline in its capability and capacity... About a decade ago, there were several articles in newspapers and other forums and commentaries, very critical of our statistical system during the years 2014-2016 and so on. Our Prime Minister was very surprised at how so much



PK Mishra (right), Principal Secretary to PM Narendra Modi. PIB

criticism there was about our system,” Mishra said.

While Mishra did not mention specifics, he was seemingly referring to the blowback the government faced after it junked the Consumer Expenditure Survey for 2017-18, citing data quality issues. At the same time, key economic indicators such as the CPI and GDP had begun attracting criticism for being outdated.

According to Mishra, discussions in the PMO started in January 2020 over the improvement of India’s statistical

system, starting with a meeting involving MoSPI, NITI Aayog, and the World Bank.

“At that time, even within our Office, eyebrows were raised that the Prime Minister’s Office was spending time brainstorming on the statistical system instead of spending time on flagship programmes and schemes,” he said, adding that the PMO’s intention was to enable MoSPI to improve its performance by addressing structural and inter-ministerial issues.

FULL REPORT ON
WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

‘US whiskey a priority agri, export category; India an essential market’

AS THE United States Trade Representative (USTR) Jamieson Greer wrapped up his India visit to finalise an interim bilateral trade agreement (BTA) between India and the US, **Michael Bilello**, President and Chief Executive Officer (CEO) of American Whiskey Association said they are in talks with both governments to make sure American whiskey is understood as a priority US agricultural, manufacturing and export category. In an interview with **Divya A.**, he also underscored that India is increasingly viewed as essential, and not optional among American businesses. Edited excerpts:

You’ve been arguing that American whiskey should be part of the emerging US-India trade framework. Have you had any conversations on it with Indian government officials and the American side?

The American Whiskey Association has been actively engaged on both sides of the US-India trade conversation. On the Indian side, we have engaged with Indian government, diplomatic, policy and business stakeholders to make sure American whiskey is understood as a priority US agricultural, manufacturing and export category. That has included discussions with Ambassador Vinay Kwatra, as well as finance ministry officials. On the US side, we



met with (Donald) Trump administration officials, provided input from member companies, facilitated meetings between member-company executives and key players involved in trade negotiations, and submitted letters to the Office of the USTR. Having said that, we are not negotiators. Our job is to make sure the American whiskey supply chain’s priorities are clearly understood by policymakers.

How will this benefit US producers as well as Indian consumers?

For American producers, meaningful access to India would support one of America’s most important agricultural and manufacturing export categories. When American whiskey grows abroad, the value flows back into US farms, rural manufacturing, distilling communities and export jobs. For Indian consumers, the benefit is

choice, quality and fair pricing. Today, its price in India is shaped heavily by tariff and market-access friction before it reaches a consumer, bartender, retailer or restaurant. If American whiskey can enter the market on commercially meaningful terms, Indian consumers will have more access to premium American products at prices that better reflect the product itself, not just layers of avoidable cost.

What is the view of the Indian market and growing economy among American businesses? How is the BTA viewed in the US?

Among American businesses, India is increasingly viewed as essential, not optional. It is one of the world’s most important long-term growth markets, with a large and increasingly sophisticated consumer base, a growing middle class, strong entrepreneurial energy, a dynamic hospitality sector and an expanding role in global supply chains. The BTA is being watched closely in the US because it can demonstrate whether the strategic US-India partnership can translate into practical commercial opportunity. Businesses are looking for predictability, commercially meaningful market access, fair treatment and rules that allow investment and trade to grow. A good agreement should be mutually beneficial.

FULL INTERVIEW ON
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If there are questions of current or contemporary relevance that you would like explained, please write to explained@indianexpress.com

•CRIME

Charge sheet after 36 years: Recalling the Sarla Bhat murder case

Bashaarat Masood
Srinagar, June 29

TEN MONTHS after reopening the case in the murder of Kashmiri Pandit nurse Sarla Bhat, the State Investigation Agency (SIA) Monday filed the charge sheet.

The agency has charged five operatives of the banned Jammu Kashmir Liberation Front (JKLF) for murder, including its jailed chief, Yasin Malik. Of the other four accused, three have already been killed, while the fourth one is absconding and is believed to be in Pakistan.

What was the case?

Bhat was a 27-year-old nurse from the Qazibagh neighbourhood of south Kashmir’s Anantnag. She was working at Srinagar’s Sher-i-Kashmir Institute of Medical Sciences (SKIMS) and was abducted and killed allegedly by the JKLF militants.

On April 18, 1990, Bhat was at her hostel when suspected militants barged in and abducted her at gunpoint. Her body, marked by multiple bullet wounds, was recovered the next day from Mallabagh, a locality close to SKIMS. A handwritten note recovered from her body accused her of “being a police informer”.

While most of the Kashmiri Pandits left the valley in early 1990 after the inception of militancy in Jammu and Kashmir, Bhat had decided to stay back.

The J&K Police registered a case (under FIR No 56/1990) against unidentified militants at Srinagar’s Nageen Police Station. Although several Kashmiri Pandit organisations claimed that Bhat was “tortured and raped” before being killed, the police report only mentioned the murder.

Since then, there was limited progress in the investigation, while most

•INSURGENCY DEATHS

- There is no definite number on how many Kashmiri Pandits were killed by militants in the initial years of insurgency.
- A 2008 report by the J&K Police said that between 1989 and 1990, militants killed 209 Pandits. Pandit organisations say the actual number is higher.

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•CLIMATE

Behind Europe’s heatwave, climate change the culprit



AMITABH SINHA

A NEW study has confirmed what was already evident — climate change is behind the scorching heat in large parts of Europe right now.

A study by World Weather Attribution (WWA), a group of scientists that examines the causes of extreme weather events worldwide, has found climate change to be “unequivocally to blame” for the European heatwave, which has seen several places record unprecedented temperatures in recent days. WWA said this was the most severe heatwave ever recorded in Europe.

On Sunday, WHO Director-General Tedros Adhanom Ghebreyesus wrote in a post on X that “Europe is the fastest-warming continent on Earth, heating at twice the global average... More than 1300 excess deaths have been recorded since 21 June linked to high temperatures in Europe.”

This is the third time in five years that Europe finds itself in the grip of an intense heatwave. Similar scenes were witnessed in 2022 and 2023 as well. More than 1,00,000 people are estimated to have died owing to extreme heat in those two years.

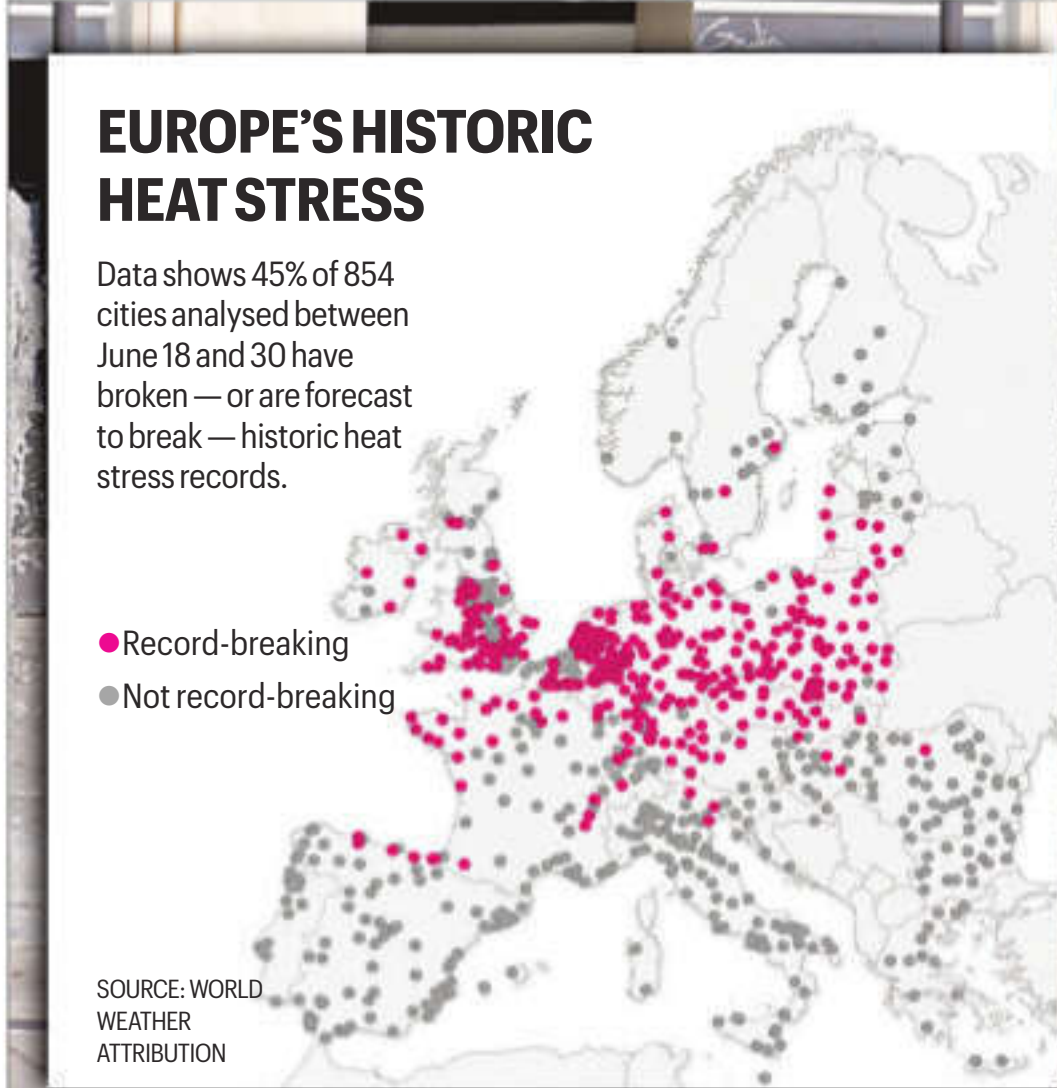
While the current episode of extreme heat is expected to slightly subside this weekend onwards, Europe’s ordeal might not be over yet, according to forecasts by meteorological offices of the UK and France. Historically, June has not been the hottest month for Europe — July is. With the El Niño phenomenon in the Pacific Ocean expected to get stronger in July, Europe might be staring at fresh heatwave spells in the coming weeks.

Climate change-driven heatwave

The WWA study, however, was categorical in assigning the cause of this heatwave. It said it was not because of El Niño, which is still to reach its peak, or any other reason, but climate change.

“Both the daytime highs and overnight temperatures seen during this heatwave would have been virtually impossible to occur at this time of year as recently as 1976 — just 50 years ago,” it said.

Many of the temperature records now being broken in Europe were set in 1976, when the region had experienced an un-



usually hot summer.

Europe experienced its first heatwave of this century in 2003. The study said that heatwave was nothing in comparison to what the region is witnessing now. The record-breaking high temperatures during the night are almost 100 times more likely today than they were in 2003, it said. The daytime peak temperatures observed during the current spell are almost 10 times more likely.

Daytime temperatures in most of Europe, barring the northern part, are usually between 20 and 30°C during June. Night-time temperatures typically vary between 11 and 17°C. But in many parts of the region, peak temperatures during the ongoing heatwave have been 10 to 15°C higher than normal. A similar situation had prevailed in May this year as well, when an early heatwave had prevailed in Europe.

“The analysis found that the El Niño Southern Oscillation (ENSO) phase had no role in driving the heat (in this spell),” the study said.

ENSO is an ocean-atmospheric interaction over the Pacific Ocean region. El Niño is one of the two phases of ENSO and is known to have a warming effect on the planet. Its opposite phase, La Niña, tends to bring temperatures down.

Why accurate attribution is important

Though the intensity of this particular



A man cools off at a fountain during a heatwave in Saint Germain en Laye, west of Paris, on Thursday. AP

Concrete evidence

Climate attribution science is a relatively new discipline. It examines the likelihood of a particular extreme weather event, if climate change were not taking place.

- Attribution science seeks to remove ambiguity and determine the exact extent of responsibility that climate change bears.

spell of European heatwave and the trend over the last few years had made the imprint of climate change fairly clear, scientists are usually wary of linking any individual extreme weather event to climate change without an attribution study like this one.

Climate attribution science is a relatively new discipline, developed just over the last two decades. It tries to examine the likelihood of a particular extreme weather event happening if climate change were not taking place.

Earlier, it used to take scientists a couple of months, even years, to make this assessment. But in the last three to four years, mainly owing to the efforts of WWA, a much faster assessment has been made possible, sometimes even when the event is still ongoing, as in the present case.

Attribution science seeks to remove ambiguity and determine the exact extent of responsibility of climate change in causing major extreme weather events.

In the last few years, it has established the footprints of climate change on several events. Besides preparing scientific evidence, this exercise is also aimed at forcing policymakers and decision-makers to act more rapidly on climate change.

Action awaited

The scientific evidence on climate change is already voluminous and compel-

ling. Still, climate change seems to have dropped a few notches down in the list of global priorities, particularly after Donald Trump took office as US President. The recent G7 meetings, for example, hardly had any climate-related agenda or outcomes. A few years earlier, climate change used to be one of the most important items at such international meetings, especially those involving influential leaders.

Scientists insist that there is still time for countries to take rapid action and attempt to achieve the Paris Agreement targets of containing the global rise of temperatures within 1.5 or 2°C from pre-industrial times.

But governments appear to have all but given up on those targets. For them, it seems, these targets have already gone beyond reach, or require the kind of mobilisation of resources on a global scale that is neither practical nor realistic to organise.

Countries seem to have decided to let climate change play itself out and do their best to deal with its impact and adapt to it — a strategy scientists routinely warn against. Adaptation has its limits, they maintain.

But global action on climate change has continued to woefully lag behind global warming. Events such as the European heatwave are only expected to increase both in frequency and intensity over the next few years.

•POLICY

Why more medicines will now have QR codes on their packets

Anonna Dutt
New Delhi, June 29

THE CENTRE has recently mandated that all vaccines, antimicrobials, narcotics and addictive drugs, and anti-cancer drugs carry a bar code or QR code, to enable tracking of each vial or blister pack of the medicine. This track-and-trace mechanism allows regulators as well as manufacturers to follow the entire journey of every unit of the product, from the manufacturing plant to the retail store.

This is already applicable for 300 top brands of drugs, such as the gastric reflux tablet Acilol and fever medicines like Calpol.

The mechanism will be implemented for the new categories over the next two years — by July 2027 for vaccines, narcotics, and anticancer drugs and by July 2028 for antimicrobials, according to the recent gazette notification.

How does the tracking system work?

In addition to the unique identification number for the particular blister pack or vial, the QR code or bar code also has to

carry the brand name and generic name of the drug, name and address of the manufacturer, batch number, date of manufacturing, date of expiry, and manufacturing licence number.

While most drugs in the market already carry this information on their pack, the QR code-based tracking system requires the manufacturers, wholesalers, distributors, and retailers to log these products on specialised track and trace platforms.

“This mechanism makes counterfeiting difficult. Some may still use AI to generate codes similar to the original product, but with each unit carrying a unique code, that becomes difficult,” said an industry expert, adding, “Even using the original packaging to refill and sell counterfeit drug is not likely to work because once the drug has been registered on the platform, the same number cannot be re-registered.”

“The enhanced traceability mechanism will facilitate authentication of medicines at various stages of the supply chain and enable improved tracking and verification of drug products. The measure is expected to strengthen regulatory oversight and support efforts to curb the distribution of spurious medicines in the market,” said the

Past cases

- The use of this mechanism to track expensive cancer drugs is specially significant, considering there have been instances where used vials have been filled with other medicines and sold to desperate patients.
- A recent investigation by ‘The Indian Express’ had tracked one such ring that counterfeited the cancer immunotherapy drug Keytruda.

Union Health Ministry in a statement.

Why is it needed?

The main aim is to prevent counterfeiting. A drug can be counterfeited by either releasing products with no active ingredient into the market or diluting a drug to increase quantities for sale.

The track and trace mechanism can help regulators identify whether a product was contaminated at the source — at the manufacturing plant of a company — or was tampered with.

The possibility of tracking every single unit also means that regulators and companies know exactly where to find their products in case there is a recall.

What are the challenges?

One of the challenges, an industry expert said, is that if there is a delay in logging the genuine product and a counterfeit gets logged into the system, the genuine drug might come across as counterfeit.

Second is the challenge of cost. Companies will have to put in place mechanisms to generate the unique codes and the tracking platforms, incurring significant expense.

The expert said: “While it may be feasible for companies selling expensive cancer drugs, smaller companies will struggle. Considering that many of the drugs in schedule H2 are ‘essential’ and therefore under price control, the government may provide some monetary support or allow the companies to raise the prices slightly.”

How does it change regulatory oversight?

Another reason for implementing the tracking mechanism is to improve the maturity level of the Indian drug regulator. The World Health Organization has a benchmark tool for rating regulators depending on the way drugs are approved, the mechanisms for surveillance and testing, and ways of recalling products.

When it comes to vaccines, the Indian regulator is already at Maturity Level 3, the second-best. Making each unit of a vaccine traceable is a step towards achieving the highest level, Maturity Level 4. Higher the maturity level, the easier it is for medicines from the country to be accepted in international markets, as their quality is seen as more trustworthy.

•GLOBAL

Iran to charge fee for using the Strait of Hormuz: What international law says



EXPERT EXPLAINS
ANWAR SADAT

ASSOCIATE PROFESSOR, INTERNATIONAL LAW, INDIAN SOCIETY OF INTERNATIONAL LAW, NEW DELHI

WITH THE signing of the framework agreement between the US and Iran this month, the Strait of Hormuz has been reopened and the US blockade on Iranian ships lifted. Still, there are fundamental legal concerns that require answers.

After the US and Israel attacked Iran on

February 28, Iran has used the Strait as both chokepoint and bargaining chip to put pressure on the US and its allies to end all hostilities. At one point, Iran was collecting toll per transit against those using the Strait so as to compensate for all damages caused by the war.

Although Iran has now agreed to reopen the Strait, it will still charge fees for navigation and environmental protection. This prompts a larger question: whether Iran’s action qualifies the litmus test of international law relating to a “right of transit passage” codified in the 1982 United Nations Convention in the Law of the Sea (UNCLOS).

Freedom of navigation

Articles 37 to 44 of the UNCLOS that govern “Straits used for International Navigation” hold that all ships and aircraft have a “right of transit passage”: the freedom of

continuous, swift navigation and overflight through and over international straits. They “shall not be impeded”, and “there shall be no suspension of transit passage” through a strait. This is because when a considerable portion of global trade depends on a narrow corridor, bordering states are not allowed to use it as leverage.

The Strait of Hormuz is generally considered as one such “international strait”. Even before the UNCLOS, the International Court of Justice laid down in the *Corfu Channel (United Kingdom v. Albania)* case of 1949 that in such cases, “ships enjoy unrestricted passage during peacetime, so long as the transit does not threaten a coastal state’s security”.

Iran is trying to consolidate its attempt to convert this Strait into a managed and revenue generating-entry point, which it would administer with Oman’s support and assistance.

As the Strait is within the combined territorial waters of Iran and Oman, freedom of navigation as enjoyed on the high seas is not available in the territorial sea. Still, ships are entitled to the “right of innocent passage”: the UNCLOS principle that allows foreign vessels to navigate through another coastal state’s territorial sea, thus balancing national sovereignty over coastal waters with the global necessity of free maritime transit.

But this is subject to the satisfaction of the coastal state that it is not going to prejudice its peace, good order, or security (Article 19 of the UNCLOS). These grounds are broad enough for Iran or a coastal state to use it to deny the right of innocent passage during a tense standoff.

Iran might use the analogy of the Suez and Panama canals, as both of them charge transit fees. But this does not support Iran’s case as these canals, unlike Hor-

muz, are artificially engineered waterways constructed, maintained, and administered through sovereign territory. Their functioning is also governed by specific treaty regimes and not by the UNCLOS provisions.

Iran signed the UNCLOS but never ratified it. Even then, the Iranian government declared that it does not treat codification of the regime relating to transit passage as customary international law — rather, they were *quid pro quo* bargains for treaty parties. Customary international law consists of unwritten rules binding all nations.

‘Persistent objector’

Iran can use the “persistent objector” argument, which states that a sovereign nation is exempt from a newly emerging norm of customary international law if it has clearly and consistently objected to the rule during the process of formation. This

is considered valid owing to the fact that Iran passed its own legislation in 1993 called “Law of Marine Areas of the Islamic Republic of Iran in the Persian Gulf and Oman Sea”. This law allows Iran to suspend the passage of foreign ships, and it also requires prior authorisation for warships and vessels carrying harmful substances with respect to environmental protection.

The latter category can encompass commercial oil tankers, which carry the bulk of petroleum and are widely treated in maritime law as posing environmental and navigational risks. This strengthens Iran’s “persistent objector” argument.

The Iran war has oscillated between a military confrontation and an economic war at a fast pace. Iran might have been stretched economically and militarily in conventional terms, but it made the world realise that it can impose global costs by making ordinary commerce uncertain.

Walk-in-interview

A walk-in-interview has been scheduled to be held at Division of Pathology, ICAR-IVRI, Izatnagar, Bareilly, Uttar Pradesh on 15.07.2026 at 10:00 AM for engagement of **two (02) Young Professional-1** under **ICAR-All India Network Project on Challenging and Emerging Diseases of Animals**. The engagement is purely temporary on the contractual basis. For further details, please visit **website www.ivri.nic.in**.

OFFICE of the Executive Engineer Mechanical

Division bhep, Chanderkote

GIST OF e-TENDER NOTICE

For and on behalf of Managing Director JKPCD, e-tenders are invited from Reputed Firms / Contractors having relevant experience for the below mentioned works:

S.No	Name of Work	e-NIT No. & Date	Due Date	Tenders receiving Authority
1	SITC of Hooter System.	10-MECH of 2026-27 Dated 27-06-2026	18-07-2026 at 16:00 Hrs	Executive Engineer, Mechanical Division, BHEP, Chanderkote
2	SITC of Dewatering Submersible 20 HP Pump, Automatic Control panel with water level sensors in Adit-II HRT of BHEP II.	11-MECH of 2026-27 Dated 27-06-2026	18-07-2026 at 16:00 Hrs	Executive Engineer, Mechanical Division, BHEP, Chanderkote
3	Replacement of damage Radiators of AHU/FAU and its allied Accessories at Various Locations of Power House-I.	12-MECH of 2026-27 Dated 27-06-2026	18-07-2026 at 16:00 Hrs	Executive Engineer, Mechanical Division, BHEP, Chanderkote

For details of work, terms and conditions and any other clarifications, kindly visit www.jktenders.gov.in, you can also contact the Office of the undersigned on any working day up to 18.07.2026 till 14:00 Hrs.

Executive Engineer
Mechanical Division
BHEP Chanderkote

DIP/J-1234-P/26 – DATE 29 JUNE 2026

GUJARAT URJA VIKAS NIGAM LIMITED

CIN U40109GJ2004SGC045195

ISO 9001:2015 Certified Company

Sardar Patel Vidyut Bhavan, Racecourse, Vadodara 390007

PBX: (0265) 2310582-86, www.guvnl.com

NOTICE INVITING TENDER

GUUVNL, a Govt. of Gujarat Undertaking hereby invites e-tender for purchase of 500-1000 MW Power for the period from **1st August 2026 to 31st March 2027** as per Ministry of Power (MoP), Govt. of India Guidelines dated 30.03.2016 read with amendment to the guideline notified on 21.02.2022. RFP is available at www.mstcecommerce.com from 29.06.2026. Bid has to be submitted online through DEEP Portal of MoP. All terms and conditions shall be as per RFP.

Date: 29th June 2026

General Manager (Power Trading)

UTTARAKHAND POWER CORPORATION LIMITED

(A Govt. of Uttarakhand Undertaking), Corporate Identity No. UA40109UR2001SGC025867/2358,
Victoria Cross Vijeta Gabar Singh Urja Bhawan, Kanwali Road, Dehradun-248001, Telephone - (0135) -2763672-76, Fax- (0135) -2760289
Website: www.uktenders.gov.in

E-TENDER NOTICE (NIT)

Uttarakhand Power Corporation Ltd. Dehradun invites e- tender for following as detailed below:-

S1. No.	Name of Item	Tender Specification No.	Tender Qty.	Estimated cost (in ₹)	Average yearly Turn Over of Preceding Three Financial Year i.e. 2022-2023, 2023-2024 & 2024-2025 (in ₹)	Earnest Money (in ₹)	Cost of tender document including GST (in ₹)	Date & time of Prebid conference in online mode	Last Date & time of online request for Tender and submission of tender in online & Offline mode	Date of opening of bid Part-I in online and offline mode
1	11KV XLPE Cable 3x50Sq.mm	CCP-I/17/ 2026-2027	100 Km	7,82,57,458.00	11,73,87,000.00	15,66,000.00	23,600.00		20.7.2026 upto 17:00 hrs	21.7.2026 at 15:30 hrs
2	11KV XLPE Cable 3x120Sq.mm	CCP-I/18/ 2026-2027	20 Km	2,51,17,452.80	4,00,00,000.00	5,03,000.00	17,700.00		20.7.2026 upto 17:00 hrs	21.7.2026 at 15:45 hrs
3	11KV XLPE Cable 3x400Sq.mm	CCP-I/19/ 2026-2027	50 Km	14,59,58,462.00	21,89,38,000.00	29,20,000.00	29,500.00	08.7.2026 at 12:00 hrs	20.7.2026 upto 17:00 hrs	21.7.2026 at 16:00 hrs
4	33KV XLPE Cable 3x400Sq.mm	CCP-I/20/ 2026-2027	50 Km	19,24,50,900.50	28,86,77,000.00	38,50,000.00	29,500.00		20.7.2026 upto 17:00 hrs	21.7.2026 at 16:15 hrs
5	ACSR Rabbit Conductor	CCP-I/21/ 2026-2027	3000 Km	22,94,89,770.00	34,42,35,000.00	45,90,000.00	29,500.00		21.7.2026 upto 17:00 hrs	22.7.2026 at 15:30 hrs
6	Stay wire GI 7/3.15mm (7/10SWG)	CCP-I/22/ 2026-2027	200 MT	1,70,03,800.00	3,40,08,000.00	3,41,000.00	11,800.00	08.7.2026 at 12:30 hrs	21.7.2026 upto 17:00 hrs	22.7.2026 at 15:45 hrs
7	Stay Set GI 20x1800 mm,	CCP-I/23/ 2026-2027	20,000 Nos	1,44,05,000.00	2,88,10,000.00	2,89,000.00	11,800.00		21.7.2026 upto 17:00 hrs	22.7.2026 at 16:00 hrs

For further details, please visit the website www.uktenders.gov.in

No.: 460/EE/(CM)/UPCL/A-2 Dt. 29.06.2026

SUPERINTENDING ENGINEER
Corporate (C&P-I)

"SAVE ELECTRICITY IN THE INTEREST OF THE NATION. Use LED Bulb, Save Electricity (Toll Free No. 1912) "Pay Electricity Bill Online 24x7 from www.upcl.org". (For information on Electricity theft, informer may report to Toll free No 1800 180 4185/ Fax No. 0135-2760911)

UNION TERRITORY OF JAMMU & KASHMIR

OFFICE THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER PWD (R&B) DIVISION SATWARI

SHORT NOTICE INVITING TENDER

Short e-NIT No. 36 of 2026-27 Dated 25-06-2026

For and on behalf of the Lieutenant Governor, Union Territory of Jammu and Kashmir e-tenders are invited on percentage basis from approved and eligible Contractors registered with Union Territory of J&K, CPWD, Railways, MES and other State/Central Governments for each of the following works:-

S. No.	Name of Work	Advertised Cost (In Lacs)	Cost of documents (In Rupees)	Earnest Money (In Rupees)	Time allowed for completion	Time and date of opening of tender	Class of Contractor
1	Macadamization of roads in Panchayat Kharian and allied links in Brij Nagar	39.98	600/-	(2% of the Advertised Cost)	30 Days	16/07/2026 at 1800 Hrs.	A, B/Hot mix Plant
2	Macadamization of Road from Chatha to Miran Sahib Via SKAUST Road	39.99	600/-	(2% of the Advertised Cost)	30 Days	16/07/2026 at 1800 Hrs.	A, B/Hot mix Plant
3	Macadamization of Roads From Muralian to Gazian.	39.95	600/-	(2% of the Advertised Cost)	30 Days	16/07/2026 at 1800 Hrs.	A, B/Hot mix Plant
4	Macadamization of Road in Panchayat Ban sultan Upper and Various allied links	30.00	600/-	(2% of the Advertised Cost)	30 Days	16/07/2026 at 1800 Hrs.	A, B/Hot mix Plant
5	Macadamization of links at Dindey Kalan, Miran Sahib	30.00	600/-	(2% of the Advertised Cost)	30 Days	16/07/2026 at 1800 Hrs.	A, B/Hot mix Plant
6	Macadamization of Roads at Gujjar Colony Khawas Khan near Muralia Dak Banglow	20.00	600/-	(2% of the Advertised Cost)	30 Days	16/07/2026 at 1800 Hrs.	A, B, C/Hot mix Plant

Position of AAA :-> Accorded

Position of TS :-> Accorded

Major head of account :-> City & Town 2026-27

The Bidding documents Consisting of qualifying information, eligibility criteria, specifications, Drawings, bill of quantities (B.O.Q), Set of terms and conditions of contract and other details can be seen/downloaded from the departmental website <http://jktenders.gov.in> as per below schedule:

1	Date of Issue of Tender Notice	25/06/2026 at 1800 Hrs.
2	Period of downloading of bidding documents	25/06/2026 at 1800 Hrs.
3	Date, Time and place of pre-bid meeting	27/06/2026 at 1300 Hrs. in the Office of Executive Engineer PWD (R&B) Division Satwari
4	Bid submission Start Date	25/06/2026 at 1800 Hrs.
5	Bid Submission End Date	15/07/2026 up to 1600 Hrs.
6	Date & time of opening of Technical Bids (Online)	16/07/2026 on or after 13.00 Hrs in the Office of Executive Engineer PWD (R&B) Division Satwari
7	Date & time of opening of Financial Bids (Online)	To be notified after technical bid evaluation is completed

1. Bids must be accompanied with cost of Tender document in shape of e-challan through Treasury indicating Treasury Voucher No. & date, e-NIT No. and name of work duly crediting to 0659 (Revenue) favoring Executive Engineer PWD (R&B) Division Satwari and upload the same i.e treasury challan/receipt, Earnest money/Bid security in shape of CDR/FDR/BG pledged to Executive Engineer PWD (R&B) Division Satwari. The CDR/FDR/BG shall be valid for 45 Days beyond the bid validity period. The original instruments in respect of cost of documents, EMD and relevant documents of LI be submitted to the Executive Engineer PWD (R&B) Division Satwari at the time of allotment.

2. The electronic bidding system would not allow any late submission of bids after date and time as per server time. Bidders may modify their bids by uploading their request for modification before the deadline for submission of bids. For this, the bidder need not to make any additional payment towards the cost of tender document. For bid modification and consequential re-submission, the bidder is not required to withdraw his bid submitted earlier. The last modified bid submitted by the bidder within the bid submission time shall be considered as the bid. For this purpose, modification/withdrawal by other means will not be accepted. In online system of bid submission, the modification and consequential- submission of bids is allowed any number of times. The bidders may withdraw his bid by uploading their request before the deadline for submission of bids; however, if the bid is withdrawn, the re-submission of the bid is not allowed. No bid shall be modified or withdrawn after the deadline of submission of bids.

3. The date and time of opening of Financial-Bids shall be notified on Web Site www.jktenders.gov.in and conveyed to the bidders automatically through an e-mail message on their e-mail address. The Financial-bids of responsive bidders shall be opened online in the Executive Engineer PWD (R&B) Division Satwari. The date for same shall be intimated separately.

4. The bids for the work shall remain valid for a period of 120 days from the date of opening of technical bids.

5. The earnest money shall be forfeited, If:-
a) Any bidder/tenderer withdraws his bid/tender during the period of bid validity or makes any modifications in the terms and conditions of the bid.
b) Failure of Successful bidder to furnish the required performance security within specified time period after issue of letter of acceptance.
c) Failure of successful bidder to execute the agreement on same day of allotment of work contract as per Chief Engineer PW (R&B) Department Jammu's Circular No. CEJ&P/12660-87 dated 07-10-2021.

6. Instruction to bidders regarding e-tendering process. Bidders are advised to download bid submission manual from the "Downloads" option as well as from "Bidders Manual Kit" on website www.jktenders.gov.in to acquaint bid submission process. To participate in bidding process, bidders have to get 'Digital Signature Certificate (DSC)' as per Information Technology Act-2000. Bidders can get digital certificate from any approved vendors. The bidders have to submit their bids online in electronic format with digital Signature. No financial bid will be accepted in physical form. Bids will be opened online as per time schedule mentioned above. Bidders must ensure to upload scanned copy of all necessary documents mentioned in NIT and SBD with technical bid online.

No.: XEN/SAT/PWD/Tender/2026-27/
Dated :-
DIP/J-4672/26 – DATE 29 JUNE 2026

Executive Engineer
PWD (R&B) Division
Satwari

SALUTE THE SOLDIER

GORKHA RIFLES

Indian Army and 11 Gorkha Rifles Salutes its brave heart, Late Hav Milan Tamang 107 (TA), Late Nk Diwankar Thapa 107 (TA), Late Rfn Benjamin Rai 107 (TA), Late Rfn MD Jairul Hoque 107 (TA), Late Rfn Marcus Gurung 107 (TA), Late Rfn Shankar Chhetri 107 (TA), Late Nk Tshering Lepcha 107 (TA), Late L/Nk Bishal Chhetri 107 (TA), Late Rfn Tak Bahadur Thapa 107 (TA), Late Rfn Ladup Tamang 107 (TA), Late L/Nk Bhupen Rai 107 (TA), Late Hav Bedhyan Rai 107 (TA), Late Rfn Balaram Sharma 107 (TA), Late Rfn Chandan Gurung 107 (TA), No 10375121Y Hav Deepak Pradhan 107 (TA), No 1037517M Late Hav Santu Banerjee 107 (TA), No 10375150N Late Hav Umesh Limbu 107 (TA), No 10375234F Late Nk Chhedup Lama 107 (TA), No 10375213L Late L/Nk Bikram Sarki 107 (TA), No 10375580X Late Rfn Pritam Kumar Dutta 107 (TA), No 13014366H Late Rfn Prasanta Deb 107 (TA), No 13014464H Late Rfn Sanjay Debnath 107 (TA), No 10375531P Late Rfn Shubham Kumar Singh 107 (TA), TJ-7016N Late Sub Sajit Subba 107 (TA), TJ-6395H Late Nb Sub Umesh Lama 107 (TA), No 10375397P Late Rfn S K Mahiuddin Ahmed 107 (TA), No 10375537 Late Rfn Sanjay Oraon 107 (TA), No 10375646H Late Rfn Priyam Dutta 107 (TA), made supreme sacrifice while deployed in Manipur, on 30 June 2022.

COLONEL 11 GR & SIKKIM SCOUTS AND ALL RANKS
BORDER SECURITY FORCE

LANCE NAIK
SONA RAM GOPE
95 BN BSF
19.04.1948 –
30.06.1991

CONSTABLE
BARUN KUMAR
95 BN BSF
31.12.1970 –
30.06.1991

Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Jawans Lance Naik Sona Ram Gope and Constable Barun Kumar on their Balidan Diwas. On this day, they sustained grievous bullet injuries while fighting with militants in Shri Hargovindpur area, Gurdaspur (Punjab) and later succumbed to their injuries.

INDO-TIBETAN BORDER POLICE (ITBP)
Constable Anil Rana

ITBP salutes its braveheart Constable Anil Rana of 49th Battalion, who laid down his life in the line of duty on this day in Arunachal Pradesh in 2018.

RAJASTHAN RAJYA VIDYUT PRASARAN NIGAM LIMITED

Notice Inviting Bid

Procurement of outdoor live tank type 400kV, 3000-2000-1000/1 A, 6C current transformer with terminal connector BID NO: RVPN/EHV/BN9019002529 & (UBN: VPN2627GLOB00763) other particulars of the bid may be visited on the procurement portal (<http://eproc.rajjasthan.gov.in>, <http://sppp.raj.nic.in>) of the state; and <http://energy.rajjasthan.gov.in/rvpn> departmental website.

Raj.Samwad/C/26/5824 R.R.V.P.N/TR-7641/2026

Superintending Engineer
(Contracts-II), Jaipur

भारतीय अन्तर्देशीय जलमार्ग प्राधिकरण
INLAND WATERWAYS AUTHORITY OF INDIA
(Ministry of Ports, Shipping and Waterways, Govt. of India)
A-13, Sector -1, NOIDA-201 301, Phone 0120-2543931, Email Id: akbansal.iwai@gmic.in

NOTICE INVITING E-TENDER

Tender No.: IWAI/Cargo/591/2026-27

IWAI invites tender in 2 cover system from experienced agencies for Preparation of Detailed Project Report along with Project Management Consultancy Services for Development of Urban Water Metro System at Srinagar, Guwahati and Kolkata, from individuals/firms fulfilling the Eligibility Criteria as specified in the tender. Bid document download starts date: 24.06.2026. Last date for submission of bids: 22.07.2026 up to 15:00 hrs (IST). Tender document & detailed eligibility criteria can be downloaded from IWAI website: www.iwai.nic.in & portal: <https://eprocure.gov.in/eprocure/app>. Chief Engineer (T&L and NER)

The Kerala Minerals & Metals Ltd
(A Govt. of Kerala Undertaking) Sankaramangalam, Kollam, 691583
Phone : +91-476-2612125 to 217, E-mail : mdg@kmmcl.com

TENDER NOTICE

For more details, please visit E-Tendering Portal <https://tenders.kerala.gov.in> or www.kmmcl.com

No	Tender ID	Items
1.	2026.KMML.857414.1	Fabrication & replacement of Pigment Separator
2.	2026.KMML.857925.1	Supply of PFA Lined Plug Valves
3.	2026.KMML.857777.1	Supply of High Purity Liquid Argon
4.	2026.KMML.857986.1	Supply of Brick Acid Resistant
5.	2026.KMML.857963.1	Supply of Double Girder Crab Assembly
6.	2026.KMML.857932.1	Supply of 210L M.S. Open Drums with Lid

Chavara.29.06.2026 Sd/, Managing Director for The Kerala Minerals and Metals Ltd

कार्यालय आयुक्त, नगर पालिक निगम, ग्वालियर

क्र. 47/26/2/30/सब.बी.ए. /2026-27/855

दिनांक: 29/06/2026

नगरपालिका 462

निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना

दिनांक: 29/06/2026

नगर पालिका निगम ग्वालियर की ओर से निकाय सीमा अंतर्गत निम्न कार्य की निविदा आमंत्रित की जा रही है, विवरण निम्नानुसार है:-

वैकल्पिक	टेकर क्र.	टेकर क्र. करने की तिथि	टेकर करने की अंतिम तिथि	टेकर राशि
Operation and maintenances of automatic vehicle tracking system and consultancy service for providing assessment tools, documentation and technical advisory for Swachh Survekshan under SBM three year in GMC	2026_UAD_517234_1	24.06.2026	24.07.2026	₹. 2,96,99,543/-

उपरोक्त निविदाओं की विस्तृत जानकारी www.mptenders.gov.in वेबसाइट पर प्रदर्शित की गई है।
सहायक यंत्री, एस.बी.ए., नगर निगम, ग्वालियर

Uttar Gujarat Vij Company Limited

CIN – U40102GJ2003SGC042906

Regd. & Corporate Office, Visnagar Road, Mehsana, Gujarat -384001
Toll free number 19121 OR 1800233155335 www.ugvcl.com

Tender Notice

Invitation of Tender Notice No.

UGVCL/TECH-PROJECT/26-27/ROBUST-GWFCM/HT-UG/FT/01 to 06

Uttar Gujarat Vij Company Limited (UGVCL) invites bid for Site survey, Designing, Engineering, Procurement, Supply, Loading, Transportation, Unloading, Insurance, Delivery at site, Handling, Storage, Installation, Testing, Commissioning including documentation of all items/material required to complete works for turnkey based contract for conversion of existing 11 KV HT Line network in to underground cable network with ring main system at Chandkheda & Ognaj, Nana Chiloda & Vinzol, Kujad & Naroda Urban, Ghuma & Shela, Shilaj, Kathwada & Naroda Industrial Sub Division respectively of Sabamati Circle under UGVCL with GIS Mapping/Geo Urja Mapping (Developed by GUVNL) and Asset Tagging under ROBUST-GWFCM respectively through online tendering on www.ugvcl.com & <https://tender.nprocure.com>. Interested Vendors are requested to locate the same from above mentioned websites.

Note: Be in touch with our website till opening of tender.

Chief Engineer (Op), R&C Office Mehsana

NOTICE INVITING E-TENDER

Gujarat Energy Limited (Erstwhile Gujarat Gas Limited), desires to invite bids against Tender(s) under two bid system through e-tendering portal from eligible and interested parties for the following categories:

Tender ID	Tender Description	Link for accessing the Tender Documents
316174	Supply, Installation, Testing, Commissioning and comprehensive AMC of air compressor and air inflator at CNG stations across GEL.	
315517	Third Party Inspection Agency For Quality Assurance Services For PE-PNG Project And O&M Activities And Steel Pipeline Construction Projects Having Pipeline Length Less Than 5 Km Across Surat GA	https://www.gujarat-energy.com/ggl-current-tender/
316645	Consultancy Services to carryout Land Identification & Acquisition for the Development of CNG/LNG/CNG Stations including all statutory permissions across GEL.	
316412	Hiring of Consultant for Engineering and Project Management Services for CNG and LNG/LCNG Stations across GEL.	

Any revision, clarifications, corrigenda, addenda, notifications etc. related to this notice will be updated on the above referred websites only. Interested parties should regularly visit websites to keep themselves updated.

BENGALURU SOUTH CITY CORPORATION

Office of the Executive Engineer, HSR Division,
HSR Layout, BDA Complex, Bengaluru-560102

No.: EE/HSR-D/Tend-05/2026-27 Date: 29.06.2026

TENDER CANCELLATION NOTICE

Reference: Tender Notification No.: BSCC/EE/HSR-D/ Tend-05/2026-27, Dated: 25.06.2026

With reference to the above subject, tenders were invited by the Bengaluru South City Corporation, Office of the Executive Engineer, HSR Division, HSR Layout, BDA Complex, Bengaluru-560102.

Due to technical reasons, the said tender notification has been cancelled.

Sd/- Executive Engineer, HSR Division,
Bengaluru South City Corporation

MINISTRY OF RAILWAYS

RESEARCH DESIGNS AND STANDARDS ORGANISATION (RDSO)

MANAK NAGAR, LUCKNOW

NOTICE FOR EXPRESSION OF INTEREST

Ministry of Railways, Research Designs and Standards Organization (RDSO), Lucknow, India is interested in Development of Functional Requirement Specification (FRS) for Air Generation Treatment Unit(AGTU) as an Integrated Unit of 2000 LPM Compressor along with Air Dryer for Electric Locomotives along with details etc. appearing on RDSO website. Firms interested in developing and supply of said items are requested to see the details on RDSO website www.rdsso.indianrailways.gov.in at HOME PAGE under Vendor Interface >Expression of Interest (EOI).

PEADSE RDSO,
Lucknow-226011

RO No. 09/2026-27/Electrical/EOI/03

S. E. RAILWAY – TENDER

DRM/ENGG/Chakradharpur acting for & on behalf of the President of India invites E-Tenders against Open Tender. Manual offers are not allowed against this tender, and any such manual offer received shall be ignored. **Sl. No.:** 1; **Name of Work:** (i) Improvement of Tuniia Yard under the jurisdiction of DEN/Central/ Chakradharpur (ii) Improvement of Manoharpur Yard, Jaraiakela Yard, Bhallulata Yard & Bisra Yard under the jurisdiction of DEN/Central/ Chakradharpur; **Tender Notice No.:** CKP-CENRAL-26-27-19; **Tender Value:** ₹ 2,88,60,792.91; **EMD:** ₹ 5,77,200. **Sl. No.:** 2; **Name of Work:** Extension for Platform No. 4/5 at Kharagpur end and construction of parcel platform between line No. 6 and 7 at Tatanagar; **Tender Notice No.:** CKP-EAST-26-27-24; **Tender Value:** ₹ 70,91,170.22; **EMD:** ₹ 1,41,800. **Sl. No.:** 3; **Name of Work:** (i) Through Rail Renewal (TRR(P)) for 28.610 TKM in Rajkharasawan-Padapahar, Noamundi-Bara Jamda & Bara Jamda-Gua Section, (ii) Complete Track Renewal (Primary) (CTR(P)) for 1.35 TKM & Through Turnout Renewal (TTR (FS+CS+CMSC)) for 9 sets in connection with improvement of Dangoaposi Yard under the jurisdiction of Sr. DEN(South)/Chakradharpur, (2nd Call); **Tender Notice No.:** CKP-SOUTH-26-27-12; **Tender Value:** ₹ 2,74,06,282.10; **EMD:** ₹ 5,48,100. **Sl. No.:** 4; **Name of Work:** Through Turnout Renewal (TTR (FS+CS+CMSC)) for total 69 sets in Padapahar-Nayagarh & TTR(FS+CS+CMSC) for total 74 sets in Rajkharasawan Jn. Padapahar section for layout correction under the jurisdiction of Sr. DEN (South)/Chakradharpur (2nd call); **Tender Notice No.:** CKP-SOUTH-26-27-13; **Tender Value:** ₹ 2,72,83,608.71; **EMD:** ₹ 5,45,700. **Sl. No.:** 5; **Name of Work:** Balance work of Construction of 17 unit type-II Qtrs. in lieu of existing type-I Qtrs. (17 nos.) on deposit basis in connection with proposed Pvt. Siding on M/S SAIL-BSL, Gua Ore Mines at Gua under the jurisdiction of Sr. DEN (South)/Chakradharpur (2nd call); **Tender Notice No.:** CKP-SOUTH-26-27-14; **Tender Value:** ₹ 1,87,63,683.84; **EMD:** ₹ 3,75,300. **Cost of Tender form:** 0.00 (for Sl. No. 1 to 5). **Date of opening:** 21.07.2026. (for Sl. No. 1 & 2) & 20.07.2026 (for Sl. No. 3 to 5). The tender can be viewed at Website <http://www.irops.gov.in>. The tenderer/bidders must have Class-III Digital Signature Certificate & must be registered under on IREPS Portal. Only registered tenderer/bidder can participate on e-tendering. All relevant paper must be uploaded at the time of participating in e-tendering. **Note:** e-Tender Forms shall be issued free of cost to all tenderers. (Authority – Rly. Bd.'s letter No. 2020/CE-I/CT/3E/GCC/Policy ctd.16.07.2020). (PR-392)

BENGALURU WEST CITY CORPORATION

Office of the Executive Engineer, Yediyur Division,
4th Cross, Jayanagara 7th Block, Bengaluru-560 070.

No:EE/YDR/TEND/05/2026-27 Date: 29.06.2026

Short Term Tender Notification

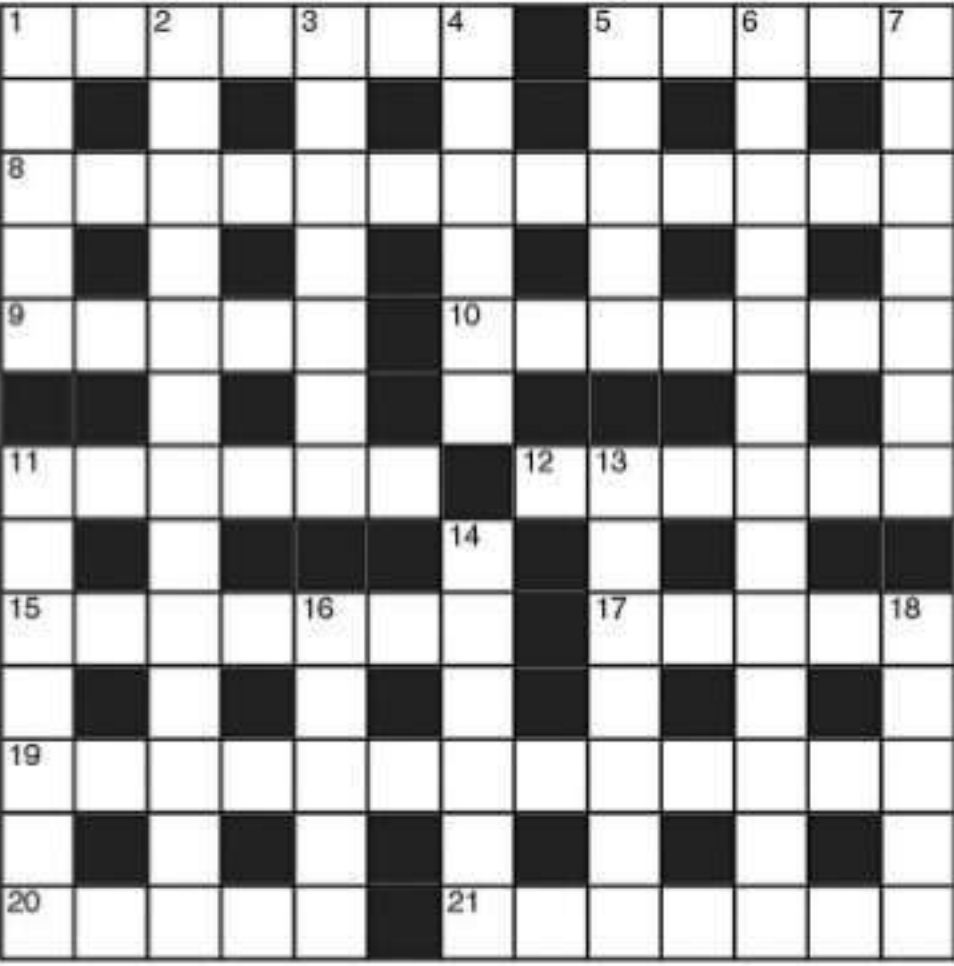
(Two Cover System) (Through GOK KPP Portal only)

website: <https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in>

The Executive Engineer, Yediyur Division, BWCC, Bengaluru invites tender from eligible Tenderers registered in BBMP or equivalent registration with PWD/CPWD or any State Govt. Organisation for the execution of works detailed in the table below.

Sl. No.	Name of the Work
1.	Improvements to Roads and Drains, Footpaths and other allied works in Ward No.105, Yediyur and 106 Devagiri Temple in Yediyur Sub Division, Comprising of 10 Works Sl.No. 112, 113,114, 115, 116, 117, 130, 131, 132 and 133. (Package-01-2026 YDR) Approximate value of work (₹ in Lakh): 933.14, EMD ₹: Rs. 5.00 Lakh through online payment & Rs.9.00 Lakh through BG.
2.	Improvements to Roads and Drains, Footpaths and other allied works in Ward No.107, Dharmagiri, and 108 Ganesha Mandira Sub Division Comprising of 6 Works Sl. No. 118, 119, 120, 121, 134 & 135. (Package-02-2026 YDR) Approximate value of work (₹ in Lakh): 790.85, EMD ₹: Rs. 5.00 Lakh through online payment & Rs.6.86 Lakh through BG.
3.	Improvements to Roads and Drains, Footpaths and other allied works in Ward No.109, Kamakya and 110 Chikkalasandra in Yediyur Division Comprising of 6 works Sl.No. 122, 123, 124, 125, 1

CROSSWORD



ACROSS
1 Take over from a man selling fine fabric (7)
5 Olga's staggering on port (5)
8 A fair exchange in sight (2,3,3,2,3)
9 Tom comes back with it — that's understood (5)
10 Space for some oar movement (3,4)
11 Ventilator in a gallery (6)
12 He shares what's left (6)
15 Such twins were once inseparable (7)
17 The Spanish weapon used in the movement of arms (5)
19 To take up the post is to increase the risk (5,3,5)
20 Council saying evil is peculiar? (5)
21 Seven days and one more - but not Sunday (7)

DOWN
1 New rotas for cook (5)
2 Deep thought given before starting the job (13)
3 One helping a superior it's said (7)
4 In Latin 'T' is used by many showing vanity (6)
5 Pack animal brings everything up around morning (5)
6 Bypasses the directors and takes the plunge (4,9)
7 Vessel without sails makes me stare (7)
11 Puts a gloss on bad results (7)
13 Exercise supervision in place of a bishop (7)
14 Write letters back to model relative (6)
16 Correct measure leads to a conclusion (5)
18 Lanky like unwanted plants (5)

SOLUTIONS CROSSWORD 6027 ACROSS: 1 Smock, 8 Animated, 9 Frank, 10 Gossamer, 11 Charm, 12 Led, 16 Creche, 17 Ignore, 18 Asp, 23 Cedar, 24 Arrogant, 25 Aspic, 26 Good news, 27 Inane **DOWN:** 2 Marchers, 3 Contract, 4 Income, 5 Smash, 6 Stamp, 7 Adore, 12 Lea, 13 Dip, 14 In person, 15 Creation, 19 Sineus, 20 Barge, 21 Groom, 22 Agony

JUMBLLED WORDS

Given below are four jumbled words. Solve the jumbles to make proper words and move them to the respective circles below. Select the letters in the shaded circles and jumble them to get the answer for the given quip.

When the ___ of a man is not clear to you, look at his friends. - Japanese proverb (9)

CPAAE

RECUR

EIPPCCT

EESWCH

ANSWER: When the character of a man is not clear to you, look at his friends.

SOLUTIONS: Apace, Cure, Peptic, Eschew

OVER THE HEDGE



CALVIN & HOBBS



MARVIN



DIFFICULTY LEVEL 1s INSTRUCTIONS

To solve a Sudoku puzzle, every digit from 1 to 9 must appear in each of the nine vertical columns, in each of the nine horizontal rows and in each of the nine boxes.

DIFFICULTY LEVEL

1s = Very easy; 2s = Easy; 3s = Medium; 4s = Hard; 5s = Very Hard; 6s = Genius

SUDOKU 6365

		4	6		2			7
3			5		8	2		
	1	8		4				
6	3				1		9	
	7	2	9		3	5	1	
	8		4				3	6
				9		8	6	
		1	2		6			4
5		3		7	9			

SOLUTION SUDOKU 6364

9	3	4	5	6	7	1	2	8
2	6	5	9	1	8	7	4	3
1	7	8	3	2	4	5	9	6
7	5	3	6	9	2	4	8	1
4	2	6	7	8	1	9	3	5
8	9	1	4	3	5	2	6	7
5	4	2	8	7	6	3	1	9
6	1	9	2	5	3	8	7	4
3	8	7	1	4	9	6	5	2

ROYAL STARS

ARIES (MAR 21 - APR 20): Today might begin in a stressful way, especially with parents, bosses, and the police. But this does not have to be the tone to your whole day. The next 12 months offer opportunities for romance, vacations and joy with kids. Tonight: You're admired.

TAURUS (APR 21 - MAY 21): Steer clear of controversial issues; they will be a bummer earlier in the morning. Starting today for the next 12 months, Jupiter will help you improve your home. Tonight: Explore and learn.

GEMINI (MAY 22 - JUNE 21): Even though you might be concerned about a financial squeeze this morning, perhaps it's hard to pay bills. Today, Jupiter enters a part of your chart that will boost your optimism for the next 12 months. Tonight: Check your finances.

CANCER (JUNE 22 - JULY 23): There's good news and there's bad news. The bad news is that Mercury retrograde is taking place in your sign. The good news is lucky money bags Jupiter will make you richer in the next 12 months. Tonight: Listen and cooperate.

LEO (JULY 24 - AUG 23): Generous, moneybags Jupiter moves into glamorous, loyal Leo today to stay for the year! This will make your life more fortunate. It will bolster your optimism. It will attract favourable circumstances to you. Tonight: Get better organised.

VIRGO (AUG 24 - SEP 23): Today begins with some challenges with your kids or a romantic partner. Someone sucked the joy out of your morning. As the day wears on you feel lighter and brighter. In fact, the next 12 months will be meaningful in a spiritual way for you. Tonight: Socialise.

LIBRA (SEP 24 - OCT 23): Jupiter will activate your interaction with friends, clubs and organisations for the next 12 months! Friends will benefit you. Whatever you put out will come back to you. Tonight: Relax at home.

SCORPIO (OCT 24 - NOV 23): Today Jupiter moves to the top of your chart for the first time in 12 years. It will stay there for an year, boosting your career, social status and reputation in the community. Tonight: Discussions.

SAGITTARIUS (NOV 24 - DEC 22): Today Jupiter moves into your fellow fire sign for 12 months. In the coming year, you'll be able to sit back and enjoy life and feel great. Finances look good as well. You wanted more? Tonight: Check your belongings.

CAPRICORN (DEC 23 - JAN 20): Today Jupiter moves into your fellow fire sign for 12 months. This is a big help! In the coming year, you'll be able to sit back and enjoy life and feel great. Finances look good as well. Tonight: Check your belongings.

AQUARIUS (JAN 21 - FEB 19): Today Jupiter is moving opposite your sign into your house of partnerships, making the next 12 months the best time to get married in over a decade. This improves all your closest relations. Tonight: Enjoy your privacy.

PISCES (FEB 20 - MAR 20): Starting today and for the next 12 months, you'll have wonderful opportunities to improve your health and your job. If you can't improve your job, you'll find a better one. You will also experience greater joy with pets. Tonight: Be friendly to someone.

GREATER VISAKHAPATNAM MUNICIPAL CORPORATION

Tender Notice No: 29/2026-27/SE(MDW)/EE (PW-MDW)/DB, Dt:27-06-2026

Number of works : 01 Work, Value of work : Rs.1,39,40,228.00

Starting Date: 27-06-2026, Ending Date: 13-07-2026.

Note: Further details at <http://www.tender.aeprocurement.gov.in>

D/o. the EE-II Cell No.99480 95518 Sd/- Commissioner, GVMC

KERALA WATER AUTHORITY e-Tender Notice

Tender No : 09/2026-27 KWA/PHC/ TVLA,10/2026-27/KWA/PHC/TVLA

1) Jal Jeevan Mission (JJM)-Chenneerkkara Panchayath-Construction of 11.5 MLD WTP for Chenneerkkara and Omalloor Panchayaths-General Civil Work, 2) Jal Jeevan Mission (JJM)-RWSS to Cherukole-Naranganam Design and Construction of 10 MLD Water Treatment Plant with 8.5 LL Sump cum Pump house and 5LL OHSR at Vayalathala WTP Site-General Civil Work EMD : Rs. 500000, 500000 Tender fee : Rs. 19518,19518 Last Date for submitting Tender : 20-07-2026 02:00 pm Phone : 8281997974 Website : www.kwa.kerala.gov.in www.etenders.kerala.gov.in

KWA-JB-GL-6-126-2026-27

MANGALORE ELECTRICITY SUPPLY COMPANY LIMITED

(A Government of Karnataka undertaking)

Corporate Office, "MESCOM BHAVANA", Bejai, Mangalore - 575 004

Ph: 0824-2885796 CIN: U40109 KA 2002 SGC 030425

No: MESCOM/SEE(PROJ)/EE(APR)/2026-27/1129 Date: 29.06.2026

SHORT TERM TENDER NOTIFICATION (KPPP Mode Only)

MESCOM invites tender for Comprehensive strengthening of distribution network using Covered Conductor in Kadur division of MESCOM jurisdiction on Total turnkey basis vide bid enquiry no. MESCOM/2026-27/EL/WORK_INDENT494

The interested eligible bidders may log on to <https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in> on or after 01.07.2026.

Sd/-,

Superintending Engineer (Ele) (Projects)

For Power Related Complaints contact:

MESCOM Helpline: 1912

9483041912 mescom_official mescom_official

BEFORE THE DEBTS RECOVERY TRIBUNAL - II AT BANGALORE

4th Floor, BSNL Building, Near Cubbon Park Metro, Bengaluru - 560 001.

O.A. No. 793 / 2022

BETWEEN :

STATE BANK OF INDIA ... APPLICANT

AND :

GOPALI BHAMRI ... RESPONDENT

SUMMONS TO THE DEFENDANT UNDER RULE 23 (VII) OF THE DEBTS RECOVERY TRIBUNAL (PROCEDURE) RULES, 1993

BY WAY OF PAPER PUBLICATION

To,

Smt. Gopali Bhambri W/o. Sri Vinod Hansda,

Fiat No. F-4, C & D Lake View Apartments, Malik Layout, Near Kothanur Lake, KLV Layout, J.P. Nagar, 8th Phase, Bengaluru - 560 076.

Also At : 1. C/o. M/s. Honeywell Technologies Solutions Ltd Pvt. Ltd., No. 151/1, Doraisanipalya, Bannerghatta Road, Bengaluru - 560 076.

2. Fiat No. 24, Second Floor, Lakshmi Vihara, Kammanahalli, Begur, Bengaluru - 560 068.

3. Fiat No. 214, Packet 3 Sector No. 23, Rohin, New Delhi.

WHEREAS, the applicant herein has instituted an application under Section 19 of the Debts Due to Banks and Financial Institutions Act, 1993 against you this Honble Tribunal for recovery of a sum of **Rs. 30,36,959/- (Rupees Thirty Lakhs Thirty Six Thousand Nine Hundred and Fifty Nine Only) under Loan Account No. 32356677978 as on 26.05.2022** together with current and future interest at the rate of 7.40% p.a. with monthly rests and penal interest at the rate of 2% p.a. and from 27.05.2022 till the date of payment / realization in full.

You are hereby requested to Show Cause in this Tribunal personally or by a pleader / advocate duly instructed within 30 days or on 03.08.2026 at 10.30 a.m. as to why the relief prayed for should not be granted.

Take notice that in case of default, the applicant will be heard and determined in your absence.

Given under my hand and seal of this Tribunal on this 17.06.2026

OFFICE OF THE TRIBUNAL

SD/- REGISTRAR,

DEBTS RECOVERY TRIBUNAL - II

BANGALORE

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Dinesh Kumar, S/o: Lt. Birju Prasad, R/o: H.No. D-1, Tibbia College, Karol Bagh, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 12/2022, P.S.: Karol Bagh, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Dinesh Kumar** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Dinesh Kumar** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Dinesh Kumar** accused of offence in case **FIR No. 12/2022, P.S.: Karol Bagh, Delhi** and is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **02.09.2026**.

By Order

Sh. Nishat Bangarh

Judicial Magistrate First Class-01

Room No. 180

Tis Hazari Court, Delhi

DP/8734/CD/2026 (Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Kunwar Singh S/o Man Singh, R/o Gali No. 6, Arya Samaj Road, Haiderpur, Delhi**, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No.: 20/2019, U/S 279/337 IPC, PS Kashmir Gate, North Distt., Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Kunwar Singh** cannot be found, and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Kunwar Singh** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant);

Proclamation is hereby made that **Kunwar Singh** the said accused of **FIR No.: 20/2019, U/S 279/337 IPC, PS Kashmir Gate, North Distt., Delhi**, is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **17.08.2026**.

By Order

Sh. Vaibhav Garg

Judicial Magistrate First Class-11,

Central, Court No.-138, 1st Floor,

Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/8663/N/2026 (Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Imran S/o Nizam R/o I-127, Janta Colony, Welcome, North East, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case registered vide **FIR No. 94/2017 U/S 356/379/411/34 IPC, PS Kashmir Gate, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said accused **Imran** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Imran** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Imran of FIR No. 94/2017 U/S 356/379/411/34 IPC, PS Kashmir Gate, Delhi** is required to appear before this court (or before me) to answer the complaint on or before the day of **13.08.2026**

By Order,

Sh. Vaibhav Garg

Judicial Magistrate First Class- 11

Central District, Court No. 138, 1st Floor

Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/8756/N/2026(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 CrPC

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Amnyunose Kingsley Uyi S/o Amany Unose R/o P/R No. 1, Akiyele Street, Mogoro Lagos State, Nigeria** and 43, Arjun Nagar, 1st Floor, Safdarjung Enclave, New Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case registered vide **FIR No. 206/2011 U/S 379/34 IPC, PS New Friends Colony, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest their upon issued that the said accused **Amnyunose Kingsley Uyi** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Amnyunose Kingsley Uyi** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Amnyunose Kingsley Uyi of FIR No. 206/2011 U/S 379/34 IPC, PS New Friends Colony, Delhi** is required to appear before this court (or before me) to answer the complaint on or before the day of **07.09.2026**

By Order,

Sh. Vinod Joshi

Additional Chief Judicial Magistrate

South-East District, Court No. 515

Saket Court, New Delhi

DP/8637/SE/2026(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Nadeem S/o Munnay, R/o Indraj Colony, Bawana, Delhi**, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No.: 426/2021, U/S 380/411 IPC, PS Bawana, Outer-North Distt., Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Nadeem** cannot be found, and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Nadeem** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant);

Proclamation is hereby made that **Nadeem** the said accused of **FIR No.: 426/2021, U/S 380/411 IPC, PS Bawana, Outer-North Distt., Delhi**, is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **17.08.2026**.

By Order

Ms. Bharti Beniwal

Judicial Magistrate First Class-05,

North Distt., Room No.-114, 1st Floor

Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/8767/ON/2026 (Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 CrPC

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Sobha W/o Amit, R/o H.No. B-3, Ambika Enclave, Nihal Vihar, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No.: 134/16, U/S 33/38 Delhi Excise Act, PS Nihal Vihar, Outer Distt., Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Sobha** cannot be found, and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Sobha** has absconded (or is concealing herself to avoid the service of the said warrant);

Proclamation is hereby made that **Sobha** the said accused of **FIR No.: 134/16, U/S 33/38 Delhi Excise Act, PS Nihal Vihar, Outer Distt., Delhi**, is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **24.08.2026**.

By Order

Ms. Komal Garg

Judicial Magistrate First Class-03,

West Distt., Court No.-292,

Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/8603/OD/2026 (Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Manoj Kumar, S/o: Rameshwar Dayal, R/o: B-17, Amar Colony, Nangloi, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **CR No. 1647/2018, U/s 279/304-A IPC, P.S.: Kanjhawala, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Manoj Kumar** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Manoj Kumar** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Manoj Kumar** accused of offence in case **CR No. 1647/2018, U/s 279/304-A IPC, P.S.: Kanjhawala, Delhi** and is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **03.08.2026**.

By Order

Sh. Apoorv Bhardwaj

Judicial Magistrate First Class-02 (North West)

Room No. 113, Rohini Court, Delhi

DP/8723/RD/2026 (Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

SEE SECTION 84 BHARTIYA NAGARIK SURKSHA SANHITA

Whereas a complaint has been made before me that accused Person namely **Sameer@Bata S/o Munnawar R/o Mohalla: Hazipur, PS: Rasulpur, Distt: Firozabad UP** also at: Phool Wali Gali, Bhumia Pul, PS: Useri Gate, Meerut, UP, have committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence under **FIR No. 000252/2017 U/s 411/482/34 IPC.**, has been registered at PS: **Sadar Bazar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said, **Sameer@Bata** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said, **Sameer@Bata** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused said, **Sameer@Bata of FIR No. 000252/2017 U/s 411/482/34 IPC.**, has been.registered at PS: **Sadar Bazar, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **19.08.2026**.

By Order

Sh. Kartik Taparai

Ld. JMFC-06 (Central), Room No. 247

Tis Hazari Court Delhi

DP/8694/N/2026 (Court Notice)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.PC. /84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person, namely, **Ashish, S/o: Vijay Kumar Sharma, R/o : H.No. 8/5 Gali No.8, A-Block, Prem Nagar-11, Delhi**, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No.: 351/2020, U/s: 457/380/411/34 IPC, P.S.: Prem Nagar, Rohini District, Delhi**, and the warrant has been returned writing upon that the said accused person, **Ashish**, cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person, **Ashish**, has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person, **Ashish, FIR No.: 351/2020, U/s: 457/380/411/34 IPC, P.S.: Prem Nagar, Rohini District, Delhi**, is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **31.07.2026**.

By Order

Ms. Shagun

Judicial Magistrate First Class

North West, Court No. 109, 1st Floor,

Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/8623/RD/2026 (Court Matter)